

A person in a dark hoodie stands on a rocky peak, looking out over a vast mountain range at sunrise. The sun is low on the horizon, casting a warm orange glow over the landscape. The sky transitions from a deep blue at the top to a bright orange near the horizon. The mountains are silhouetted against the light, and a misty valley is visible between them. The overall mood is one of inspiration and achievement.

TRAINING
EDITION

ACHIEVE GREATNESS

CONQUER YOUR FEARS,
EMBRACE YOUR FUTURE

HOW TO MOTIVATIONALLY COACH OTHERS

Achieve Greatness (Training Edition)

*This book is dedicated to you, who opened
these pages because you wanted to take the
step to achieve your best.*

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An Introduction From Your Coach

This book is the **third** and final chapter in the Achieve Greatness Training series books.

In earlier books, we have covered nutrition, fitness, and formed the beginnings of a positive mindset.

This book takes that all to the **next level**. The first section of this book explains how you can **motivationally coach** others within a fitness context specifically.

That section is for those who want to learn how to become **leaders** and learn how to teach the skill of fitness (or any other skill) to others. There is information in this chapter on how to **set goals** correctly, how to

motivate someone, and this can be used in many areas **outside** of fitness too.

For those that want to delve deeper into improving their positive mindsets, the second part of this book details all I learned as a **life coach**.

I have life coached an extensive number of clients through **various** life issues, starting my work in a charity music studio for disadvantaged youths, and moving on to coaching many people online through various life issues.

You can use the second half of the book to gain knowledge and to help yourself, or to help others through the **common** issues faced in areas of self improvement. It contains the life coaching **advice** I used to help work clients through issues, and acts as

a short, quick and simple to read **encyclopedia** of all the most common life issues that you usually find when trying to help people with their mindsets.

Whether you want to learn how to **coach** in a fitness context or simply want to learn principles to **train** or **lead** in general, the first part of this book has you covered. If you just want to make use of the encyclopedia in the second half of this book, to find **advice and solutions** for common mentality issues, this book is the perfect solution for you.

I welcome you to the book, and hope you use it to achieve your ultimate best, sending you positive vibes. Welcome once again to another installment of Achieve Greatness.

- Coach Tommy

How To Motivationally Coach Others

There's a lot of **reasons** why you would want to be more motivational. Maybe you want to be motivational to encourage others to come to the gym such as your little siblings and friends.

Maybe you have to **train** people at work.

Maybe you want to **motivate** your older family members to be more healthy and take better care of themselves.

Being a motivational person allows you to **send a wave of positivity** to others.

As a motivational person, you have to **live and breathe** motivation and **surround** yourself with it, you have to practice it daily.

You can't really focus on the **negatives** in the world much or hang around with those types of people that focus on that.

Throughout this book, I am going to show you the **techniques** I used in my fitness coaching business and my life coaching business to motivationally coach others through a **wide variety** of issues.

There will be fitness coaching elements, but also ideas on how to coach people through a variety of positive self-development areas.

I've spent years refining my coaching across **two very different worlds**. In my fitness coaching and life coaching businesses, I've worked with clients on everything from body

transformation to rebuilding self-belief from scratch.

Not only am I a **fitness** coach, but I used to run a charity studio called Fresh Beats, which was aimed to direct and coach youths away from trouble in South London and apply themselves onto the correct path in life.

These youths often had immense life issues, and there was really **nothing** I didn't see.

But coaching these youths brought a great **hope** in me. Because for every youth who decided they had it hard in life, that they were some kind of victim with a unique circumstance that no one else had been through (even though many others had been through the same and **succeeded**), there were other youths who had it 10 times worse, who would simply reach for the stars and

better their situations with **amazing** attitudes.

What is even greater is that, once those youths who believed they had it hard were shown the **example** of someone who had been through what they had been through (or worse) and still came out of it with a great attitude towards life, they felt inspired and often were able to change too.

The right direction, the “positive” direction is always there, and some people just need to give themselves **permission** to take it.

I gained a lot of **self growth** from this chapter of my life. This experience gave me an outlook on many life issues and mental health issues in general that led me onto **greater** things.

I went on to start a **life coaching** business.

Through my online business Achieve Greatness I helped over 100 people on the website Skool.com, teaching them self improvement principles to improve their mentalities.

I consider myself blessed to have the experience of these **two worlds**, life coaching and fitness coaching.

My best advice for you to become a **motivational** type of person is to put yourself in scenarios where you are positively helping people and **consuming positivity** daily.

This allows you to become the kind of person who is always positive, who always has just read that one article or watched that one YouTube video with some positive **advice**, that they can then share with other people.

Motivational advice stays fresh in your brain
when you read it often.

On social media, I **recommend** that you stay
learning and follow motivational pages and
coaches, instead of the usual supermodels
and comedy video accounts that many
people follow. Really try and seek out
positive role models and mentorship.

Read **motivational** books in the **self-help**
genres. This way when you go about your
day to day life, you find yourself recounting
quotes and teachings from these books to
others. I have included a **recommended**
reading list at the end of this book for you to
follow.

Involve yourself in the world of **positivity**,
self improvement and motivation and really
live it.

The last piece of advice I can give, is to truly care about people. Fitness is one area, life coaching is one area, and there are so many other areas you could motivate someone in.

Find your area of expertise, and never stop reading and learning how to be a motivational coach in the areas you believe you are destined for. There is lots of information out there nowadays.

Being In Tune With Your Emotion

Another thing I have **struggled** with, that many motivational coaches struggle with, is the experience of coming from a rough area, or having a family that showed you **tough love**. It takes some **serious** changes to your

mindset to become the best coach you can be when you have come from a **rougher** background.

It can feel **weird** to you, or seem over emotional to tell someone you're proud of them, to tell them "well done, I'm proud of you."

Especially if you and your family had **difficulty** showing emotions. But this is what every great trainer does every day. So you need to give yourself **permission** to do that too. Never be afraid of that. Don't make excuses.

People need **positivity** to be coached, if a coach just has "tough love" in his coaching style, there will only be a small percentage of people that they can truly reach and help.

To truly bring **100%** out of someone, you have to give them **more** than tough love. You have to **support** them. You have to bring them warmth, patience, and encouragement as well.

Promise yourself that you can show emotion without thinking you are "sounding silly" or "not strong enough." Once you can conquer this barrier, you can easily be a **motivational** person too, and not just in fitness but in any area.

Can Anyone Learn To Be Motivational?

Yes. Positivity and motivational coaching are **learned** skills that **anyone** can learn.

I grew up in a house full of non-motivated people for years, and it had a very **tough love style environment**. In my household motivation wasn't exactly in the air — and self-improvement felt **foreign** to most people around me.

For a long time I felt like the **odd one out**. I was the only one at times who was motivated or **cared** about the gym or self improvement, or doing coaching and my charity business ideas.

Positivity is something you can **build** even when **everyone** else around you **rejects** it, and I've seen it happen numerous times.

It is usually when a person simply wants **more** out of life than those around them, and understands positivity is the mindset that will most likely get them their the **fastest**.

I still made my life work out despite the **conditions** around me, and slowly, when my personality became stronger, my household all noticed the positive changes in me and finally changed their attitudes and mindsets too!

Will People Listen When I First Start?

You can start getting results a lot faster than you would think. Anyone can learn the skill of having a positive motivational mindset and character. All you need is to be able to forget the imposter syndrome of: "why would anyone listen to me?"

Even if you are not a gym coach, the amount of times I have heard someone say: "thank you for that one thing you said to me, it was

great and really helped my situation." to another person who wasn't even a coach.

Once a person acts in a motivational way, people are drawn to them and **look up to them** whether they are a qualified coach or not.

So if you're sitting with that voice that says "*why would anyone listen to me?*" — challenge it. You don't need a **certificate** on the wall for your words to matter.

Think about how many times someone said something to you — casually, in passing — that stuck with you for years. They probably had no idea. That's the **power** you already carry.

In fact, some of the **best life advice** I have been given in my life, has been from everyday good-natured people. These were

people who had **never** done any life coaching **qualifications** or coached in any professional capacity.

That is the power of this book, to spread the idea around that **we all have it in us to help others**. With a little practice, positivity, a bit of self improvement reading and working on ourselves, with the right words at the right time, we can **change** lives.

Surrounding ourselves with positive role models, habits and lifestyles **helps** too, and that's all things my books have been helping you to build!

The aim of this book is to get you to learn some **additional** techniques, and get an **education** around leading others, so that you can be the light in someone else's life.

Everything will be written **simply** and easy for you to understand so you can apply the teachings to your own life!

Things may be slow to start, but if you achieve a good level of fitness, a good level of nutritional knowledge, and a bit of life coaching expertise, you can really help **a lot** of people who come to you with advice.

Fitness Training - Analysing Your Client

Before you train **anyone**, you need to understand there are many different types of people you will face. Try to understand the type of person who you are dealing with.

The first thing you can do is make them feel **comfortable**. Show them where the water is, ask them how their day has been, how they slept, if they had a long day at work and how much **energy** they have.

People perform better when they feel **relaxed** and **welcomed**. Remember, for many people, walking into a gym for the first time is **genuinely** nerve-wracking. You have a responsibility to change that feeling immediately.

When you train someone, first ask them **what they are looking for** and what their goals are. Don't assume. They might be looking for a relaxed workout or more of a challenge.

You can then provide them with what they are looking for once you have an idea! If they

have injuries, you may have to **refer** them back to their **GP** first.

If you want to be **professional**, you can have them fill out a really basic form called a PAR-Q form.

You can print this form out from the internet and it will ask your client their medical history just to help you make sure they are safe to exercise.

Then ask the important question: "Do you have any injury, limitation or illness that could affect your workout today?"

If they say **no**, you're good to go — put them straight into a movement assessment.

If they say **yes**, you adjust accordingly, and in some cases refer them to their GP before proceeding.

Very **minor pains** are ok during a workout, but never get a client to push past pain if they feel it, and switch exercises if they do feel pain.

A client should feel a pumping feeling and a challenge, even feeling close to muscular failure, but in terms of actual **pain**, pushing through anymore pain than a 2 or 3 out of 10 means you should switch exercise.

The PAR-Q Form

As fitness trainers, we fill out 2 forms, a **consent** to exercise and a PAR-Q which asks them if they have any illnesses or conditions.

Even if you're not an officially qualified trainer, but you know you're going to try and

train friends and family anyway, this is the kind of thing you need to keep in mind. You can find the official PAR-Q form **online** by googling “Par Q form.”

If a client makes any “Yes” answers on the PAR-Q form, it may be worth sending them to a GP to get them **cleared** before they exercise.

Reasons to see a **GP** before starting exercise:

- Lung problems
- Heart problems
- High blood pressure
- Diabetes
- Obesity
- Over 50 year olds
- Those on painkillers
- Skin infections
- Pregnant women

- Those with muscle or joint pain
- Arthritis type conditions
- Strokes
- Recent strains
- Heavy flu symptoms
- Any previous reason why exercise caused a problem for them

Once the person gets clearance from a GP to work out, here are some **common conditions**, and how you could approach them through training:

- **Asthma** — Go easy on cardio!
- **Heart Problems** — Go easy on cardio!
- **Knee problems** — Go easy on leg day!
- **High Blood Pressure** — Be careful of overhead exercises, decline exercises, make sure they don't hold their breath on heavy lifts.

- **Teenagers under 17** — Start them off on bodyweight programmes, don't go under 6 reps as their body is still developing and heavy weight can cause damage.
- **Ankle Sprain** — Be careful on machines like Leg Extension where the feet are pressured against a weight roller pad. Be careful of kickboxing and explosive jumping movements.
- **Tennis / Golfers Elbow** — Take care with Bicep Curls, deload and go high reps instead of heavy reps on pull movements and Bicep movements.
- **Chest Pains / Constant Sickness When Exercising** — Tell the person to see a GP, explain that they may be at risk of having cardiovascular problems.

Depending on your country, you may wish to get **insurance** to protect yourself financially

when training people, in case of any
accidents.

But if you are just training your friends and wish to help them out, then of course, the risk and choice is yours.

You can go straight into training someone after checking for the above risks.

Do not overthink this, be an organised person who prints out an outline of a movement assessment, and a PAR Q form, and get those done before the main workout.

It takes less than 10 minutes to perform a quick **movement assessment** and ask a few safety questions through the PAR Q form, and gives that person a lot more safety.

Some people will be so **excited** to train with you and not even realize they have a

condition that would stop them from
working out!

The movement assessment will be covered
later in this chapter.

Determining Experience Levels

You must first determine if the person you
are training is at the **beginner, intermediate**
or **advanced** level.

Beginner — You would classify a beginner as
someone who doesn't really know **anything**
about the form of exercises. They are easily
injured. You have to be **careful** with training
beginners.

Always start light, with sets of 15-20 repetitions. If they are **young, strong** and seem like they can handle it, you can push them towards further rep ranges of 12-15 in the first session.

Move **slowly** and don't have a beginner performing “strength” or “powerlifting” work with extremely heavy weights. Some people, especially young men, may have “something to prove” but it is **your responsibility** to look after them and build them up to heavier weights slowly.

In terms of training time, a beginner could be **brand new** in the gym, or they have under 6 months of experience and haven't trained 3 times a week consistently or with any kind of personal trainer.

Intermediate — After 3 to 6 months of training three times a week, you can reasonably start calling someone intermediate — but that's assuming they've been working with a **personal trainer** who's guided them properly through technique, warm-ups, and nutrition from the start.

Without that structure, the timeline **stretches**. Someone training alone could be intermediate for anywhere up to a year to a year and a half.

Why? Because without proper **guidance**, people pick up bad habits. They follow **unqualified** advice online, they don't understand how to eat to support muscle growth, and sometimes, more often than not, they're only making it to the gym twice a week and calling it consistent.

Once someone is genuinely intermediate — they are showing up three to four times a week, moving well, and handling intermediate programmes with good form — you can work these clients mainly in the 8 to 12 rep range and start building real structure into their training.

Someone who had 1-2 years gym experience and returned to exercise after taking **a few months away** could also be seen as intermediate. Someone who has gone to the gym on and off their whole life and is recently taking it **seriously** can be seen as intermediate.

Advanced — Advanced lifters know their body. As a general guide, someone can reach this level after around a year with a really

good personal trainer — or closer to two years if they've been self-directed but following the right sources. Ultimately though, years in the gym alone don't tell the full story. It comes down to knowledge and consistency.

Some people are lucky enough to find great coaches, strong role models, and excellent programming early on. Others spend years wading through bad advice online and never quite break through.

That's exactly why I'd rather judge an advanced athlete by what I see them do in the gym than by how long they've been training.

Someone can train on and off for years, absorbing the wrong information, and plateau indefinitely. Someone else can lock

in with **quality** coaching and smart programming for two years and arrive at a level most people never reach. The difference isn't always time — it's mindset and guidance.

I judge an advanced lifter by what they can do, and how much they know.

For example, if you see a guy do a muscle up, handstands, handling all your advanced workouts 4 - 6 days a week with all the supersets and drop sets causing them **motivation** instead of to give up, then this is an advanced level person.

They can handle power days, **advanced training techniques**, and have been consistent in the gym for a long time. They understand the basics of dieting and how to

eat so that they can “cut” and “bulk” their body composition.

Time Available

Consider the **available time** before promising a person you are training a bulging chest in under 2 years or a 6 pack in 6 months.

If you know this person can only do 1 session a week, you have to tell them the truth — that it will be **harder** for them to get a good physique.

Your goal should be to get them to **commit** to a minimum of three sessions a week — that's where consistent, visible progress starts to happen.

But if once a week is genuinely all they've got, **make it count**. A full body session built around the five core compound movements will give them the most **return** for their time.

If weight loss is the priority, a well-structured circuit works well and a focus on cardio machines.

If they're dealing with **posture** issues, point them toward the *"How To Fix Your Posture And Become A Superhero"* workout from the Fitness Mastery book in my series, or search on the Achieve Greatness YouTube channel for the video:

"How To Fix Your Posture And Become A Superhero."

There is always **something** you can do for someone in the time you have. Beyond that,

use the time you do have with them **creatively**. Introduce them to boxing, experiment with **different styles** of training and sports, and make the sessions genuinely enjoyable.

A lot of people who start at once a week simply haven't found the type of training that **clicks** for them yet — your job is to help them find it. Find what they take to.

You can also give a client **homework** — simple **home workouts** that build the habit of moving on the days they're not with you.

Small steps compound quickly when someone starts to **enjoy** the process.

The goal is always **three structured** sessions a week minimum if possible.

Get familiar with the **AG 3-day, 4-day, and 5-day programmes** for both men and women, have a bank of the **AG home workouts** ready, and a few outdoor calisthenics ones, and you'll be equipped for whatever a client brings to you.

Once you identify what your client **enjoys**, try to persuade them to invest more time into fitness offering more of what they enjoy.

What To Do On The First Session

A client's first session is their first introduction to the world of fitness. I find it matters **less** what exercises you make them do, but more about how you make them **feel**.

If you make a person feel good, have fun, and explain to them the value behind the exercises they are performing, they are more likely to see the **value** in the gym as a whole.

The first session should be fun and full of **positive encouragement**, this is an element that is missing from many people's lives at home.

Tell the person things like:

"Wow you can kick really high.. you're really getting the hang of this quickly!"

"You're a natural at this!"

"Your doing really well!"

Make them **feel good**. Make that extra effort and exaggerate it, even if you're not in the mood, because even though it's just another

day at the gym for you, you have to think...
it's a make or break moment for this person.

This is their **first** time in the gym and could
be their **last** if they don't get a good
impression, so be an exceptional person and
coach.

You actually have a LOT of **responsibility**
here if you decide to give someone their first
session, as it dictates whether or not they get
into fitness and potentially change their
entire life for the better, so show them a
really good first session.

On a first session, if you need to show
criticism, start with the **good** before you say
the **bad!** For example:

*"I loved how you threw that hook punch with
such power! What I really liked is that you
dipped down before the shot to give yourself*

more power. However, your back leg needs to shift slightly back so you can balance yourself more!"

"You did really well on that set. I love how you paused your repetition and resisted the weight on the way up.

That's actually what builds more muscle. Just a tip, keep your chin tucked down to avoid jerking your neck back when you pull back the bar on the lateral pulldown — lots of people get injured that way!"

Can you see how the **bad** is always **layered after** the good? This makes the corrections seem to be delivered in a positive way.

If you layer this kind of language and speak to a person in the ways explained above in their first workout, you will actually find you don't need them to make them perform a lot

of exercises or give them the most **intense** workout they ever had.

Something about the fun they had, the feeling in them that felt like a natural, and the overall experience of feeling encouraged and having a good time, will **intrigue** them to come back for more.

The Movement Assessment

In the first session, you can teach a person some machines and see where they are at on a few of the basic lifts.

If you want to be **safer** and more **professional**, I will give you my formula for training clients. First run them through

these movements as an **initial assessment** at using super light weights:

- Dumbbell Squat
- Dumbbell Deadlift
- Dumbbell Shoulder Press
- Dumbbell Curl
- Push-Ups
- Sit-Ups
- Step-Ups

This can take 10 minutes but checks if they can squat, hinge, press overhead, flex and extend their spine, and push up.

If they do this without pain then you can go into a workout with them. Only once they can do all this under light weight would you think about putting them under a rack and loading up more weight.

If a client does feel pain on any of these exercises, then these are the exercises you load lightly, reduce the range of motion on, and do repetitions of 15 - 20 on until they build strength to lower the rep ranges.

I am going to attach a table to show you what you would commonly be looking to change, if you identified pain in any of these areas.

Movement Assessment

Exercise	Reason
Dumbbell Squat	Check You Can Move Your Hips And Knees Safely Under Load

Dumbbell Deadlift	Check You Can Hinge At Your Hips Without Rounding The Spine.
Dumbbell Shoulder Press	Check Your Vertical Press To See If You Can Move Weight Over Your Head Safely.
Dumbbell Bicep Curl	Check Elbows For Elbow Pain.
Press Up	Check You Can Press Horizontally Without Pain
Sit-Up	Check Your Spinal Flexion
Step-Up	Check Your Balance For Unilateral Exercises.

Movement Assessment - What To Do If There Is Pain

Exercise	Pain?	What We Change
Squat	Knee Pain?	Box Squat, Goblet Squat, Reduce Depth
Hinge	Lower Back Pain?	Hip Hinge To Elevated Platform, Romanian Deadlift With Lighter Dumbbells

Overhead Press	Shoulder Pain?	Neutral Grip Press, Seated Press, Lighter Weight.
Biceps Curl	Elbow Pain?	Switch to Hammer Curl Or Resistance Band
Press Up	Chest / Shoulder Pain?	Incline Push Up / Reduce Range
Sit - Up	Spine Pain?	Crunch, Plank
Step- Up	Knee / Hip Pain?	Lower Step / Partial Step

Notice from this table that we coach **defensively** and safely, but we don't coach in a **scared way**.

If an exercise brings **pain**, notice we are simply testing out different exercises and form tweaks of the same exercises that would work the same target muscle with our client.

We never try to totally **avoid** working an entire muscle group just because of pain, or the client will never get **strong** in that area. We **lighten** our exercises that target that area, reduce the range of motion, or find **substitutions**.

The main **aim** for your first session is to make the first gym experience **fun** and **enjoyable** for beginners, and if you use the techniques above you will be great at that!

Tell your client they are a **fast learner**, always **compliment** them and say they are doing really good, make them feel good, and then tell them you can definitely help them to reach their goals.

Then try and **arrange the next session** with them whilst you are still with them.

Try and put this person on a 4 - 6 week programme before they leave. It won't be long before their **life gets in the way** or they have second thoughts about committing, so get the commitment from them when they are with you.

The plan of "this is definately happening again at X time" is easier for a person to commit to whilst they are still high on the energy of the workout session.

A **commitment** benefits them too, once a solid plan at a specific time has been made for a follow up, they feel secure and certain in their mind that another workout will happen. They have certainty and a specific date to work out again instead of feeling left unsure of the next steps.

You can tell a client things like drinking and smoking will slow their progress, you can take their **measurements (if they want)**. I find the most important one to help them work out is their **weight**.

After this you can also send them a picture of the calorie calculator in my Nutrition book to help set them rough **calorie targets for their goals**.

The app called Trainerize is also **free** to train one person on, and is quite good at inputting all a client's body measurements and allowing them to track their calories.

You could support a person further from this app, in a very easy way. Even a teenager could figure out this app very fast.

But in terms of measuring and weighing a person, only do so with the person's permission, and remember it's a **sensitive** scenario for some people. Some people might not be on that level of trust with you, or simply not want to take that route.

In my opinion, unless the person specifically pushes to get body measurements done, I think it's more **simple** to take their basic weight on the scales, and before and after photos if possible, and go with those.

Measuring out the exact inches of a persons biceps and chest and **obsessing** over it each week can be a bit too much for some people unless they really want it.

When you train a person well, they will see a visible change in their body. A person can also loose weight and build muscle at the same time, so the scales are **not** always the **best** way to measure body composition changes. Visually is usually the best way.

Apps such as Trainerize can be very effective for the type of person that needs a habit tracker set for them, someone to **check** on them, a place to **log** their food, and finds it fun to use apps to track things.

Try and get a feel for the person and what they want to commit to, but setting all this technology and measurements up can really

help them feel like “they are really doing this **seriously** now.”

Especially once they have an app that tracks their nutrition, their changes in body weight, and a actual 4 - 6 week programme written out for them, they have more than just that experience of “oh I went to the gym and someone showed me a few machines, and I might go again sometime.”

They have gone in, and received real **support**, and real **targets**, and a way to track this all.

They feel like they can come back to the gym in 2 days time with a programme that has now begun. This programme expects them to show up again for their workout and to track their food. And you will be helping them. Something about seeing their measurements on the app, will make them

realise in 4 - 6 weeks, if they don't go to the gym again, there will be no difference to these measurements, or maybe they will get worse instead of better.

This makes the process **real and apparent** to them.

Can you see the difference between this way of doing things, and just showing a person a few machines and telling them “Bye! Let's maybe train together again **sometime!**”

The main thing at this stage is to try and keep **contact** and get your client to work out **consistently** and have **fun** consistently.

Set a 4 week **introductory programme** for them as soon as you can, write it into an app, have some kind of PDF, or just write it for them in person, so that they can do a programme when they aren't with you too.

It may sound like hard work, but if you truly care about this person it will probably take a **short time** to copy and send them a programme.

Specifically say: "this is the programme you should start." The sooner you **set goals** with them the more motivated they will be.

If you do wish to use Trainerize to help a person with calories, or even if you just tell them to log everything on a different calorie tracking app and send you pictures, tell them you'll be **checking up** on them.

This will help them to take it **seriously**.

When your client comes again, always carry out a quick **verbal check-in** at the start of every session — ask if anything has changed since they last trained with you.

Any new aches, illness, or fatigue needs to be factored in before you start.

The First Session - Intermediates or Advanced

What about if you want to train someone who is a bit **further** along in their gym journey?

Intermediate and Advanced gym goers will want to feel like they got a **good workout** and learned some **new techniques** from you.

Everyone has learned their own little **supersets** and **shortcuts** in the gym, so after you see they are safe to load up the weight on your movement assessment, show them

some of the cool **supersets** that you know or sports specific training that you have learned about when reading my books.

Ask if they have a **particular muscle** they want to work on or a lift they want to work on, and show them what you know about that.

How To Motivate Someone In The Different Stages Of A Session

Before a session:

- Try and pump your client up and get verbal consent you're going to go hard — *"Are you ready for warfare today with your body? Let's shout, let's*

scream, let's have some positive vibes and go hard today!"

- *"I think you can do it.. I think you can do X reps today."* They have to agree with you that they are going to go hard, pain will result and it's going to be worth it.
- *"It's good to see you again"* — makes them feel valued.
- *"You feel tired, yet you have made a great effort to come today, that is an incredibly positive step, well done!"*

Mid workout:

- *"I'm proud of you!"* — when the music's blaring, makes them feel great.
- *"You're doing excellent."*

- *"How bad do you want it? I know you're tired. Show me the champion now."*
- *"You think you can't [their name], but you can. You know you can. Believe in yourself."*
- They say "I can't" — you say: *"You can do anything you put your mind to. You're a strong man/woman."*
- *"Well done!"*
- *"Come on, you can do this!"*
- Ramp up verbal intensity after about the 8th rep — *"Let's GO!!"* — wakes them up.
- *"That's it. Every day we are improving!"*
- *"Keep on achieving."*
- *"I believe in you."*

After a session:

"Well done guys, you worked really hard today, that was a great session. Everyone should be proud. It's good to see you all here improving yourselves."

"Well done, you worked really hard today. That was a great session. You should be proud. It is good to see you here improving yourself."

Ask them how they found the session and ask for **feedback** on what they enjoyed, what they didn't, and how to make it better for them next time.

You can provide a client with the total amount of weight lifted and compare it to the previous session to show an **increase** in

total volume. Always show increases
whenever possible.

You could also give them information about
how intense the session was and how that
will help them grow.

In the spirit of "setting up a sequel," you can
also inform the client of what to expect for
the next session.

There will be an opportunity to offer some
basic **nutritional advice** about what is best to
eat before the type of session that you have
planned.

All of this combined closes the chapter on
that session and opens the page for the next,
creating a sense of anticipation for the client
and keeping their
motivation high.

Bad Day Clients

Some clients simply have a bad day or a day of low motivation.

Say: *"Some days you'll have more motivation than others, but we follow the plan not the mood — some of the best workouts you do are the ones you don't feel like doing!"*

Reflect any "I can't" statements back to the person, but take out the "I can't" in a smart way.

What we want to do is keep their "change talk" in our replies and not too much of their "sustain talk."

Change talk is their positive talk about changing their habits. Sustain talk is the talk

about staying the same in the same negative situation.

For example, a client may say: *"Part of me really wants to stop eating fast food."*

"I know it's bad for me and I really want to make a change now that I am getting older"
*(**change talk!**)*.

"I've tried so many times and I felt like I couldn't so I just gave up giving up."
*(**Sustain talk!**)*

You: *"Ah ok, so you really did struggle before with giving up. But you really want to make a change now that you're getting older."*

*I think that's **great**. It's a great thing that you have identified where you want to be and how positive the change can be."*

*"So you've really identified that you want to make this change as you get older. That's a genuinely great thing. **Let's focus on that.**"*

Focus more on the change talk in your responses, and where they **want** to be, and how to get them there.

Tracking Progress

Track the below metrics to compare to the client's next workout:

- Exercises performed
- Weight used
- Rep range or reps performed
- Sets
- Tempo
- Recovery between sets

By **recording** and referring to this information, you will be able to track progress from one workout to the next and also evaluate the **success** of the workout.

This information can also be used for setting and tracking progress toward goals and for future programme design.

Competitive Motivation

If a client has issues with form or issues grasping a concept in the gym, before correcting the form, you first start with telling them a positive. For example: *"Great, I didn't expect you to get so many repetitions there."*

You did amazing. You did cheat up the last few repetitions but you got loads of

repetitions so I'm proud of you. This next set I challenge you to get the same reps without the cheating."

With competitive motivation, you set challenges. Encourage them to beat their score.

"Let's beat your last set by 1 clean rep."

"That was an 8/10 set — let's aim for 9/10."

Inverse Motivation

Inverse motivation is like competitive motivation but slightly different. It can work to motivate a person when you playfully challenge them: *"Any more?"*

"I bet you can't give me 3 more?!"

However this only works when a client is so close to the end of their set. Telling a client *"I bet you can't do X"* whilst they are halfway through a really tough marathon will have the opposite effect and demotivate them.

They have to have the finish line in very short reach, and have a specific personality type, for this technique to be best used.

Emotional Anchor Motivation

Link the training to a deeper reason they have told you about why they train.

"This is the work that builds the version of you you keep talking about, I'm proud of you."

"You're making your family proud. Keep going for them." (if they told you they want to train to inspire their family.)

“Come on push this last one, we are building that mindset we talked about.” (if they told you they are working out to feel better mentally)

Training Different Types Of People

There are many **different** types of people and personality types that you will come across, when you try to motivate, train, and inspire people.

I will run through some of the different types you will find in a fitness coaching context first, and in a later chapter I will explain the types of people and conditions you would find in a life coaching context.

Blood Pressure

If an exerciser is hypertensive, care should be taken not to exacerbate their health issues by straining so hard that diastolic blood pressure rises excessively.

This means that hypertensive exercisers should avoid **holding their breath**.

It is also recommended that hypertensive exercisers follow a **circuit weight training programme** rather than use the more traditional multi-set system, and **avoid overhead and declined exercises**.

During weight training, most of us **hold** our breath as a means of handling intensity.

In heavy weight training where the **breath is held** to increase intra-abdominal pressure, diastolic blood pressure can **increase**.

Breath-holding during exercise **increases** blood pressure rapidly and this can lead to fainting, painful exercise-induced headaches, or even stroke.

Correct breathing is important — a good rule of thumb is exhale on the push for push exercises, and exhale on the pull for pull exercises.

Inhale on the descent on a Squat, and **exhale** as you explode back up. Stay breathing and don't ever hold your breath.

Improper breathing on your heavy lifts, can result in your head spinning and going dizzy.

Hypertensives should take extra care on **Deadlifts** as people tend to hold their breath whilst pulling the bar up on a Deadlift, and then they **exhale** at the top.

To fix this, try not to “**hold**” your breathe on the Deadlift, simply breathe out as you pull the bar to the top, finish your exhale, than breathe in as you lower the bar to the floor.

Low blood pressure can also cause fainting, and you should keep an eye on these clients at all times, and avoid heavy overhead pressing.

Pregnant Clients

First obtain **medical clearance** to train a pregnant person.

This will all be determined through the completion of a PARmedX, a required form that acts in a similar fashion to a PAR-Q,

simply used to evaluate whether a pregnant client can safely engage with physical activity.

As a general rule, pregnant individuals should be able to **hold a conversation** as they exercise.

If a pregnant client becomes **breathless** as they talk, then they're exercising too strenuously.

It's strongly advised that pregnant clients avoid:

- Laying **flat** on their backs for prolonged periods, due to the fact that the bump will compress the main blood vessel bringing blood back to the heart
- Exercises that involve them **getting hit** — kickboxing, wrestling, rugby, etc.

- Hiking/walking/running above 2,500m sea level — both expecting parent and baby are at risk of **altitude sickness**.

Sometimes pregnancy makes a woman who previously did not exercise ever before in her life choose to **take up** exercise to improve the health of her body **when** they become pregnant. Identify if they are this type of person.

If they are, their body not only has to **adapt** to being pregnant, but to exercise for the first time too.

In this instance, you should programme **15 minutes** of continuous aerobic exercise and **gradually** increase week by week until they reach up to 30 minutes per session.

Pregnant women are vulnerable to nausea, dizziness and fainting. Key **guidelines** include:

- Stay well hydrated and avoid exercising in hot or humid conditions to reduce the risk of foetal overheating.
- Severe calorie restriction is not recommended during pregnancy as it may harm foetal development.
- Sessions should be limited to around **45 minutes** and adjusted according to the mother-to-be's energy levels on the day.

Pregnant women should **avoid**:

- Exercising in the **supine** (lying on your back) position after 16 weeks
- Exercising to the point of **exhaustion** — the goal should be to maintain activity rather than improve fitness
- **Prone** lying exercises (exercises lying on your front)
- Prolonged **motionless** standing
- Heavy, uncontrolled, isometric or prolonged resistance work **above the head**
- Abdominal exercises — focus instead on posture, mobility and pelvic floor muscles
- Loaded forward flexion exercises
- Leg abduction or adduction against a resistance

- Isometric exercises
- Rapid changes of direction or position
- Uncontrolled twisting like in Russian Twists
- Exercise with a risk of falling or abdominal trauma
- Excessive and uncontrolled destabilisation techniques e.g. BOSU ball
- Developmental stretches, hip abduction or hip adduction exercises due to joint laxity

Posture During Pregnancy

During pregnancy, as the baby grows, there is an **increased tendency** toward forward flexion, lumbar hyperlordosis and thoracic

hyperkyphosis, leading to lower back and neck pain.

If this language is confusing to you, to put it simply: the upper back **leans forward** in a poor posture similar to office workers who spend all day at their desks. This needs to be corrected with a balanced number of back exercises.

The lower back **arches** (anterior pelvic tilt), which needs to be corrected by strengthening the Glutes and the Core.

Exercise should be adapted accordingly. But your Core and Glutes exercises need to be safely selected exercises during pregnancy, as not all are appropriate.

You must monitor for faintness, dizziness and nausea and be **prepared** to stop the session **immediately**.

Warm-up:

- Utilise mobility exercises
- Build any intensity of movement gradually to avoid any sudden changes in blood pressure
- Support stretch positions and take care not to exceed a comfortable range of motion

Cardiovascular Exercise:

- Use low to moderate intensity
- Use low impact exercises — the cross trainer is ideal
- Build and lower intensity more gradually

Muscular Fitness:

- Include exercises for the pelvic floor muscles
- Avoid supine (on back) and prone (on front) lying for pre-natal clients
- Avoid exercises that place a lot of pressure on the pelvic girdle (lunges, single leg movements, heavy squats, explosive jumping movements)
- Use movements related to everyday life
- Select comfortable starting positions
- Perform fewer repetitions
- Do not use heavy abdominal exercises — sit-ups, crunches or oblique cross-over type exercises are not appropriate here.
- Avoid twisting core work.
- Do not use Heavy Deep Squats or Heavy Lunges, or Side Lunges.

- Avoid wide Sumo Style Squats and Deadlifts
- Avoid high impact skipping

Say motivational things like: *"You're going to be the most fit pregnant lady ever — we're going to get you in amazing shape."*

Be super kind to these clients!

Cool-down and closing:

- Include specific relaxation work, some yoga stretches can be appropriate but not all.

- Use shorter-hold stretches to maintain rather than develop flexibility, go for around 10 seconds.

5 Tips To Avoid Abdominal Separation During Pregnancy

Studies find that 100% of women will see **some degree** of abdominal muscle separation after pregnancy. This is **natural** and not an injury.

This is called Diastasis Recti and happens because the growing baby stretches the abdominal wall and the two sides of your rectus abdominis separate slightly.

You cannot completely avoid this, but you can **minimize** how severe it becomes.

The correct ways to reduce risk involve exercising safely **during** pregnancy and are as follows:

Tip 1: Learn Safe Core Engagement & Breathing

When we exercise, especially using heavy weights, we tend to **brace** our core to handle the heavy weight. During pregnancy, we lift lighter weights to avoid heavy bracing entirely.

We still need to brace when using lighter weights, but in a subtle way, and the fact that we aren't lifting as heavy means we don't have to brace in an **extreme** manner.

When you tell someone to **brace** their core when lifting, there are two **extremes** that

people tend to default to that we want to avoid entirely, especially whilst pregnant.

The first extreme is sucking in the stomach in an extreme manner, like you are trying to fit in a pair of jeans that are too small and you are trying **suck** in your stomach so you can do the zip up.

Secondly, we have the **opposite**. Tensing your core so tight and pushing out your stomach as much as you can, as if you are bracing for a massive punch or impact.

During pregnancy, **correct** bracing is simply allowing yourself to brace without going to any of the above extremes.

When bracing, think of your breathing in **two** steps:

Inhaling - Let your belly expand naturally.
Don't suck in your stomach on the inhale.
Don't push out with force either, just breathe
naturally and allow for expansion across
your entire core.

Allow 360 degrees of expansion. This means
you should feel air expanding your stomach
outwards, your sides outwards, and your
lower back outwards.

Exhaling - Gently tighten your stomach a
little. Like your preparing for a light poke.

As you breathe out, gently lift the muscles
you'd use to stop passing wind or urine.

You aren't "squeezing" your pelvic floor muscles all the time like some people advise, you are **gently lifting** them on the exhale.

Whenever there is effort involved is when you exhale. Exhale on the effort.

To summarise, breathe in, let your belly expand. As you breathe out, gently tighten your stomach—like you're bracing for a light tap.

This helps to regulate your abdominal pressure and is important during pregnancy.

If an exercise causes you to be unable perform the above method of breathing correctly, forces you to hold your breath, or makes you **tense** your abdomen **more** than if you were bracing for a "light poke" then you are performing an exercise at an intensity that is too heavy for pregnancy.

Tip 2: Choosing Safe Core Exercises

We also have to choose safe core exercises.

Best options:

- Bird dogs
- Suitcase Carries
- Side Planks
- Side Leg Raises

Tip 3: Avoid High-Pressure Movements

These increase risk of worsening separation:

- Sit-ups / crunches
- Leg raises
- Planks (especially later stages)

- Twisting core exercises
- Heavy lifting with poor control
- Jumping

These movements create **too much intra-abdominal pressure**.

Tip 4: Watch For “Coning” Or “Doming”

If you see the stomach bulging or forming a ridge down the middle

That’s a sign of **too much pressure**. Stop or regress the exercise immediately

Tip 5: Strengthen Support Muscles

- Glutes
- Pelvic floor
- Deep core
- Upper Back
- Lower Back
- Rear Delts

This reduces strain on the abs and also maintains posture. Strengthening the muscles in these areas helps us to:

- Reduce over-arching (lordosis)
- Reduce rounding (kyphosis)
- Reduce upper back hunching forward
- Reduces pressure on the abdominal wall

Again, this is where the Face Pulls, and a variety of back and posture exercises are crucial.

To access a **specialized** programme for pregnant clients, visit achievegreatness.gumroad.com

After Birth:

Women should only **return** to exercise after their post-partum 6–8 week medical check. For caesarean deliveries, this extends to 12 weeks.

The return to exercise should be gradual.

High impact exercises, rapid changes of direction, and twisting movements should be **avoided** for at least 6 months after birth.

Crunches and sit-up type exercises are **not appropriate** in the immediate postnatal period.

Refer the client to a healthcare professional immediately if they experience any of the following post-birth:

- Stress incontinence (loss of bladder control) or pelvic floor weakness
- Dragging pain or heaviness in the lower abdominal or pelvic floor area
- Groin or low back pain or difficulty walking, even if only mild and intermittent
- Abdominal muscle weakness, umbilical hernia, abdominal muscle

separation or softness/sinking at the umbilical mid-line, excessive abdominal doming.

Post-partum programmes should **re-establish** joint stability, address muscular imbalances, and prioritise core and pelvic floor function. We have detailed post partum programs available at:

achievegreatness.gumroad.com

Young People (Ages 13–17)

Why is it that some people do exceptionally well at **inspiring** young people, whilst others fail completely?

I first pictured helping young people to be a challenge, but helping them to find a love for sport is **possible** once I learned a few tricks.

I can recall the story of a client of mine, Daniel. Daniel was a young man who dropped out of school due to constant **fighting**.

I first found him in a lonely 24 hour gym at night time on his own, shouting and swearing, powerfully hitting a punch bag with no gloves on...

He would smile ear to ear as he would talk about MMA to me, but he had been kicked out of most of the local martial arts gyms due to bad behavior.

I'm not sure quite why I got on well with training Daniel, I think I was addicted to the fiery energy of him saying he wanted to be the champion of the world one day, and the fact that we both happened to come to this 24 hour gym late to practice boxing. His parents didn't seem to be in his life much.

I got a great experience out of training Daniel, many people in this situation, would consider Daniel the most **difficult** type of young person to train. Kicked out of school, and lots of aggressive energy built up.

We often picture this type of young person who got kicked out of school to be very difficult to train, the type of person who is going to never listen, who avoids all the rules.

But, through my experience I learned a lot. I realised, most people look to control a young person when they train them, and are scared if they lose this control.

Young people are so full of energy, you can barely ever match them. Yes they will have focus issues, yes they will interrupt you and get excited, yes you will have to work to keep their focus.

Young people simply have an excited energy that will outmatch yours on many occasions. Instead of trying to control them or fight

against this energy, learn to roll with it, their excitement will show you what they truly are enjoying working on, focus on these areas and give them a say.

Don't worry about controlling them, don't worry about the short attention span...

Direct the hyperactivity of a young person towards a great workout, as long as they express a wish to train, you are on the right track.

Don't worry if they want to experiment with things slightly differently, or interrupt or like to bounce between many different topics.

As long as the hyperactivity is there, you can direct it towards working out and achieving great results.

It is actually more rewarding and fun to train a young person with unlimited energy and hyperactivity than it is to train someone who gives no effort.

Making those discoveries really helped me to train young people. I am going to give you 5 key tips to help you rapidly improve when training young people.

8 Tips To Train Young People

Tip 1: Adapt Your Training Style

Training styles must be adapted your training in a few subtle ways. If you, grasp these ways, you will do exceptionally well with young people.

Teenagers are in a transition phase — physically developing rapidly, mentally starting to think for themselves, emotionally more sensitive than they let on, and socially shaped heavily by their peers. Coaching them well means understanding all of that at once.

Teenagers are:

- Physically → developing rapidly
- Mentally → starting to think independently
- Emotionally → more sensitive than they show
- Socially → heavily influenced by peers

You need to tell young people they have a **bright future**. They are motivated by fun, praise, and belonging — not by the same analytics and outcomes that drive adults.

When you tell an adult that working out will help them lose body fat, sharpen their focus, improve their posture, and make them more competitive at work, they immediately see the value.

A teenager's world doesn't work like that. You have to think about *their* priorities — gaining **respect from their peers**, being seen as **strong** and capable at school. Fitness can genuinely help with those things, but you have to show them how.

Teenagers also don't need to understand the "why" we workout as deeply as adults do, but they still need some of it. What matters most

is giving them the *feeling* that they're improving, the feeling of enjoying sport, and the feeling of being believed in — including through failure. Lets look at the different age ranges:

Children (Instructor Coaching Style)

With really young people and children:
they aren't as much interested in the
“why.”

You hide the work they are to complete
inside fun challenges, games and
competitions, and let them use their
imagination, you turn things into an
imaginative game. You take an drill
instructors style and they will listen.

Teenagers (Collaborator Coaching Style)

You appeal to their sense of fun, and appeal to their sense of identity, it is a mix of the child and adult because they still need to have fun but they also start to care about the “why.”

You also have to appeal to their need to be independent and respected and this is through less of a “drill instructor” style and more of a collaborative approach that asks them what they would like to focus on and gives them choices.

Adults (Accountability Partner Coaching Style)

You show the work they need to do and explain the value. Adults are analytical and love to know the why. You tell them what they need to do without ordering them, and then you check up on them to make sure they are doing it and give them accountability.

Adults are more happy to work independently, and can be left to their own devices. You can set an adult homework, and give them more space to do things themselves, whereas kids and teenagers still look to you and need you for support.

Highlighted in the previous pages are **three different coaching styles**. The instructor, the collaborator, and the accountability partner. I hope you see how each age group warrants you to consider a different training approach.

With really young kids, you can be more of an instructor. They don't need the "why" as much, they need fun and you are more of an instructor. Your coaching style is more **instructional**.

Teenagers resist authority and don't like being shouted at and instructed. You have to form more of a "mentor" role and use a **collaborative** coaching style.

Involve them in **decisions**:

- “Which drill do you think will help your jab more?”
- “Do you want to focus on speed or power today?”
- “Is there a specific muscle or technique you want to improve on today?”

This helps with the fact that teenagers resist authority. Even asking them things such as:

“We’re pushing today—do you want to aim for 8 strong rounds or 10 with pace?”

Instead of: “right, we’re doing 10 rounds today.” This can be good when dealing with a rebellious type of teenager.

You give them more of a say in their development. You’re still leading—but they feel ownership.

To summarize:

With young children, you take an instructor's role. They aren't as interested in the "why" — they want fun. You hide the work inside challenges, games, and competitions, and let their imagination do the rest. You can take an **instructor** role where you tell them what to do and a child will listen, they need direct instructions.

With teenagers, it's a mix of the child and the adult. They still need fun, but they're starting to care about why things are done a certain way. They also need to feel respected and independent — so you shift from instructor to **collaborator**, giving them choices and asking what they want to focus on.

With adults, you explain the value and show them the work. You check in on them and hold them **accountable**. They love the "why" and respond well to directness. You give them more independence to do the work, unless they need more of a “drill instructor” style. You can often find a style that works best with an adult through communication and asking them, as they are old enough to know what they respond to and what they might need out of a coach.

Tip 2: Support The Deeper Emotions a Young Person Goes Through

What is a young person **really** asking? A young person isn't just asking whether they're the best. They're carrying a lot of questions they'd never say out loud:

- *Am I good?*
- *Where do I fit?*
- *Who am I becoming?*
- *Is it okay if I fail?*

When an adult makes a **mistake** in sport or in the gym, they've made thousands of mistakes before. They process failure with more maturity. You can be more direct with an adult, and they'll tend to be kinder to themselves.

A teenager **hasn't** been through that yet. Failure is still a new, raw feeling. When they mess up, the first thing they do is look to their coach to see how you **react** — to find out whether you're disappointed, whether you noticed the effort they put in, and whether it's okay to fail.

Everyone knows the feeling of missing a goal in front of their teammates. On top of the embarrassment, they feel like a **failure** and have no idea how to handle it.

That's why a lot of kids end up **walking away** from sport entirely — because they looked to their coach in those moments and found **nothing there**. They concluded they simply weren't good enough, and stopped trying.

A coach who nods back in those moments — who says the effort is what counts, who

explains that every miss is part of learning — shapes a completely different outcome. Young people need to be seen and noticed for **improving**, and for **effort** rather than just the times where they are the “star” or the best.

Reinforce this kind of identity:

“You’re disciplined”

“You’ve got heart”

“You don’t quit.”

“Failure is making you stronger”

That is key when coaching young people, instead of just highlighting the benefits

of sports and working out, or making them feel like they could be the best, you have to help them navigate through the emotions of failure, of looking for support when they fail, and feeling like sport is a positive thing.

You are going to shape the **type of person they become** if you coach them during this age period. Will they be the type who cheats to get ahead and win?

Or will they be the type to take a loss and play by the rules. Will they be a bad sportsman who gets angry at others? Or will they shake the hands of the other players and be a good sportsman who shows respect.

Will they miss a goal and get upset, or will they understand that to be the best, most players miss thousands upon thousands of goals, and that each failure brings them closer to a win.

Tip 3: Praise Effort And Improvement

Building from my last point, training young people requires an approach beyond just telling them they are naturals or “talented”. In fact, praising them for showing **effort** and **improvement** can be even more effective than recognizing them as having some innate talent or being the “star.”

When a young person does fail, they are navigating this feeling still. They may feel self

conscious, and often the first thing they do is look to their coach to see how they react.

They are looking to see things such as: if you aren't **proud** of them. To see if you notice their effort. To see if it's okay to fail.

When they **miss shots** at school, imagine this: they already deal with their friends frustrations making them feel like failures. They also feel like a failure.

That's why a lot of kids end up disliking sports, if they had a bad coach who they would look too in these moments of failure and failed to get **reassurance**, they would decide they truly were a failure and end up disliking sports.

Many have the experience of seeing the kids with the "natural talent" or the "star students" get praised often. But what is

more effective is to praise young people for the **effort** they put in, and a focus on how they are improving, even if they are not “the best” yet.

Some kids with good coaches and role models, will be able to process failures in a positive way, because they know and were taught that every failure is them practicing and every missed shot is one they **learn** from.

I always like to use the example of a young persons favorite football player or sportsman.

And then I **ask** them:

“How many goals do you think your favorite player had to miss, in private when no one was watching, to become the best at his sport?”

“Twice as much as anyone else and twice as early! By 10 years old, they had probably missed 10,000 goals.”

If you can give a young person the feeling of failing, but when they look at you as their coach, you nod back and explain to them that, it’s the effort that counted and it’s the effort you are proud of, they will be likely to develop a great attitude to sports.

Tip 4: Track and Show Improvements

Reward young people and show them after each session the ways that they **improved**, rather than just comparing them to the best.

Track them the same way you would track an adult.

Track lifts and **improvements** no matter how minor, their speeds and times, and **highlight** the wins to them.

They aren't just looking to be the best at this age, they are looking to enjoy sports and feel guided through a lot of emotions.

Imagine how many young people would have **stayed** in sport if their coach had said to them after a bad game: "listen you made a great effort, you have potential, come back next week!"

Tip 5: Show Consistency

Showing consistency and always being there to train a young person instead of being a "every once in a while" type of coach really helps with a younger age group.

Especially with youths from families that were **inconsistent** with them. They might feel like every one in their life just lets them down, so if you appear as consistent, always on time, and not letting them down, then they will trust you.

They will be likely to get into sport if coaching is always there for them, rather than you being a **part time** figure in their lives. Youths need consistency.

Tip 6: The Criticism Sandwich

Let's talk about how to provide **criticism**. When it comes to a young person, they need slightly less criticism than an older person. The way you criticise is important because a young person is more sensitive.

Remember I gave you the **technique** in an earlier chapter, where I told you to focus on praising someone before serving up the criticism?

Giving a person a positive first before a negative means they feel the balance of criticism and praise is equal and they are happy to hear you out.

Give young people even more **praise** than you would an adult. I actually use this technique with young people and I call it the **criticism sandwich** technique,

Picture it like this. The two pieces of bread are your positive remarks, I want you to think of criticism as the filling in the sandwich.

When you criticize an older person or an experienced athlete, you can get away with a

thickly filled sandwich. When you hand out a criticism sandwich to a young person, the filling must be very lightly spread.

The two pieces of bread are your positives. The filling is your **correction**. Keep the filling **light**.

"I really see you making an effort, and I love how you ran in and intercepted that ball — excellent work. When you got near goal, just shift the angle of your shot slightly left next time, because it was too wide. But the effort you made and the control you showed — that was great."

The criticism sandwich technique is good to use with a young person as it is good to give them an extra round of positivity at the end of your corrections.

A positive for a good start, criticism in the middle, and a positive remark to end on a high.

A note on criticism, when you deliver criticism, correct the action, not the person.

- Instead of: *"You're sloppy"*
- Use: *"That combo got a bit loose — tighten it up"*

Tip 7: Call Them In, Not Out

If someone is slacking:

Instead of: "Stop messing around"

You can use: "You're better than that—
what's going on?"

This invites accountability instead of
triggering ego

Instead of:

“Stop messing around or leave”

You say:

“You’ve got potential, but right now
you’re not showing it. What do you need
to get locked in?”

“Come on, are you in right now or are
you out? Show me the champion!”

This method is useful for **difficult**
teenagers. Young children allow you to
lead them and you can take full control of
9 times out of 10. With children, you set
the rules and correct them if they don’t

listen. You take a **drill instructor** type role, and what you say is non-negotiable.

With teenagers, their discipline is not based on just ordering them around. A teenagers discipline to you is negotiable.

They have to buy in.

“Calling in” instead of “calling out” can work well for teenagers.

When you call them in, try to avoid saying: “this is your session, if you don’t want to be here then go!” Instead challenge them to step up to the standard:

“You’ve got more than that. What’s going on? Show me your level this round. Are you in or out for your team? Are you serious about this championship?”

Tip 8: Respect

Teenage young people require you to respect their social world. Don't publicly embarrass them in front of others. It shuts them down and makes them not trust you.

Instead challenge them through private challenge: ““I know you've got more in you—prove it this round.” Respect to a teenager is very important. Don't use sarcasm or try to be their boss.

Understand teenagers can be loud, overconfident, and full of energy. Direct this energy towards focus and being the best, instead of challenging it.

Teenagers are more addicted to the feeling of improvement, and how working out can help them prosper in areas that teenagers focus

on such as respect from peers, improving themselves, improving their status at school and feeling strong, than “longevity, improved focus, looking aesthetic and attractive.”

Safely Training Young People

Young people are still developing their growth plates and are susceptible to growth plate fractures.

At around 15 years of age, weights may be introduced slowly.

In the first year of training, keep light weights and high repetitions. Use a young person's first year to learn the exercises and machines in the gym.

As young people are still going through growth spurts, you have to be careful when stretching them.

Stretch only to the point of **mild tension** and never over-stretch.

Powerlifting, bodybuilding, and maximal resistance lifts should be avoided until young people reach physical and skeletal maturity.

This means no one-rep maxes and no powerlifts. Try to encourage them to wait until the age of 18 before they attempt the above training methods.

As resistance machines in most gyms are designed for adult users, the weight increments will often be too great for young people.

Free weights and bodyweight exercises are generally the better choice as their safe and effective use is not determined by the size of the exerciser.

Further Tips:

- Give regular water breaks
- The warm-up component can be shorter than for adults
- The cool-down component can be shorter than for adults
- Monitor for signs of heat exhaustion and dehydration
- Drills last 3 minutes or less, due to shorter attention spans

- Anaerobic capacity isn't fully developed until age 20, so avoid heavy Zone 5 cardio sessions and never push to exhaustion

Final Summary

Teenagers don't just remember drills...

They remember:

- How you made them feel
- Whether you believed in them

- Whether you respected them

If you get this right, you're not just coaching fitness...

You're shaping confidence, discipline, and identity.

With patience, positivity and being able to select the correct coaching style for the correct age group, you can make a massive change to a young persons life.

That's the job.

Stroke and Neurological Conditions

Strokes, cerebral palsy and loss of limbs can result in asymmetrical weakness which means they can affect one side of the body more than the other.

The aim should be to strengthen the affected side as much as possible without neglecting the unaffected side.

If nerve control or tissue damage is very severe, the ability to improve the affected side will be very limited.

For progressive disorders such as multiple sclerosis — which worsen over time — careful monitoring is essential to ensure the exercise programme does not exacerbate the condition.

Muscular imbalances are common in people that have experienced a stroke.

This means that we can use unilateral exercises. **Unilateral** exercises simply means that we use exercises one limb at a time. Like one legged Squat exercises, or Bicep Curls with dumbbells doing one arm at a time.

Bilateral exercises are when you use both limbs at once. For example a Barbell Bench Press with both arms engaged.

When performing bilateral exercises such as a Barbell Bicep Curl, the stronger side will often compensate for the weaker side if a person has a muscular imbalance.

Adapt by switching the Barbell for Dumbbells to ensure equal distribution of weight.

There are different ways to do unilateral exercises. Some people will use a lighter weight with the affected side, and a heavier weight for the stronger side. So they will use dumbbells with a different weight in each hand.

I am not a fan of this method, because I find the imbalance remains. The side using the heavier dumbbell gets stronger, and the side using the lighter dumbbell gets stronger too, but the imbalance still remains.

Therefore, I like to use the same weight for both hands, and only when the client can safely perform the same weight in both hands, without losing balance, will they move on to the next weight.

This fixes the imbalance over time.

Wheelchair Users

Understanding the Individual First

Before anything else, remember that wheelchair users are not a single category. Some have full use of their upper body, core, and arms. Others may have limited grip strength, reduced trunk stability, or conditions that affect their endurance. Always assess the individual in front of you, not the wheelchair.

Find out:

- What is their condition, and is it stable or progressive?

- Do they have full upper body strength and control, or is there limitation there too?
- Are they a daily wheelchair user, or is the chair a recent change?
- What are their goals — general fitness, sport-specific training, rehabilitation, or independence?

Cardiovascular Training

Traditional cardio equipment will often be unsuitable. The rowing machine, treadmill, cross-trainer, and exercise bike all rely heavily on leg use and are not appropriate for most wheelchair users.

The arm cycle (upper body ergometer) is the most accessible and effective cardiovascular option available in most gyms.

It allows for sustained aerobic work, is adjustable in resistance and speed, and can be used directly from a wheelchair.

Other cardiovascular options to consider:

- **Seated boxing or shadow boxing** — great for heart rate, coordination, and upper body conditioning
- **Battle ropes** (seated) — explosive and cardiovascular, can be adapted to a chair
- **Wheelchair sport** — if the person has access to wheelchair basketball, tennis, or rugby, this is some of the best cardiovascular conditioning available

- **Outdoor training** — some gyms are simply not wheelchair accessible or are poorly laid out. An outdoor session in a suitable environment can remove these barriers entirely and adds variety. Don't underestimate the value of this option.

Resistance Training

Many resistance exercises can be adapted effectively for wheelchair users. Upper body and core strength are often the primary focus, and there is a lot to work with.

Suitable exercises typically include:

- Seated dumbbell press, lateral raises, front raises, and curls
- Resistance band exercises — highly versatile and portable

- Cable machine work — rows, pull-downs, face pulls, tricep pushdowns
- Chest press and shoulder press machines where the seat can be removed or the person can remain in their chair
- Seated core work where trunk stability allows — pallof press, cable rotations

Things to be mindful of:

- Many gym machines are designed for users sitting in a fixed seat. If the person remains in their wheelchair, check whether the machine's handles and cables are at a height that works for them

- Avoid exercises that could compromise balance or tip the wheelchair — always check the brakes are locked during any stationary exercise
- For users with limited grip, lifting straps or gloves can help

Posture and Muscle Imbalances

Wheelchair users often develop tightness through the chest and front of the shoulder due to the forward pushing motion of daily wheelchair use. Over time this can contribute to rounded shoulder posture and discomfort.

Prioritise pulling movements and posterior chain work where possible — rows, face pulls, and band pull-aparts help counterbalance this. Stretching through the chest and anterior shoulder is also worthwhile if the individual has the mobility for it.

Environment and Accessibility

Not all gyms are built equally when it comes to accessibility. Narrow corridors, heavy doors, equipment packed tightly together, and raised platforms all create genuine barriers.

If the gym environment is limited:

- Identify which areas and pieces of equipment are genuinely accessible

before the session, so time isn't wasted navigating on the day

- Consider outdoor training as a legitimate and often preferable option
- Resistance bands, dumbbells, and bodyweight work can all be done in more open, flexible spaces

Treat the environment as something you actively manage, not just a backdrop. Part of coaching a wheelchair user well is removing these barriers before they become frustrations.

Mindset and Coaching Approach

Everything covered in the broader coaching principles still applies here — the importance of tracking progress, focusing on what the person *can* do, and building their confidence alongside their fitness. A

wheelchair user is not defined by limitation. They are an athlete working within a specific set of parameters, the same as any other client.

Set goals, track improvements, and celebrate progress. The wins might look different — a heavier dumbbell, better endurance on the arm cycle, improved posture — but they are just as real.

Elderly Clients (65+)

Training style:

- Work at a slow, steady pace
- Do not explain everything at once — feed instructions gradually throughout the session

- Use slow, controlled repetitions and endurance-based sets of around 15 reps
- Keep your coaching voice calm and measured — no shouting or “hype”
- Take it easy on very hot days

Avoid with elderly clients:

- Heavy loading
- Powerlifting or strength-focused programming
- Explosive movements or jumping
- Any high-speed plyometric activity

The NHS recommends those over 65 should:

- Aim to be physically active every day — even light activity such as walking to the shops

- Incorporate exercises which improve strength, balance and flexibility — minimum 2 days a week
- Engage in 150 minutes of moderate intensity activity such as riding a bike, OR 75 minutes of vigorous intensity such as running — at least once per week. This can be split into 7 rounds of over 10 minutes across a week.
- Reduce time spent sitting or lying down by breaking it up with regular movement

Cardio for elderly clients:

- Switch from the Treadmill to the Cross Trainer — this gives a walking motion without the impact

- A spin bike in a standing position mimics the motion of jogging without the pounding of the feet on the floor can be used with elderly clients.
- If a client struggles with the rowing machine, build up to it using light, high-rep supersets of Leg Press and Seated Rows.

To hit your exercise targets per week as an Elderly person in bouts of over 10 minutes, a practical way would be to:

Vigorous Exercise: If you wish to use Vigorous Exercise as your preferred form of exercise. Then you can use running or any cardio machine that pushes you to your limit.

To reach 75 minutes a week, do 10 minutes per day for 7 days to reach your recommended 75 minutes, you will be 5 minutes short of 75 minutes so therefore to do one day on Sunday at 15 minutes.

Moderate Exercise - To reach 150 minutes through Moderate Exercise, you can do **Light Jogging, or Cycling** for 20 minutes daily for 7 days a week. Then on Sunday do 30 minutes to bring you to 150 minutes.

Light Exercise - Walking counts as Light Exercise. You can do 1 hour per day.

Note that there is a difference between Health and Fitness. Doing the 1 hour walk per day would be enough to keep you healthy.

As in generally keeping you alive with the minimum government guidelines.

However, fitness is where you are actually fit. You gain extra benefits to your metabolism, weight loss, your heart health, your lung health and overall this is where you want to be.

To get fit instead of just maintaining a “Healthy” body through simply walking an hour a day, you would be wise to mix up your approach and include some Moderate and Vigorous exercise.

Therefore I suggest you mix up your cardio. For example, you can do 2 days vigorous, 2 days moderate, and 3 days light.

This allows you to get a balanced and fit body, keeping you in the game longer and

enjoying more benefits, beyond just being “just healthy enough.”

Bodyweight Exercise Modifications:

These modifications allow older or less fit clients to participate fully in standard workout formats without feeling excluded.

- **Squats** — use a box, bench or chair to reduce the range of motion. Parallel bars can also provide a handrail to build up to unassisted squats
- **Burpees** — use a step or box to reduce the depth of movement and prevent falling to the floor
- **Press-ups** — lower to the knees, or perform against a wall or bench

- **Pull-ups** — begin with scapular pull-ups or bar hangs, progressing to assisted pull-ups on parallel bars

Motivating Elderly Clients:

Let them know they do not have to lose muscle or bone mass as they grow older. Bodybuilding is a fountain of youth. Yes, muscle deteriorates after our thirties, but if we train we can actually build **faster** than we lose it.

The actual difference in muscle-building capacity is around 10% in most cases — not the catastrophic gap most people imagine.

Elderly lifters are some of my **favorite** people to train, because most of them almost sell themselves the dream that they are “past

their prime” in a way that is a lot more exaggerated than the reality.

It is nice to help them see the reality of what they are capable of. The truth is the mind **tricks** them into thinking their body is around 10 times weaker than it actually is.

It's such an exaggerated number in their minds, until they actually push a session to completion and realise they aren't that far off from those half their age.

The warm ups, lifts and cardio sessions in this programme are specifically designed to build a balanced body for all ages.

The only things that change when you get older, are you rely less on the explosive and heavy lifting areas, and you lighten your rep ranges and reduce the number of sets slightly.

You must also work around any injuries you may have picked up.

You can stick to this programme as a lifelong programme, but you may wish to make small changes such as:

- Reducing or removing the power based cardio and weights sessions
 - Reducing explosive movements
 - Keeping the same exercises but reducing rep ranges from lower to higher.

Keep working out your whole body, as whatever you do not use you will most definitely loose. I have seen this first hand with many elderly people.

You can be the fittest, healthiest and strongest and the greatest version of yourself possible. That's what really matters.

Some people can even reach better than what they reached in their prime if they have better training now vs what they had when younger.

A key theme with elderly people is to never submit fully to the idea that you are “old now” and cannot be in great shape.

It is the reality that your body will not be as strong as in it's twenties, and that you may pick up some extra injuries, the push may become harder!

But if you look at the amount of people in their 50s and 60s that still have great bodies, we know that it is possible.

Accepting you aren't “done.” is very important. You build less muscle yes, by a few percent, you have less hormones yes, by a few percent.

But it is not by any means the
“insurmountable barrier” that you think it is.

There are those at 50 years old that are
running marathons and with 6 packs whilst
there are 25 year olds that are morbidly
obese and sitting in front of Netflix.

You can still be a superhero that people look
up to.

With the exception of being a college athlete
or a very heavy gym user in your twenties,
you can probably even gain more than the
younger version of yourself.

Especially in your 30s, 40s, and 50s, you
aren't anywhere near done yet.

Past 60s and 70s, you can still maintain with
a great attitude.

You can do anything you put your mind to.

One thing in common with the elderly people I see that were fit, is that they accepted a slight percentage difference for how hard it would be to maintain muscle mass and general health than when they were in their prime as a teenager.

But they didn't subscribe to the fact that this percentage was massive.

They did not subscribe to the idea that it was significantly harder or impossible, that they were “done” or it was now out of reach because of their age.

You can still reach a height that is incredibly high.

Setting Motivational Goals - SMART Goals

Setting your goals needs to be done correctly in order to do well for yourself in life. In personal training, I was taught to set goals using a system called SMART goals.

Specific — Measurable — Attainable —
Relevant — Timeframe

Specific

Setting specific goals is super important as it affects whether you will actually complete a task. This is scientifically proven. Let's say you got two people to write down their goals in journals.

Journal 1: *"I will lose weight."*

Journal 2: *"I will lose 2kg by the end of June, at a rate of 0.5kg per week. I will weigh myself weekly to measure this, and reduce my calories by 500 per day which I will track through the MyFitnessPal app."*

I will not eat out at restaurants until I achieve my target and I will go to the gym on Monday, Wednesday and Friday on the AG Full Body Men's programme."

Which person would you bet on to follow through? One person is holding themselves accountable and going into the specifics, visualising their success and the exact process they plan to take. One person is not.

A study took two groups of people. Both were asked to write down their monthly goals.

The first group wrote vague goals — *"I will start going to the gym"* — with no plan or detail.

The second group wrote their goals with the exact date, place, and time. Those with no plan were 35% likely to follow through.

Those with specific goals were 91% likely to follow through — nearly three times as likely.

Measurable:

Non-measurable: *To run a 5k quicker.*

Measurable: *Client is to reduce their 5k run time by at least 2 minutes. They currently run 5km in 24:09.*

Measurable is about writing down the unit you will use to track your goal. You can track your progress with a clear number or outcome.

For example the percentage increase in your run time, or the amount of repetitions you increase.

Measurable goals give you **clarity, direction, and motivation**, because you can see improvement over time.

Not every small task needs to be measurable. Simple actions like completing a chapter, booking appointments, or finishing daily tasks can just be done.

However, for **fitness, performance, and long-term goals**, making them measurable is essential for tracking progress and staying accountable.

"I want to lose 5lbs" is better than "I want to lose weight".

Attainable

The goal has to be realistic. There is no point setting goals too hard. Especially for people who are not confident, they do well to set themselves easy to hit “process goals.”

The type of short term goals they can easily do day to day to hit little wins and feel like they are achieving.

However, for a highly confident, self-assured individual, you can set your goals to be what I call "impossibly possible" goals.

These goals are just above the realms of realistic, but not impossible.

The logic is this: let's say I aimed to build my first website in 1 month, but it usually takes a beginner 3 months. I set 1 month as my goal and it ended up taking me 1.5 months.

The thing is that, by setting that “impossibly possible” goal, I pushed myself more, and still got there far quicker than if I had set a 3-month goal and relaxed.

Most people benefit from making goals challenging but realistic.

For clients with lower confidence however, set easier wins first and help them

understand that failure is data, not defeat.
Every champion has a long list of losses
behind their greatest achievements.

I found that if you set the goals slightly
higher, you usually nearly hit them, and do
more than what you could have done if you
didn't challenge yourself.

For this method to work you need to be the
type of person whose ego is not bruised
when you don't reach the goal, because you
are able to say to yourself:

“Well, by setting myself that big goal I got
there in half the time I would have if I set a
smaller goal. Even though I didn't hit my
goal it was still a win.”

You kind of need to know how to trick your
mind into doing things better, and if you are
the kind of person who doesn't need the ego

boost of quick and easy wins, this method can work for you.

Attainable Benchmarks:

- A sugar reduction of 5% over 3–6 months is considered clinically significant for an overweight client
- The average weight loss over a 3–6 month programme is around 3% of body weight for those who adhere to it
- Weight loss of 10% of total body weight is considered the upper limit of what is safely expected
- Losing 0.5kg per week is more realistic for most people than 1kg per week

Relevant

Is the goal relevant? For example if your client just wants to tone up slightly:

Not Relevant: Coach sets goal for client to wake up at 5am every day and complete long, intense workouts

Relevant: Coach sets goal for client to train 3–4 times per week with manageable, moderate sessions

Timeframe:

Goals should have a clear time frame and date for completion.

- Non-time-bound: Client is to fit into a size 32-inch waist pair of jeans.

- Time-bound: Client is to fit into a size 32-inch waist pair of jeans within the next 3 months.

Organise Tasks In Order Of Importance

You have to organize your tasks in order of importance and in order of how effective they will be to move you forward.

Humans are the masters of doing tasks and seeming busy, spending hours on things that don't even matter.

There is a difference between being **busy** and being **productive**.

Organise your goals in order or importance for the day.

Complete the most important first. Only focus on the goals that get you to your end result.

Ask yourself as many times per day as possible if the goal you are completing now is the most relevant

Cleaning out your email inbox is just “seeming busy” and not the most practical task when the rent is due and making sales calls is the difference between your business surviving or not.

There's no point doing a task such as setting up a new 2nd product to your business, when the first product hasn't been released and making you money yet.

There's no point going to basic fitness classes working bodyweight squats and

cardio if your goal is muscle gain and aesthetics.

You need to lift heavy and complete the “bang for your buck” targets that move you forward the most.

Get everything out the way that prevents you from moving forward the most and will have the biggest impact on progress.

Process goals are short-term goals that build new habits. Part of your daily or weekly process.

Product goals are long term project-based goals with firm deadlines — the qualification you need for a promotion, the workout plan you need to complete to reach 10% body fat in 4 months. A good goals list has a mix of both.

Process goal examples:

- I will go out for a 10-minute walk each lunchtime this week
- I will prepare a salad to take to work for lunch every day this week
- I will attend two supervised exercise sessions this week
- I will shop online and not order any chocolate this week
- I will not take cash to work, to stop myself using the vending machine

Product goal examples:

- Grow your Instagram page to 1,000 followers
- Save 3000 pounds in 4 months for a new car

- Create your business portfolio and upload it to the internet
- Create your company logo

Long and Short Term Goals

“The journey of a thousand miles begins with a single step.”

It is important to break your longer term goals into shorter goals. The quote above talks about a long journey to greatness beginning with a “single step”.

Smaller steps are easier for us to process and allow us to take our longer goals and tackle them in smaller chunks.

It is easier to take the smaller steps, and one day they will compound into our large goal becoming a reality.

Break your journey into smaller, manageable time frames. This makes the long-term goal far more attainable.

I set my goals into Short, Medium and Long Term Goals. And to simplify what I am about to say:

Short term = Daily and Weekly Goals

These are your to-do lists, daily tasks, and habit tracker goals. These are mainly process goals which are small,

achievable goals that slowly move you closer to your end goal.

Medium term = Monthly Goals

Breaking longer goals into bite-sized monthly chunks is extremely effective. These are the hurdles you **have** to clear as you go down the path of achieving your long term goal.

Long Term = 6 Months +

These are monthly or even yearly goals. These are your final end results for what you want to accomplish in 6 months to a year down the line.

I organise my short term goals on things like the notes page on my mobile phone.

To track my monthly and yearly goals, I have a month by month sheet on Notion, which I write down my goals on each month and tick off with a tick emoji when I finish them.

Any goals that don't get finished in that month get moved over to the next month.

Say What You Want, Not What You Want To Avoid

Never focus on the negative things you don't want to happen to yourself when setting goals!

Always focus on the positive things you do want to happen when setting goals.

Rather than “I won’t get fatter” , say “I will improve my body fat percentage by 5%.”

Instead of “I won’t get any weaker in the gym.”

Why not:

“I will maintain my numbers when it comes to my weight lifted in my gym sessions and also try to improve at 3 different lifts this month, in order to hopefully improve as well as maintain!”

Picture always positive outcomes that you **want** and never frame your goals in a negative way when it comes to goal setting.

Full SMART goal example:

Goal: To reduce overall body mass by 1 stone, from 14 stone to 13 stone, in 3 months.

- S — To lose 1 stone of weight, from 14 stone to 13 stone.
- M — Measure weight loss using the scales every 2 weeks at a rate of 0.5kg a week.
- A — Achieved by going to the gym 3 times per week and switching

unhealthy snacks for healthy alternatives.

- R — Relevant as it will help the client achieve safe and effective weight loss.
- T — Target is 3 months from today.

Setting Goals — The Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Ask the client their final, endpoint goal. This is their long-term goal.

Step 2: Consider all the things that would support your client to achieve that long-term goal.

Step 3: Decide which of those supporting goals is most appropriate and most effective.

These become the short and medium-term goals.

Step 4: Write the short, medium and long-term SMART goals down. The client keeps a copy. Goals should be stored somewhere visible and easily accessible — a journal, a wall, a Notion page, a Canva PDF.

Step 5: Set reminders:

- Monday to review the week's goals
- Mid-month to check monthly progress
- End of month to reflect and reset

First Allow A Person To Set Their Own Goals

Before you chime in with what you think another person's goals should be, first allow the person to set their own goals —

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psychological research tells us that **humans do not like being told what to do.**

Clients who set their own goals are far more likely to buy in. If you see anything you would change, you can explain why you would make the change.

Help them make goals more specific, realistic, and time-bound.

After first asking them for their own goals, then you can try and **suggest** some, this makes the person feel heard and understood.

Back these goals up with imagery, encourage clients to visualise how they will look and feel when they reach their goals. Mental imagery makes the process much more real.

Open Questions To Engage Someone On Their Goals

- *"Where would you say you are now in relation to your goals?"*
- *"Where would you like to be?"*
- *"How would it feel if you were there already?"*
- *"What help might you need to get you to where you would like to be?"*

The Main Reasons People Drop Out Of Exercise And Improving Themselves, & How To Fix It

Why is it that some people seem to stick to positive habits and routines for years, whilst

others barely last a week? We are going to cover a variety of reasons below.

- **Boredom** — This is a big reason. We live in a world where instant gratification activities are readily available. Exciting parties, TV shows, social media scrolling and video games provide us with instant doses of excitement.

But these things aren't the best for us **long term**. Something like the gym is healthy and can be fun, but it can take some time to build up a love for it. We are also battling against spending our time in the gym, versus the temptation to spend our time on all these other less healthy things we could be doing. How do we combat this? Provide variety. Constantly be learning new

skills, attending new gyms, and trying new sports.

Learn every machine and piece of cardio equipment in the gym.

Change your programme ever so slightly every four to eight weeks. A client who is always learning something new will not get bored.

If you are finding your gym routine **boring**, combine going to the gym with something you do like. Bring your favorite show or a new movie to watch on the treadmill.

Do your **favorite** sport for cardio. I'm not advocating drinking, but if you were going to have a beer or two at home, why not go to the outdoor workout park? Even though I don't

recommend that lifestyle, I've known a few people who would come to the outdoor workout park, and have a beer or two after they finish their workout in the sunshine!

My point is there are numerous techniques, combine the gym with some things you **do** like, and add variety to what you practice in the gym and the sports you experiment with.

- **Lack of improvement** —When it comes to a lack of improvement, it's obvious it would cause someone to consider giving up. Remind the person that your own transformation did not happen overnight. Gains can be slow at first, but a good programme makes this unlikely long-term.

Gains simply take **time**. Fitness is a marathon and not a sprint and anyone you look up to, if they are natural and not a social media influencer on drugs, has worked out for a lot longer than you think to get an amazing body.

Explain your own experience with fitness. The thing with fitness is that progress goes up and down.

Progress generally trends **upwards** if you are on the **correct** programme, however, one year you may be focusing on bringing up your chest. The next your shoulders.

Some areas will slip back down as you focus your targets elsewhere, you are constantly trying to bring up weak points at the cost of other muscles.

Seeing a muscle slip or **losing** a skill as you spent a few months training yourself towards a specific muscle group can be **disheartening** to those who don't know the game of fitness.

But those that understand what it truly takes to build a naturally strong body will understand it is simply **part of the process** and continue working on their body.

This process can go on for **years** until you finally build the body of your dreams. That's totally normal and expected. I know that **even I** sometimes lose skills like the muscle ups, or get really good at my Dumbbell Presses at the expense of my Barbell Presses.

However, you want to **minimize** slow results as much as possible. You want to be making solid progress as that will keep you happy in the gym.

They call it bodybuilding because you actually want to feel that you are **building** your body.

Being on a good programme like my AG programme will help with the feeling of lack of improvement.

- **Stalling progress** — Remind your client that progress in fitness is not linear. Bodies are constantly changing.

One year you may grow your triceps but your chest may shrink. Over five years however, the gains **compound** enormously. There will come a time where you bring everything up to a

sufficient level and simply have to maintain.

Your client is **never** back to square one. They are always one well-structured programme away from looking amazing. Help them to find that programme.

Try and bring up **everything** at once on a great programme with great consistency.

Also, progress can be tracked in different ways. Try to create a **win** everytime you enter the gym.

If you didn't hit a record on your first exercise, hit one on a later exercise.

If you don't manage to hit a higher number on your first few sets, hit a

total weight lifted personal record instead and hit more lighter sets on the back end.

Try a new superset out or learn a new skill. Every time I have been to the gym, some kind of personal record has been beatable if I look hard enough for it.

- **Lack of time** — Make it easy. Provide home workouts. Create sessions you can do in your living room in 30 minutes. Do the 30 minute AG workout sessions in the gym, focus on weights, no cardio, just hit one or two records and go home.

Doing this 3 times a week with a good protein intake might not get you an

elite body, but it can get you pretty far above an average person.

- **Unable to break old habits (smoking, drinking)** — Encourage this person to go “all in” on their health.

Half-commitment produces half-results.

If this person can make a full commitment — cutting everything that holds them back — the transformation will be unlike **anything** they have experienced.

Provide them with resources to quit, see if they can commit to the habit only on specific days of the week first, and slowly cut that number down.

Part 2 - Life Coaching

Motivating People Beyond Fitness - Teachings Of A Life Coach

The **second** part of this book is going to give you ways you can work through common life & mindset issues that are beyond fitness.

These are to do with mentality, which is super important.

I hope these techniques help either you, or help you to help someone else, these can really make a difference **beyond** a persons physical health.

Health is not just in the body, but in the **mind** too.

Self Talk / Self Image

“A man cannot rise above how he sees himself.”

“A woman cannot rise above how she sees herself.”

James Smith grew up in a family that owned land, built businesses, and won often. James grew up in an environment where success wasn't just encouraged—it moved around him daily. The gates of his family's estate would open each morning, revealing a long driveway leading up to a house that felt more like a castle than a home.

Conversations about business and growth were constantly happening around him. At

the dinner table, his father didn't speak in hopes or possibilities, but in certainty.

"You're a Smith. Winning is what we do. Coming first is what we do.

This wasn't arrogance. It was certainty. It was permission. By age seven, James didn't wonder if he could achieve things—he assumed he could. His ceiling wasn't set by his talent. It was set by his belief.

Now consider someone else. Let's call him David. He grew up in a family that valued hard work, honesty, and humility. His parents worked steady jobs. They didn't aim high because they believed "people like us don't." At the dinner table, the message was quieter, but it landed just as hard: "We're not entrepreneurs. We're regular people. We survive. We settle. That's just who we are.

David wasn't told he was incapable. He was never explicitly discouraged. But he was never *encouraged* to be confident, to be outspoken, to consider himself the best at anything. His family called it humility. It was actually permission denied.

By age twenty-five, James had attempted five business ideas and failed twice. He kept trying because his self-image said: "Smiths succeed eventually." David had the same potential, the same intelligence, maybe even better instincts. But he never started the first business because his self-image said: "People like me don't do that."

The brutal truth: James's advantage wasn't money or connections. It was *belief*.

His family installed a self-image of capability so early that it became invisible to him. He didn't think about whether he could win—he just assumed it.

David's family accidentally installed the opposite. They weren't cruel by any means. They were just limited in what they could imagine for him. And he inherited that limitation.

Here's what matters: **Your self-image isn't fixed. It was installed. And it can be reinstalled.** We usually inherit our self talk (the way we talk about ourselves) and our self esteem from past experiences and it usually starts from the childhood.

Maybe you grew up like James—granted permission to believe in yourself, told you

could do anything, surrounded by people who hyped you up. If so, you're ahead. But many of you grew up like David. You were taught humility when you needed ambition. You were taught to settle when you needed to aim. Your family called it wisdom. It was actually fear disguised as modesty.

In today's world, that exact confidence—that self-belief, that willingness to call yourself the best and *mean it*—is often the only difference between people who change their lives and people who stay stuck. This section will help you to build your self-image.

4 Steps To Improve Your Self Image

Tip 1: Do Things For Your Future Self

The act of doing things for your future self is very good for building up self love. Even the process of staying consistent with what you say you will do, can help you in the process of building self love.

Everytime you stick to your workout, everytime you complete an entire day where you have done everything in your habit tracker, every time you complete positive habits that the you in 5 years time is going to thank you for, you are building self love and self esteem.

Tip 2: Speak To Yourself Kindly

There is one promise that is the most impactful promise you could make to yourself when it comes to fixing your self esteem. The promise to always speak to yourself kindly, even if sometimes others don't.

The way you speak to yourself matters.
Promise to always speak to yourself kindly.

I've created a self talk audio for you to hear the type of things you should be saying to yourself. You can access it at achievegreatness.gumroad.com

Things like positive affirmations when you get up in the morning can really help. In

terms of how you speak to yourself, you never want to tell yourself things like:

- *“I can’t” do something.*
- *I’m bad at this.*
- *This is impossible.*

The idea behind “positive self talk” is that you shouldn't really be saying anything negative about yourself at all.

The only time I really say negative things about myself is when I answer what my weaknesses are in a job interview, and it’s always with the strong belief that I will conquer that weakness one day.

In my first book in this series, I explained how those that are unbreakably confident and a measure above average in terms of

being self assured, are the people that win in life.

The balance to strike is that you should speak to yourself so kindly, and hype yourself up so much, to where it may sound slightly cocky if someone else was to hear you.

Even if you are a humble person, you want to be slightly above average and ideally a good measure above average in terms of your self confidence.

I'm not saying you have to go and shout that you're the best at everything so that the whole street can hear, that would annoy people. But in terms of how you speak to yourself in private, you should definitely think you're the best and that there's no one

greater. That's what strong self talk looks like.

Get used to speaking to yourself in a positive and extremely confident light. There's something about faking it until you make it that will eventually allow you to become this person.

Good self talk sounds like:

- I'm the best.
- I'm the strongest.
- I love myself so much.
- If I can't do something, I will learn how to do it and become the best at it.
- I have potential to be good at anything I put my mind to.
- I am a quick learner and can make the best out of any situation.

Any time you detect a weakness in yourself, you should affirm to yourself that you have the potential to become great in this area. Work on it. Learn to hype yourself up, as if you are already the best at it. Never let someone else dictate what you are good at!

There's always an opposite angle to your weaknesses. Find it! Maybe you mess up a lot on a particular combo in your boxing class.

Almost hype yourself up to yourself as though you are becoming the best and don't let anyone laugh at you. Remain strong willed.

Either your the best at something if you are good at it.

Or you have the **potential** to be the best if you currently aren't good at it. There's never any : "I can't" involved in your self-talk.

Find reasons why your the best at everything even if everyone else would question It. Find reasons to have supreme confidence at everything you do, and don't let anyone take it away from you. Craft a character that is unbreakable.

Even when you deep down know you aren't the champion of the world at something, for the sake of positive self talk, you can humorously say you will get there one day.

And lets be real, its healthy and self assured to beleive that if you truly worked hard and gave your all to most things in life, you could achieve them.

So set your goals high even if you know you are slightly far off and believe you are the best. You don't have to be a narcissist, but if you don't talk to yourself nicely and believe you can do anything, who else is going to?

Tip 3 - Protect Your Standards

Self-esteem is built by what you **tolerate**. What you allow into your life teaches your mind what you believe you deserve. If you stay in poor relationships, disrespect, toxic environments, and self-sabotaging habits, you will start to lower your self esteem.

Every time you accept **less** than your standards, you lower your internal value. Raise your standards.

Protect your peace. Walk away from what weakens your identity.

You can actually build self esteem by walking away from situations that don't serve you. Especially when you walk away from disrespectful situations, such as relationships, you can boost your self esteem and self love by so much.

Self esteem can also be boosted simply by removing yourself from negative people in your life who break you down, and by spending time with those that build you up. It sounds obvious, but spending time with those who see the best in you, can really boost your self esteem.

Even someone else telling you "you can do this." or seeing potential in your personality

or talent, can boost your self esteem. Surround yourself with people that build you up and walk away from people who don't respect who you truly are.

Tip 4 - Reminders Of Greatness

Reminders are a super effective tool. Keep a journal of any successful moments you had. Or even keep a notes page of reminders on your phone , with all of your wins, successful moments, strengths and the kind, respectful, positive things people said to you.

Keep reminders of anytime someone noticed greatness or potential within you. Anytime someone said you were good or great at something. You can look back on this list anytime you doubt yourself.

Tip 5: Journaling Exercise For Improving Self Image

Step 1: Read the chapter in my first book entitled Dream Life Exercise. Or visit achievegreatness.gumroad.com and download the “Dream Life Exercise” PDF.

Step 2: Use the PDF prompts to journal your dream life in vivid detail.

Step 3: Journal the type of person you need to become to achieve this dream life. This is going to give you clarity on the ideal version of yourself that you will need to become in order to achieve your goals.

Step 4: Form a table with a line down the middle. On the left side of the table, journal the answers to these two questions:

“Is there anything you were constantly brought up to believe that would get in the way of becoming the person who would achieve your dream life?”

“What went on in my life that is the reason why my self esteem isn’t as high as it could be?”

Step 5: On the right hand side of the table, write the ways your dream character would likely think about these things. The opinions they would have. It’s likely they would think the total opposite.

Spend some time going through each reason on the left hand side of the table (reasons why you have low self esteem) and then on the right construct the opposite view, the view that the most successful version of yourself would have.

Challenge those thoughts on the left and identify the positive ways your dream character would act instead.

How To Improve Your Self Love In 20 Minutes

I wanted to go into further detail on this topic, so here are 7 further tips to help you to improve your self love.

1: Self Love Journalling Prompt

When you journal in the morning as part of your routine, instead of doing your gratitude journal and writing 3 things you are grateful for, switch it up for two weeks.

Write down **3 things you love about yourself** in your journal instead.

2: Self Love Journalling Idea 2

Write down every morning:

- One thing you love about your body
- One thing you love about your personality
- One thing you love about what you have accomplished

3: Self Love Journaling Idea 3

Write down every morning for a week:

- 10 ways I'm the best and 10 strengths.

4: Write A Love Letter To Yourself

Write a letter to yourself, thanking yourself and explaining how much you love yourself.

Maybe you love yourself for staying consistent. For always believing in yourself.

Maybe you love yourself for the work you put in a few years ago that got you to where you are now.

Really sit and think, and eventually the words will flow out onto the page, and you

will realise there is a lot you love about yourself.

5: Speak To Yourself With Love and Respect

Talk to yourself only with love and respect.

Repeat the affirmations:

“I am as precious as any other person.”

“I am going to be the greatest of all time.”

6: Achieve the Body You Actually Want

“Become the person you said you were going to be.”

This is going to help you to love yourself a whole lot more. Work with a trainer or seek mentorship, and simply stay consistent every day with your fitness until you love your body.

7: Look Good, Smell Good Everyday

Keep your hair cut and everything nicely shaven.

A small step, but I do this a lot. Even if I am not going out anywhere nice, I still shave and wear cologne.

It is simply the habit of someone that loves themselves to look after themselves. Never let this slip, even though it seems like a small thing.

If you read the *Self Esteem Workbook* by Glenn R, you realise that grooming yourself and dressing well works very well for this kind of thing.

There's something about holding yourself to a high standard that just **works**.

Final Thoughts On Self Love / Self Esteem

Self-esteem is really **valuable** to build. It helps you develop real confidence and move through life in a stronger way.

There will be moments where you have to build yourself up, hype yourself up, and stay mentally sharp to secure a bright future.

Positive self-talk and a strong self-image are what help you do that.

A lot of people focus on solving mental barriers such as depression or anxiety, and then focus on getting into shape. And yes, that takes them maybe 60% of the way to a good life.

But you can still feel **negative** even when all of that is in place.

Confidence, self-love, believing in your ability to do anything—to lead, to inspire, to create the life you want—that’s where you start to live a full life. Life opens up after you reach this level.

Being “not depressed” or “not anxious,” is really just the **baseline**. And I can relate to that, because sometimes life throws us a

curveball and we have to take things back to basics.

Everything could be going great, and then something goes wrong and we have that bad day again where we feel like we are back to **square** one. This can happen thousands of times over the course of our life.

But when we do bounce back, the goal is more than just settling for “OK.”

The bare **minimum** won’t drive you to the life you really want to live. We all want to feel fulfilled and happy beyond just surviving.

We want to genuinely love ourselves and work towards **supreme** confidence in all that we do. Imagine living with self love consistently, year-round.

The difference between people who actually build this life and those who don't is simple: **action**. Daily action.

If you struggle with self love or the way you talk to yourself, then start taking **action** and begin the exercises I've shown you.

That's what's going to move you toward a better version of yourself. It takes practice and time.

Once you take that step in the right direction with your self-talk, and once you learn how to build up self-love and maintain it, you start to feel **amazing**.

Learning to be friends with yourself and not enemies with yourself is an amazing skill to have. Hype yourself up in times of great difficulty. Know how to have a sense of humor when things don't go your way, and

don't let things knock you into believing you are not capable of the very best.

You will eventually find it hard to go back to negative self talk because you will love the feeling of being your own number one supporter.

Whenever you need a boost, the exercises above and the way you speak to yourself will be what bring you back into alignment with your true self.

Depression

Depression is a tough area to coach, because it can have many potential causes. With most other life coaching issues, there are a

handful of key fixes I know will reliably work. Depression is different. It rarely bends to a single solution.

People often need to apply multiple lifestyle habits and mindset shifts — and crucially, get all of them working together at once — before they see lasting change. That process takes time. But it is absolutely worth it.

Therapy and medication are legitimate options for many people, and the first step should always be a conversation with a medical professional. What I want to talk about here is everything that sits alongside that. Because medicine is one piece of the puzzle — an important one — but it is not the whole picture. The small habits we build to achieve greatness into our daily lives are just as important as anything a doctor can prescribe.

Depression can often be understood as a case of more things going wrong in your life than right. More negative inputs than positive ones. And that means it can be shifted — not overnight, and not with one magic fix, but through the consistent, deliberate stacking of better choices.

Even if your routine is flawless, life will still occasionally throw something at you that knocks you sideways. Trauma doesn't care how many self-help books you've read or how perfect your routine is. That is OK and happens from time to time. It happens to the best of us.

But when we follow specific success strategies to build positive momentum into our lives, not only do we achieve happiness and minimize day to day chances of depression, but we have the best chance of successfully navigating those truly difficult

moments in life, and the bounce back is a lot easier.

You would be surprised how fast a bounce back could be when the correct areas are addressed.

Depression is so complex precisely because the causes are so varied and so personal — but I have found that once those causes are genuinely identified and addressed, depression can resolve itself faster than people expect.

Sometimes it happens in a matter of days, usually in cases where negative life circumstances suddenly improve. Other times, it takes longer to feel fully yourself again, in a slow build up of positive habits and lifestyle changes.

Both are normal. Whether it's trauma, poor lifestyle, a lack of purpose or confidence, some way, some how, you can figure out a way to grow. You can figure out the right way to live your life and achieve happiness.

What follows are the principles I return to again and again with clients. Apply them. Stack them. Give them time. And you will learn what it takes to motivate yourself day in, day out, week after week, month after month, year after year against any symptoms that don't serve you in life.

Wake up every day and apply your best foot forward, and you will land exactly where you need to be.

10 Tips To Help With Depression

Tip 1: Depression Is A Case Of Positive Momentum

You cannot fully protect yourself from the fact that life, at times, will be brutal. That is simply the deal.

“We can never 100% protect ourselves from the fact that sometimes, life can throw us one big roller coaster ride that causes our mental health to slip.”

But mental health is about momentum — and momentum can be built.

If you invest consistently in positive habits and daily self-care, what you are really doing is charging a reserve battery. So when the

hard times hit — and they will — you have something to draw from. You are not starting from zero. You have 200 days of solid **routine** behind you, and habits that have been wired in don't simply vanish the moment things get difficult.

Think about it this way: if you have one terrible day in a week, but the other six days were lived well — exercise, purpose, connection, discipline — how much damage can that one bad day really do? You stay afloat. More than afloat.

If you build positive momentum so far in one direction, choosing to be consistent with positive habits and self care daily, then when the negative life events happen, you have so much **positive momentum** built up in your life, that you are able to stay positive.

Essentially your battery of positivity is fully charged, it might get drained down to 70 or

80%, but because you are fully charged, and full of forward momentum, you won't hit 0% and shut down.

Outside of genuine unresolved trauma, serious grief, or severe life circumstances, I have found that depression is — at its core — largely a **lifestyle** issue. That is not a dismissal. That is actually good news. Because lifestyle can be changed.

Let's build yours into something that makes depression hard to sustain.

Tip 2: Setting Up Your Lifestyle To Be Depression Proof

If someone doesn't go to the gym for a few days, doesn't practice positive habits,

doesn't have a good routine, stays indoors all the time, smokes drinks or uses drugs, they are **very likely** to tell me they are depressed.

They often tell me they are only drinking, smoking, and staying indoors because they are depressed. But really, it is because they are doing these things that they are depressed.

They create an endless cycle within themselves.

The fix is this:

- Direct the person / yourself away from substance use.

- Directing the person/ yourself to a healthy diet.
- Direct the person / yourself to work out daily. BOTH Cardio and Weight Training
- Direct the person / yourself to leave the house daily.
- Directing the person towards a habit tracker, ideally with 4 non negotiable habits of:
 - Reading 1 page minimum daily.
 - Meditation 1 minute minimum daily.
 - Exercise in any form daily, even the bare minimum.
 - Gratitude Journalling Daily (3 things you are grateful for)

- Direct the person / yourself towards a positive morning and evening routine where there is an established ritual of gratitude or positive self talk. For example, gratitude journaling in the morning, and then in the evening time there is the option for positive manifestations and listening to a positive self talk audios.
- Direct the person to consume positive things, positive music, and great self help books.
- Construct an audit of what you / they actually follow on Instagram, what you / they watch and consume in spare time. Limit anything negative that doesn't serve positive thinking.

This is all scientifically proven tips that when added together, form the basis of a very positive routine that will benefit mental health and reduce the chances of depression.

Tip 3: Find Your Purpose

If a person tells me they **hate** their job, they will likely also tell me they are depressed. Depression can be an issue with a Lack Of Purpose.

I encourage a person to find their purpose and work towards a consistent job in a field they love. This can be a **big** win.

I have actually created an entire separate section on Lack Of Purpose as I felt it was

deserving of more detail. See the section on “Lack Of Purpose” for valuable insights on how to deal with this issue.

If a person starts a new course, a new **direction** in life, a new university degree or a new start in a new area, I have found their depression can almost **disappear** overnight. They get excited and engaged with a new chapter in their life!

Do not doubt the power of **committing** and **applying** yourself to something new.

Sometimes it's that feeling of waking up excited, following a new dream or purpose, that can completely remove depression from your mind.

Challenging yourself to be a better person, and employing yourself in something where

everyday you are busy following your dreams, can really help.

“Purpose is rocket fuel. working towards something you believe in, something that challenges you, something that feels like it matters — is one of the most powerful antidepressants in existence.”

It is scientifically proven that those who stay **busy** in their day to day, as long as they are working balanced shifts with a reasonable job satisfaction, are less likely to have depression than someone staying at home with no employment or daily goal.

Humans have a need for relaxation and self care at times, however:

We do not want to sit down with no purpose and do nothing!

Many scientists find that what is even **more likely** to help with depression than even a job with a medium high satisfaction, is a high satisfaction job working towards achieving your dreams that you are confident you have been put on this planet to do.

Seek to find **this**, and getting up out of bed in the morning becomes easier, and the days become full of joy and even though there is hard work to be done.

General life satisfaction, knowing where you are going in life, and being **self assured** of your life vision, is one of the best things you can do to destroy any negative forms of doubt, overthinking and depressed states of mind.

Tip 4: Become A Person Of Your Word

I would always encourage depressed clients to become people of their word. This can **really** help. Setting yourself targets and being a person of your word and fulfilling them can help you a lot.

This builds up an **identity** within you of being **strong**. The more you find yourself sticking to your word, the more you say you're going to do something and you **truly** believe it.

You end up becoming someone who says they are going to do something and then does it, and this brings a very **powerful** feeling.

You begin to hold yourself in **high regard**, and love yourself, and believe you can do things. And this is deeply connected to

depression, because at the core of a lot of depression is a person who has stopped believing they are **capable**.

They don't trust themselves anymore. So when you start becoming a person of your word, you start to **trust** yourself as a person who can actually conquer the challenge of depression too.

This act can even build **self love**, you believe in yourself and don't ever see yourself as a failure. You believe in your ability to get things done.

This is all great, even for helping you believe in your ability that you will bounce back and do the work to gain control of your mental state again.

Tip 5: Regular Movement

Move your body, and construct your life in ways that this is a regular occurrence.

Regular exercise has effects comparable to medication for depression. I myself, as a very positive person in a good place in my life, would still likely feel a minor depression coming on if I didn't workout for more than a week.

“Your body is designed to be used. When it isn't, it communicates that clearly.”

Even 30 minutes to 1 hour of Zone 2 exercise per day, is enough to act as an antidepressant. Zone 2 exercise is where you go to about a 7 out of 10 intensity.

Essentially a light jog that somewhat challenges you, but doesn't **exhaust** you, for half an hour a day.

Zone 2 exercise is great. But what is even more important is weight training. If you add in weight training as well, you are doing something further for your body.

Weight training is going to release **hormones** within your body. This is the style of training that when you miss for more than a week, you start to feel that slow, sluggish, tired feeling.

You start to feel something is wrong. If you don't believe me, try it. Commit to the gym for 6 months, become a regular goer of the gym, and then try to not weight train for 2 weeks straight. You will feel a difference.

Start with light movement, and continue to build your intensity daily.

Tip 6: Seek Social Connection

Direct yourself to a social life. Seek social connection **even when you don't want to**. There will be many times you don't want to.

In this situation, repeat to yourself: "Make the effort."

Humans are **wired** for connection.

Depression thrives on isolation. Seek out friends and join a class. Do the work on this even when you don't want to. Isolation is one of the key accelerators of depression.

Tip 7: Take Action

Depression thrives on **inaction**. Inaction and sitting there sad doesn't help in the long run if it is all you do for long periods of time.

It is OK to be **sad**, and process traumas and difficulties, but when we sit there for prolonged periods of time without taking action, it doesn't make anything better.

Forming solutions and taking action are what put you on the path to the life you deserve to live.

Beating depression isn't just about **one** magic habit fix, it's about stacking many scientifically proven habits together to build your momentum over time.

This momentum will reach a point one day where its hard for you to feel negative for

long periods of time, because your life is
overall so positive.

You probably are not going to want to do all
of these habits **all the time**, but it is the
stacking of these selected habits consistently
that will bring results.

Depression isn't just a switch that flips
between "im depressed" and "im happy."

Momentum takes time to build in either
direction. The **more** areas of self
improvement that you have worked on, the
more momentum you build.

Areas such as:

- Improving Self Love
- Improving Positive Self Talk
- Working Towards A Positive Dream
Larger Than Yourself
- Daily Habits Tracker
- Working On Discipline
- Sticking To Your Word
- Daily Weight Training
- Daily Zone 2 Exercise
- Self Development Books And Courses
- Improving Confidence and Public
Speaking

- Consuming Positivity
- Self Care
- Meditation
- Martial Arts

These are all ways of charging that **positive battery** within you, of pushing your momentum towards a great attitude and life.

There is always **something** in that list to work on, make sure you put your head down and work hard!

Tip 8: Not Having 100% Motivation In The Beginning Is Common

If you are reading these tips or trying to help someone with these tips, if the person in question feels 100% motivation and really excited to start their journey to better mental health, that's great...

But the **reality** is, most people with depression don't feel too motivated to make these changes in the beginning.

Feelings of intense motivation are not **guaranteed** at all, and these feelings can be slow to build in the beginning. But that is OK. A slow start is actually common and normal when it comes to feeling motivated during depressive episodes. What is **important** is to start.

Action comes **before** motivation, not after!
Some days motivation will magically come to
you and shoot you out of bed in a good mood.

But most days we have to **create** our own
motivation. We have to actually get up and
push ourselves hard on many days.

This is one thing I noticed in my own life. I
have my habit trackers set, and I don't
actually feel **motivated** to do my tasks most
of the time.

But once I do them, I get that **satisfying**
feeling of seeing everything ticked off by mid
day.

I **then** feel the motivation. After. I feel
motivated by what I accomplished, and then
that leads to more motivation to do more
amazing things, and I can enjoy my day!

The motivation will come more strongly **after you complete the tasks.** After you successfully produce the feeling of a hard days work that has been completed, you then feel motivation to do a little more that day.

A few days and eventually weeks like that can lead to motivation becoming a more consistent feeling. And that is ideal for your mental health.

You can actually get addicted to that good feeling of a productive days work. But it still comes and goes for everyone.

Motivation is really unlikely to arrive in the early stages of depression, but rather it is built up by constantly attacking what you don't want to do and realising your life is actually better because of it.

Get **addicted** to ticking off your tasks and making a positive change to yourself. Give it a chance.

Motivation even for a normal person isn't **constant**. But it is at least **present** some of the time. For a depressed person, it can often be **nonexistent** in the beginning.

This is ok, take a big brave step to do what you **don't** want to do and stick to your newly created habits for a few consecutive weeks, motivation will return.

These habits will get easier over time, in the same way going to the gym gets easier after the first 3 or 4 sessions.

The initial period of settling into these new routines and pushing your comfort zone is hard, but you can expect to see slow results

in as little as 2 weeks. Stick with it, because you are on the verge of changing your life.

The days of challenging yourself. **conquering** your fears, and completing all the hard work you didn't want to do consistently over multiple days are going to make a big difference.

Then the motivation will come. The happiness will come. The change will come.

Tip 9: Pick Pride Over Motivation

Motivation can be a great feeling and we all want more of it. But as I said, even for a normal person with great mental health, motivation doesn't always come.

I want you to consider picking pride over motivation always.

If you look after yourself, stick to your word and complete your tasks, even when you don't feel like them, you will be left with a great feeling. That great feeling is being **proud** of yourself.

If you complete your tasks even **without** motivation, you build an extreme amount of pride over time. You build pride and strength of character by doing difficult things that put your life in a better position, despite the challenges you face.

A lot of people get **depressed** when they give up doing all of the stuff they know they should be doing for themselves. The basic things they know they need to do to look after themselves.

They avoid the hard stuff, and wait for motivation to come instead of doing the uncomfortable things they know they need to do.

It leads to them feeling that they aren't **proud** of themselves anymore especially when they aren't even doing the basic tasks to look after themselves.

Once they start to look after themselves even when they have to push through great difficulty, they build that pride again.

Pick pride over motivation and do the hard things. The feeling of pride is a powerful **antidepressant**.

Tip 10: “You get out what you put in.”

The more you work on yourself, the more you are going to see incredible results,

No situation is stronger than a made up mind to put in the work, no life is too far off course to be steered back.

Every single type of person **can** turn this around. I have seen it with my own eyes. Rock bottom can become the **foundation** for something **extraordinary**.

You can come back from rock bottom with more than you started with. You can return a thousand times better.

No one said this will be easy, but the results are worth the discomfort. If everyday is the **same** for you and nothing changes, it is life's

way of telling you that it is time to make a change.

You need to **work hard**, as well all do in life, to drive yourself closer to the outcomes that you want to see.

Everyone is working at something. Your challenge to work on is currently your mental health. Positivity takes work and a lot of people don't realize this. But it is those that go through experiences such as depression, who actually find a deeper **treasure**.

Because when they come out the other side, they usually are the people who take working on positivity every day the most **seriously**. People who have been through a great deal and come out the other side usually don't

mess around with the idea that mental health should not be worked on.

They put the work in towards their mental health more than others, because they don't want to return to the place they have come from, and eventually they become some of the **highest achieving** people in the world with **above average** mental health.

Nearly every successful life coach I ever met always had a backstory of depressive times and lows, challenge simply improves us as humans.

You can come out the other side taking your mental health and positivity so much more seriously, or you can stay average.

Decide which person you want to be.
Positive options are on the other side of
action.

Some people work hard at sales, some
people work hard at becoming rich, but
those that find the consistent time to work at
building positive mental health with 100% of
their power, are those who unlock the key to
happiness long term.

If you commit to the success strategies
listed above, and work to 100% of your
ability, you will achieve **great** things, not
only in your mental health, but in your life
thereafter.

The most **important** thing to do is get up and
look at what positive things you have to do

today to move you closer to where you want to be... and then have the courage to start.

Only focus on the best things you could possibly do today to build you towards where you need to be in life. And focus on the best things you could possibly do tomorrow too. Keep this attitude every day for the rest of your life, and you will end up in great places.

Don't worry about slow starts, don't worry if you feel like a beginner everyday, just practice developing your skills, talents and positive mindset, and watch the results flow into your life.

“Action is the foundational key to all success.”

Task For Getting Back On Track

If you **combine** seeing yourself as a person of your word, looking after your body, exercising regularly, eating well, sleeping well, practicing positive habits and routines in the morning with things like gratitude journaling and meditation, you have a strong chance at **mastering** your thoughts.

If you promote **positive** self talk and take up positive manifestation at night, if you take up the positive life direction of gaining meaningful employment, reading self improvement books, and doing the healthy things for yourself, you will see amazing progress.

I suggest a quick **routine** for those who want some **actionable steps** to get back on track. If you want a simple starting plan.

Start with this daily baseline:

10 - 20 minute walk with positive music playing (sunlight)

Shower + get dressed properly and apply cologne even if you are not going anywhere nice (pride)

Weight training workout at the gym minimum 30 minutes. (endorphins and hormones)

Apply the habit tracker from my first book:

Gratitude journaling - 3 things grateful for minimum

Meditation - 30 seconds minimum

Reading - 1 page minimum

Exercise - 1 repetition minimum

1 social interaction (even small - ask
someone how their day went)

Try to sleep at a consistent time

Do this for 7 days and you will feel a shift.

Final Thoughts: Positive Momentum Equals Success

With the knowledge that you can go through depression and come out the other side as an achiever of amazing things in life, and as a person who takes even better care for your mental health than when you started, I want you to ask yourself one question.

Which kind of person do you want to be?
Will you be the kind of person who looks
after your mental health and takes it serious?
Or the person who stays the same.

Action changes everything. I hope this
chapter helps you to gain some ideas of how
you can build immense momentum in your
mindset. There is further help for each and
every common life coaching issue in this
book that can help you to build ultimate
progress in your mental health.

Consult the other sections of this book, to fix
overthinking, anxiety, to process your
traumas, fix your attention span, and you
have the best chance at bringing yourself or
another through!

I want to end by saying, you make a really
brave choice to want to help someone here,

or to even help yourself here! The person you become after putting in the work daily, is going to be proud of the work you put in today.

Make the right choices, and become someone who made the decision to become their absolute best. Wake up every day and do your best.

Despite the occasional trauma coming along that we need to work through and take time to heal from, happiness is a habit that can be cultivated and

We should all strive to achieve the very best state of mind and truly find happiness.

Lack Of Purpose

*“A day without purpose is a day
wasted.”*

The important thing in life is to have a **goal** in life, something you enjoy. A purpose doing what you love has been scientifically found to be a magic cure against depression, low self esteem and a large **variety** of other life issues that I commonly coach.

It is scientifically proven that you will become less depressed, and that all other life issues are 30% less likely to affect your mental health, if you are waking up in the morning with a clear purpose in mind and following it.

Viktor E Frankl was a psychiatric doctor who worked with a lot of patients. He was actually a survivor of some of the most **brutal** concentration camps of World War 2. He dealt with many other survivors and helped them improve their lives after the war through therapy.

It is safe to say Viktor had seen a lot of **depression**. Frankl himself said he noticed a trend in depression amongst his patients. Those that had employment, were 50% less likely to be depressed than those that didn't.

Having something to do, something to wake up to in the morning, even if it was hard, tough work, reduced depression in a **majority** of cases.

Now as we imagine, if a person really hates the job, that can only last for so long, and they still may feel a sense of **sadness**.

But if that person then enters a job that highly satisfies them, their levels of happiness go up by a larger percentage.

The final layer to this, is that if a person finds a job that no one can pull them away from, a purpose so great that they truly believe in, a job they can wake up to every day 100% certain that was the job they were put on the world to do.

The chances of depression become almost **nonexistent**.

People were able to lose family members, go through break ups, go through chronic pain, and still managed to feel satisfied in life.

They tended to actually have better **relationships**, because they were working towards what they loved and this allowed them to be in a better mood for their partner, they tended to have better **concentration** spans, and they tended to have significantly better mental health.

So how do we find it? The main **question** I would ask someone struggling with this is:

“Ask yourself, if I had unlimited money in the bank tomorrow, and I didn't have to work, what would I work on every day?”

That can give you a solid answer. Some people will say: “I wouldn’t work. I would do nothing.” But I try and get them to look **deeper**. If they did have to work, but they could choose the job what would it be?

Many people go to the gym, but they go to the gym with the “result” in mind to get in shape. They are doing it for the results, not because of a love for the gym.

Whereas, some people go to the gym simply because they love it and find it fun. They would do it anyway without the results.

They have what is called a core desire to go to the gym.

Try to think of something you would still do in your day anyway, not just for money, not

for results or because it keeps you healthy.
What would you simply do anyway?

A good indication you have found your purpose is when you can answer this question with a yes:

Do you wake up every morning excited to go straight into this thing, or you literally can't sleep because your so excited to work on it?

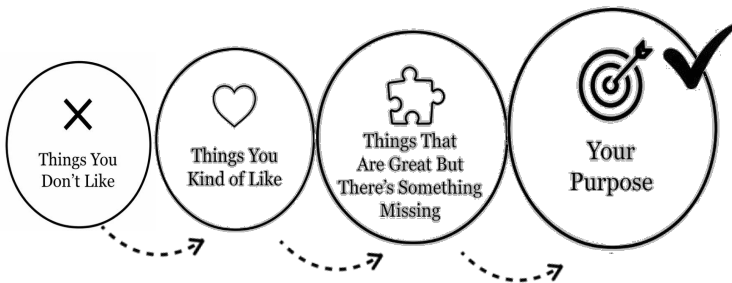
This is a sign it is your purpose. I am going to give you 5 tips to help you make sure you are building towards your purpose.

5 Tips To Find Your True Purpose

- 1. Pick the thing you enjoy the most at this current time in your life and start to build on that.**

The thing you enjoy **the most** is important here. Don't go for something that you "kind of" like.

The Stages Of Finding Purpose



The **true** purpose of your life isn't just what you enjoy. We enjoy many things. I enjoyed playing music for example. I

actually thought it could be my purpose for a while.

I did a music degree and got quite good at playing. Music appealed to my creative side which I always had. I could sit and play piano for 8 hours straight every day.

Some people say “pick the thing you can do for 8 hours a day and not get bored.” Ok, that's a good start. I had this focus. But I wasn't 100% happy. Something didn't feel **right**.

I couldn't help but feel a lack of physicality, I love to be physical daily, and I often felt a little **isolated** playing music, I was in dark music studios, mixing songs, with no windows

I started to feel like.. Music was enjoyable, and I could focus on it for **hours**, it wasn't **terrible**, it was actually quite good, and a real hobby.

Life wouldn't be **bad** pursuing a career in music, but was it really my true passion? In life, do I want to go for “not bad” or “my ultimate dream?”

I asked myself: could I do music even if the money wasn't good? And it didn't seem enough for me. Financially, physically, and mentally I wanted more.

It's crazy how what we feel is our purpose can be influenced so much by our childhoods.

I believe if I had the upbringing of someone whose whole family were musicians, who led me to believe from a young age that I would always be a musician and it was my destiny, I would have actually taken the music route.

But my experience was different.

I remember my mother had always predicted in my future that I would help people. I also had a bunch of teachers who noticed my talents for creative writing.

One teacher would always put her hand on her head and bless me, saying a prayer for me and telling me I would write amazing books one day.

This was enough for me to feel like I needed to **switch** paths away from music.

I got tired of the lack of money from music. So, I then tackled another piece of the puzzle when it comes to finding a purpose. **Money.**

I switched into IT. I enjoyed it. The feeling of creative problem solving with all the code across my screen was good.

The feeling of being able to relax and sit down and work from home was good. And financially I would have been set if I pursued this path. This was a **better** choice than my previous choice.

But again, there was something missing. There was no physicality, and I didn't have that feeling of helping people truly. It wasn't just about helping people, but I asked myself: "is this the problem I truly want to be

helping people with for the rest of my life?
Code on a computer?”

To some people the answer is yes, and that is amazing. Again, this career is actually very enjoyable and rewarding. It is highly intellectual and without coders we wouldn't be able to solve some of the worlds biggest problems. It wouldn't have been a bad life.

However, after a long journey of experimentation, it was finally fitness coaching that I gravitated towards.

I had already at this point been waking up everyday for about a year, writing books about life coaching, going to the gym and pursuing my Personal Trainer qualifications.

This was all after days working in IT and offices.

Here is a tip for you: If you are tired from a days work, and you still find the energy afterwards to work towards something else, and you would rather work towards that something else then to simply the read resources that would progress you in your current career, its a good sign that whatever you are doing after work is where you actually want to end up.

I remember I used to hide under the desk at work to pursue a better future in the things I actually loved.

Fitness appealed to me the most, I tried to do IT just to keep my father happy. I did all my qualifications, but after every day I just

kept going back to fitness and mindset coaching. I would wake up everyday and feel it was my purpose.

I got my creative side flowing by creating unique fitness programmes for people, and also writing my coaching books. I was writing books and using my creativity like how my school teachers predicted.

I was helping people like how my mother predicted too, and overall that feeling of waking up every day with the certainty that I am helping lives and that I am following the right path has never left me.

Ok, the truth is, of course with starting a business there are times of doubt. Times where the money isn't coming in, you are sleeping on a sofa unable to scrape by,

wondering if you made the right choice to leave your old job. That happens for sure because starting a business and following your dreams comes with setbacks and obstacles.

But overall after a day or so of doubt, after each and every time, I would come back to fitness as my dream. The doubt never lasted long.

I tell you this story so you can understand your purpose isn't just something you like, it is something you love. It has to tick many boxes. Our purpose is a core desire, and it is not to be taken lightly.

Tip 2: Consider The 3 Elements Of a Good Purpose.

Building on what I am saying above, it isn't enough just to have **one** element in place when it comes to your purpose.

To me the 3 elements of a good purpose are what I call the 3 F's, and all must be ticked:

First: Is it my first choice of all the realistic options? Is it the thing I truly enjoy the most?

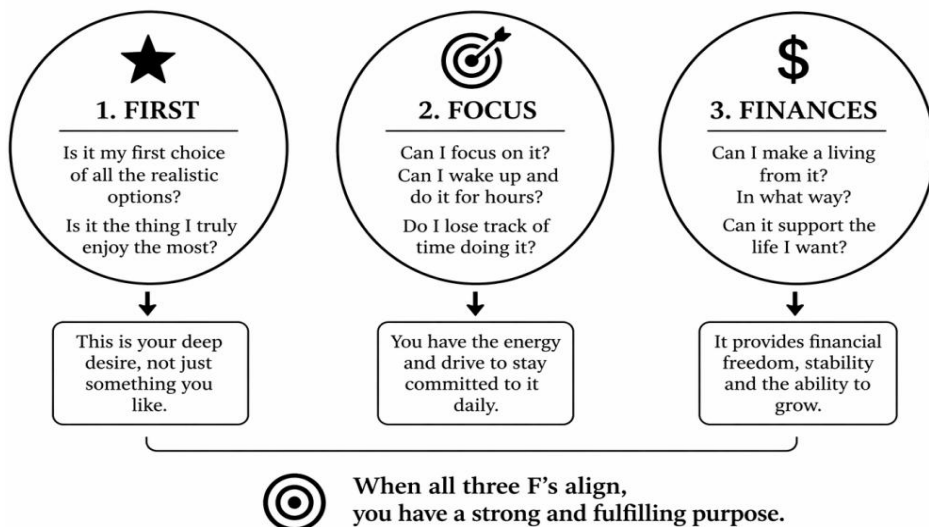
Focus: Can I focus on it? Can I wake up and do it for hours?

Finances: Can I make a living from it? In what way?

A passion is just a passion. A true purpose hits you on **all** levels and completes the three F's above.

The 3 F's of a Good Purpose

All three must work together.



Ask yourself if you can wake up daily and **love** it. Does it tick every box for you in terms of the three F's above, and can you find a way to do this daily and earn a good living from it.

That is what strikes the balance point of a strong purpose.

The **finances** actually are **important**. Try to do what you love and get paid a lot for it if you can!

Tip 3: Purpose Is Not Something That's Revealed Straight Away

As you can tell from my own story above, it took me **a lot** of testing out what worked and what didn't, before I found myself.

Work hard at the things that truly **inspire** you. Develop your skills and talents every day.

If you can't think of anything worthwhile to pursue or it feels like your interests are pointless, then keep working on the other areas of this book and follow the recommended reading pages, there are some books that may help.

You will get there in the end!

Tip 4: Sometimes Your Purpose Can Change

That's okay. This Is normal. Once every 4 years or so, you may discover that you wish to switch directions in life. Through following your dreams and following your purpose, life sometimes puts in your heart and reveals to you that your true purpose was actually meant to be something different all along.

You then take the skills that you learned working towards your old dream, which you definitely needed to learn to prepare yourself for this new chapter, and are in the perfect position now to chase your newfound purpose.

Nothing in this life is by accident, following your dreams always results in you landing exactly where you need to be, even when the dreams change, there is no wasted time.

You have learned and developed exactly the skills required to achieve the next evolution of your purpose.

Tip 5: You Are Ahead Of Others For Even Caring About This

If you are not sure of your purpose and frustrated that you can't find it. That's actually a **good** thing. Because it shows you care about finding it.

You are probably going to get further than someone who never considered this. The message to you will arrive one day, because you are looking for it with your whole heart, and that is the most important thing, that you care.

Tip 6: It's Okay To Get It Wrong

I know picking a purpose means you almost have to roll the dice and go all in on

something. As a young person especially, maybe your scared of picking the wrong thing to go all in on. Keep on trying things out, but know this:

A focused, disciplined pursuit of any goal is never going to be a waste. Pick what is most inclined in your heart at the time, and the hard work will pay off. Hard work always does. Your core desire will always lead you in the right direction.

Wake up everyday and spend that day doing every task you possibly can to follow your core desire.

Good careers to pick

If it was my advice, I would tell a young person, or any person really: If you really want money, go for a degree in:

- **Law** – Become a lawyer and enter a stable, well-paying field.
- **Finance, Economics, or Mathematics** – These degrees can lead to jobs in investment banking, where salaries can skyrocket.
- **Computer Science or Mathematics** – The IT and tech fields are booming and pay very well.
- **Business** – Get into consultancy, business management, or entrepreneurship.

Those are all high paying jobs. As a creative graduate, if I could go back and do it all again, maybe I would have picked one of those jobs.

Medical school can also get you an **extremely** well paid job, Dentistry and Sales too.

But the final thing I want to explain to you, is that we live in a world where any hobby or skill can be monetized. If you truly wake up every morning with a burning desire to do something, listen to that desire.

For example, 20 years ago, if you loved basketball, the only option would be to become a professional basketball player and earn a ton, or become a commentator or coach where you wouldn't earn as much.

But, now we live in a world where, a teenager can make internet videos of him practicing his shot into a basketball hoop, and sell courses on the internet to other teenagers to make more than a lawyer would.

There is a lot of opportunity nowadays to follow your passions. This is why even though I can sit here and recommend degrees to a specific type of person, I know it is not the only route.

I also think people should be reading business books from when they are very young so they have a greater understanding of the opportunities available to them.

Please try to think of the thing you are most passionate about and work on it daily. Eventually everything will fall into place!

Challenge: Spend an hour a day (or more) selecting a reasonably well paid skill you love the most and trying to advance this passion to make money or a career out of it.

Overthinking

Why is it that **some** people can put their head on the pillow and fall asleep within minutes, whilst others lie there for hours, **trapped** inside their own heads?

This is one of the most **common** issues I see in clients. Most people have overactive brains, and most tend to overthink at night.

But what if I told you that we can direct our overthinking towards **productive** outcomes and use it as a superpower for success?

I remember a client from Finland who reached out to tell me he was a successful young salesman who was doing well in life.

And he was. He trained consistently, had built a striking physique, was making serious money in business at only nineteen, and — by his own account — was genuinely enjoying the grind. **Sipping sparkling champagne on the balcony, he was enjoying the good life.**

He felt happy. Disciplined. Proud of outperforming most people his age.

However, he said that at night, his **inner voice** got to him. He would often think about

the worst possible scenarios happening. He would often think: “but what if I fail?”

He would consider all the negative outcomes. He would ask himself things like: “but what if I can’t do this? What if I mess up?”

“What if I’m a fluke and I don’t make as much next month?”

I felt sad for him because he was a successful young man with real potential to expand his greatness, but when it came to sleeping at night, his mind self-destructed. He was in shape. He was winning. But his mind wasn’t working for him.

So how did I help him?

First, I told him he was a young man with great potential and real discipline across many areas of his life.

I asked him to consider that he had already won half the battle — because he had something most people spend their entire lives searching for. Discipline.

I told him that whilst he applied that discipline to his sales calls and his gym sessions, he could apply that same discipline to his thoughts at night.

I told him he wasn't alone, as a person who suffered with ADHD symptoms my whole life, I too had racing thoughts that never seemed to switch off.

For some people, those thoughts never fully stop. But we can weaponise them — redirect them towards planning, towards positive thinking, towards manifesting what we want, towards productive routines at night.

The answer wasn't to stop his thoughts. It was to redirect them.

The same discipline we need to stick to a fitness diet, or to quit smoking, applies to our thoughts at night.

We have to tell ourselves sometimes: "*Let it go. This isn't serving me.*" That can actually take more discipline than going to the gym or losing twenty pounds.

So Where Do We Redirect?

You're probably thinking I want you to lie there thinking about nothing, right?. Wrong.

Nobody wants to stare at the ceiling in silence.

We have to direct the mind towards productive routines instead. Here is my step by step guide with 8 steps to prevent overthinking that I gave to this young man..

8 Tips To Prevent Overthinking

Tip 1: Write Down Your To Do List Before You Go To Bed

This stops you lying awake stressing about everything you need to do tomorrow. Getting it onto paper clears the mental load — and this has been scientifically proven to work.

Write it down and give yourself permission to let it go.

Tip 2: Show Discipline And Move On From Negative Thoughts.

Treat this with the same seriousness as your discipline in the gym. Notice you are caught in a negative thought loop, and make the deliberate choice to move on — even when part of you wants to stay there.

The same way you are disciplined in the gym, you need to notice you are distracted by negative thought loops and make the disciplined choice to **move on**, even if you WANT to think about them.

Most people overthink at night and assume they are broken, or that they are the only people going through this issue. They are not.

It is extremely common. But it does take conscious effort to redirect these thoughts — which is exactly why most people fall asleep to Netflix instead.

The phone and the screen become a way to avoid sitting there in our own thoughts. The problem is that they interrupt sleep and solve nothing.

When really what we need to do is **lie down, relax** ourselves, and learn to direct our thoughts, and attention towards positive methods of thinking, not Netflix, not overthinking, but healthy manners of thought. Something productive.

Tip 3: Replace Negative Thoughts With Positive Visualizations Of You Achieving Your Goals

How do we do this? Firstly we picture
a memory in our life that made us
extremely happy.

It can be any positive memory,
preferably an intensely happy one that
made us really smile. This is what's
known as our “**anchor memory**.”

Take the positive feeling of your
anchor memory in your mind and take
a few deep breaths. When you inhale
picture yourself inhaling positivity,
and when you exhale picture yourself
exhaling negativity.

Try to **smile**, this will boost your mood as you visualise.

Picture the same smile that was on your face and the happiness you felt in your anchor memory and now picture yourself smiling that same smile and feeling that same happiness as you achieve all your current goals.

When you visualise, you need to visualise **vividly**, down to the **exact actions** you will take to achieve your goals, the sights, the smells, the feelings that you feel.

Visualise who is going to be in the room, visualise what you will say, **don't leave out any details.**

Only visualise things going in the best way they possibly can. Whatever your

wildest dream is, picture yourself acting as the perfect character that would achieve those dreams with ease.

My positive **anchor** memory was me sending a football flying into the top right corner of the net, to score the winning goal in football in my last day of secondary school.

This was the last football match we would ever play in school, and all the boys in my year took me onto their shoulders and I felt like I was surfing on the air, supported by my friends. I felt like a **winner**.

I took this same smile I felt in that moment, and pictured this **same smile** on my face as I achieved my future goals.

I pictured the **same** smile on my face as I opened my Achieve Greatness gym, and smiled at my staff members happily as I opened multiple locations across multiple countries.

I would smile that same smile to the cleaners, the staff, talking to everyone and making them feel valued and happy, making sure everyone had development opportunities.

I pictured the clean, hygienic brand new smell of the black leather equipment and my logo everywhere, with big windows to let the sunset through with a skyline view..

That is how **vivid** your visualisation should be. You picture yourself already completing the action — so that when the day actually comes, it feels familiar, as though you have already ran through your dream character

achieving victory in this situation in your mind.

Because of this, you have essentially **rehearsed** it in your mind, and are more likely to actually act that way on the day.

Even if you don't believe in these gurus who claim the act of manifestation will result in positive things being attracted to or handed down to you by forces unknown, you can still believe in the **science** behind visualisation.

For example, Conor McGregor used visualisation a lot. He would visualise the day of his fight. In vivid detail and always positively.

From how he would walk out to his music with extreme confidence, to the combos he would throw, to the exact punch he would throw to end it all.

Visualization can also work before job interviews. Visualise yourself going in and shaking the interviewers hand, and them absolutely **loving** you.

Them laughing at all your jokes, and you smoothly saying what the **best** possible version of yourself would say to land the job with flying colors, talking with extreme confidence, clarity, and being well received.

Don't be **humble**, visualise the **best** possible things and exactly what you want out of life. Visualise the exact process you will use to make this happen in as **much detail** as possible.

Only visualise the **positive**.

Scientifically, this is rehearsing and preparing you, you are practicing these situations in your mind and will be more likely to perform in an ideal manner on the day when you have **rehearsed** the **successful behaviour** in your head.

Tip 4: Make a Self Talk Audio Reaffirming Your Ultimate Goal In Life, Play It Back To Yourself, Then Reflect On It.

I took this idea from businessman **Grant Cardone**, who built a multi-million dollar property empire.

He asks: “who is more likely to achieve their goals — the person who writes them down **once** at the start of the year, or the person who reflects on them every single night?”

Having your ultimate goal **fresh** in your mind at all times helps you to take the day to day actions to get there, without getting distracted with meaningless things.

Grant Cardone said he wrote down his goals every night, as well as his personal wins of the day.

I take this concept a little bit further, firstly as I go to sleep I reflect on three things I am proud of.

It could be basic things like going to the dentist or booking a doctors appointment, these are **genuine** wins for me as they can be boring to do sometimes and I put them off often!

Instead of writing down my goal, as I am bed and winding down, I listen to a recording that I recorded of myself.

It is a self talk audio on my phone of me reaffirming my ultimate goal to myself.

I play it back at night and reflect on it before I sleep.

It reminds me of **where I am going** and winds me down at the same time. Make your own. They are one of the best tools I know for ending the night well.

**Tip 5: Manifest Everything You Want - Not
What You Fear.**

Thinking about what you want is positive thinking. Thinking about what you do not want is fearful thinking.

When you manifest and visualise positively at night, it is a far better use of your time than rehearsing every possible disaster.

Think about your goals as if you already have them. Feel **grateful** for them as if they have **already arrived**.

Ask for everything you truly want and don't be shy to ask for it all. The more power you put into this, the more will come back and the more use you will get out of the exercise.

Manifesting is simply a case of **believing** you have something, you can also use prayer if you are religious. The key is to truly believe luck is on your side.

Tip 6: Try Gratitude

In almost any situation of negative thought spiralling, this technique works as a positive alternative. Simply think of things you are grateful for. Gratitude simply works and is proven to have amazing mental health benefits in almost every scenario.

Tip 7: Remember That Sleep Is Your Duty As As a High Achiever.

A bad night's sleep interferes with the quality of everything you produce the next day.

I took this angle with my Finnish client because I knew he was the type who stayed up working and overthinking — and I knew

that producing quality work mattered deeply to him.

He showed great **discipline** against drinking, against missing sessions, against taking the easy options in life. He had to bring that same discipline to his thoughts at night and replace them with productive behaviours.

His response was **immediate**. He saw exactly how the sleeplessness was affecting his schedule, his focus, and his output. That reframe changed everything, and helped him to change his ways.

Tip 8: Identify Genuine Traumas And Work Through Them

Later in this book there is a full section on processing traumas. We need to work through traumas so that we are not constantly thinking of them. Please visit the Traumas section.

Tip 9: Learn Meditation

You can block negative thoughts out entirely, but it takes a great deal of practice. One way of practicing this is Meditation.

Mediation works by focusing on your breath. You inhale the positivity, and exhale the negativity, and simply **focus** on your breath.

When you first start meditation, it is very hard, because your mind keeps drifting back to whatever is going on in the world and your daily life.

Draw your mind back to your breath every time you lose focus. Every time you **successfully** do this, you are training the muscle in your brain to focus in spite of distraction.

Over time you develop the ability to focus more, you can detect when you are getting distracted at work. You can **catch** yourself when you are getting distracted from positive thoughts, as well as when you are

spiralling at night into thoughts that don't
serve you.

You become very good at “switching off” and
letting go.

I acknowledge that for many of us, it feels
satisfying to "finish" a thought — to resolve
our unfinished business, to consider every
angle of an issue before we sleep at night.

Some people are even **addicted** to thinking
about all the negatives of a situation because
it feels to them like a preparation.

But ask yourself honestly: does chronically
overthinking at night **actually** serve you?

The truth is, it doesn't feel good, there are
clear weaknesses in this approach, and there
are better ways to spend our time.

Just because you **want** to think about something doesn't mean you **should**.

The best advice I can give you is to ask yourself: "I want to think about this, but should I? Is it worth it, or should I let go?"

Deep down you know the answer.
Meditation will help you to switch off and "let go" in these scenarios.

Make A Promise To Yourself

How I fixed my own overthinking was by making a promise to myself that I would not overthink things that did not matter.

I had a relationship where I would overthink every argument, every text message.

I would sit with my phone and not even press send. And I want to be honest about something — sometimes the only thing that forces a real change is when you have finally had enough.

When I left that relationship, I made a **promise** to myself I would never go back to that way of thinking. I read those old messages months later and barely recognised myself.

I am not saying you need to end your relationship. But sometimes you need to hit a low point before you make the change — or at least be honest with yourself that you have reached one.

So I want you to write down every way that overthinking negatively affects your life.
Give yourself a **true picture** of the cost.

If you feel ready after seeing the cost of your overthinking, I want you to make a promise to yourself that you are going to be disciplined starting from today.

Conquering overthinking delivers more than just better sleep. Better sleep means better work, better training, better relationships, and better focus. And it carries over.

If you can **control** your thoughts at night — catch yourself slipping, and set yourself straight — you will find that same ability showing up during the day, which is a great victory.

You will catch distraction at your desk. You will steady yourself before a difficult conversation. You will have more command over what you allow into your mind. That command is going to rapidly develop every area of your mental health.

There are two more rules I would like you to live by whenever possible.

BUCKET RULE #1

You don't get to worry about things that hasn't happened yet.

BUCKET RULE #2

You don't get to worry about things that are out of your control.

Final Thoughts On Overthinking

Overthinking is not the enemy. Misdirected overthinking is.

To conclude — overthinking can actually be a positive force if we learn to target it towards positive plans, business ideas, and visualisations of the future we want.

It takes discipline to redirect negative thoughts. But that is exactly what we have to learn to do.

Through applying yourself, you can direct any racing, hyperactive nighttime thoughts towards more productive uses of your time:

- Gratitude
- Positive visualisation of you winning and accomplishing your dreams
- Self-talk audios
- Positive affirmations
- Manifesting what you want in life and business — not what you fear

Once you get used to applying these tools, it actually becomes something you look forward to.

Your Goal This Week

If you struggle with overthinking, your goal this week is simple: tonight, before bed, write down your tasks, your unfinished thoughts. Get it onto paper. Then pick one technique from this chapter and practice it

in place of the overthinking spiral. Just one.
That is enough to begin.

This is going to help you spend your evenings **productively**, sleep deeply, and gain real control over something most people once believed couldn't be controlled.

Imagine a world where you have a grip on this. Where you control your thoughts, not the other way around.

Through discipline, maturity, and choosing to direct your thoughts to a worthwhile cause, you will be able to turn your overthinking into a superpower that works for you every time.

Discipline

One good, full, productive day where you did everything you said you would. The day where you did the workout, got the tasks done, ate well, and went to bed with nothing left on the list. This is a day of **discipline**.

You can have days like this everyday.
Discipline is something everyone can build.

I want to tell you something that Jocko Willink — former Navy SEAL commander, one of the most decorated military leaders in American history — said about discipline.

Jocko had trained people from **every** conceivable background. Rich kids and broke kids. Pampered kids and abused kids. Kids from strong families and kids with no

family at all. Kids who had grown up surrounded by discipline and kids who had never experienced a single structured day in their lives.

And his conclusion, after years of watching all of them?

Discipline is not something some people have and others do not. It is not a personality trait you are born with. It is built — through consistency — and lost through inaction.

A person can be disciplined for ten years and lose it. A person can be a mess for ten years and build it. It is **never** too late. And it is never permanently yours either. You have to keep choosing it.

This section is going to help you build discipline. Discipline is built over time by applying the correct **mindsets** to your day.

It doesn't make sense to think about doing extremely hard challenges that you haven't built up to yet, some people try to do too much too soon and burn out.

But, by starting just a little **above** our current level of discipline, and pushing ourselves daily, we can achieve great progress in our discipline levels.

We want to construct healthy targets that are slightly challenging, but that don't ruin your entire month and mental health either!
Some people take these challenges to the extreme.

Through practice, you will get better at constructing disciplined goals that you know are healthy for you and that you can achieve without burning out.

We don't all need to be military men who take **ice baths** daily. We don't have to always pick the **hard** path for the sake of it in life.

Don't target things just because they are hard, target them because they will bring you closer to your dreams, hard or not.

You know in yourself, how hard you need to work to achieve your own greatness. You know if you need more or less discipline within yourself, and this chapter is going to help you to build it.

Here are **10 tips** to build unbreakable discipline.

10 Tips To Build Unbreakable Discipline

Tip 1: Kick Start Discipline With An Awesome Morning Routine

A disciplined day starts from your morning routine. It sets the tone for the rest of the day.

The type of day you have when you complete your entire habit tracker before noon and have all tasks completed is a **different** kind of day.

You end up not even **wanting** to relax after, you actually get the energy to become even more disciplined and to do even more. From the moment you wake up, the discipline is live.

Do not stay under the warm covers negotiating with yourself. Get up and move. Work out early if you can.

Write down your most important tasks the night before and blitz through them the moment the day begins.

If you consistently execute a good morning routine, you are well on your way to becoming disciplined at least 50% of the time, as you will spend the first half of your days in a disciplined manner!

Tip 2: Discipline Applies To Everything You Do

Discipline is not just the gym. It is your diet, your sleep, your reading, the quality of work you produce, the partner you are, the

promises you keep to yourself and to others.
Your morning and evening routine. It bleeds
into everything.

To build discipline in your diet, eat clean
food, avoid sugar — it is addictive and drains
you faster than almost anything else. Fast
until later in the day if it works for you to
lose weight.

*“The body can go 30 days without food, you
can go 8 hours without it.”*

To build discipline into your gym routine,
make your workouts progressively harder.
Show up on the hard days that you don’t feel
like it and go through the motions!

A workout attended is better than no
workout.

Apply discipline to everything. How you answer your phone and get back to people in a timely manner, your routines, your habit trackers, your to do list, and your family priorities.

When your day is done, you will feel something that an easy, slow, comfortable day almost never produces — genuine satisfaction. A rewarding tiredness. The quiet pride of someone who did not waste their hours.

You will grow to **love** it.

Tip 3: Don't Give Yourself An Out

Do not give yourself an out. Track things such as lifts in the gym, your diet, habits completed and tasks completed, as well as monthly goals.

You are doing this so you remain accountable to yourself. Broadcast your goals to others, tell someone your goal and attach consequences — owe people money if you fail.

This gives you accountability. You can recreate “accountability.” In the military, people don't want to let their team down. In everyday life, you can seek out accountability partners, track and log your goals, and set punishments if you fail!

Tip 4: On The Days You Don't Want To — Go Through The Motions

On the days you do not want to do something, go through the motions. This means showing up even if your output isn't the best.

Lift the weights. Sprint the hill. Do your work at a reduced version of itself rather than not at all. Seek consistency over perfection.

If you feel like taking a day off, wait until tomorrow to decide. If you still want the day off tomorrow, take it. But, most times you will wake up the next day and the urge will have gone.

Also, once you start doing the action even with the intent to do it half heartedly, you usually end up doing it pretty good.

It's why it's better to show up for a gym session a little sleepy, and get started, because magically they somehow turn into extremely good sessions!

Tip 5: Don't Hesitate

“No more I'll start tomorrow. No more waiting for the perfect moment, the right conditions. Discipline is everyday.”

Fight instant gratification and immediate rewards for every inch they try to take. When do you start? Here and now.

Stop thinking about things, Stop researching the pros and cons of things, and stop debating doing it. Just do it. Discipline is starting now without hesitation.

Tip 6: Never Miss Twice

One day off is not the problem. But one day can quickly turn into two. Into a week. One missed workout can quickly turn into 4 missed workouts.

Adopt a never miss twice mentality. If you fall off one day, come back harder the next like you owe yourself one.

“One missed workout is not a failure. Four missed workouts following the first one is a choice.”

Stay on guard. Never miss twice, and try to go everyday. It is not always possible to, but if you can without burning out, and realistically most people can, then go ahead and take no days off. But if you do take a day off, never miss twice!

Tip 7: Construct Your To Do List

Build structure. Most people in the military build discipline because they are forced to. They have sergeants, they have set times and set goals and days.

What can really help the average person who does not have the same forced structure, is for them to plan out a disciplined day. Most people just take life as it comes.

They forget tasks. But when you get organized and plan out a disciplined routine daily, with set times to do things, it can really help you.

Decide in advance when you wake up, when you work, when you train. Write down your to do list with the top 3 most important tasks, and get them done.

Tip 8: Stack Small, Repeatable Actions

Focus on small, repeatable actions. Discipline isn't built by big heroic efforts—it comes from doing basic things over and over.

Pick a few non-negotiables (like 20 minutes of exercise, diet, reading,) and stick to them daily. Repetition is what turns effort into

habit. Build things slowly until you are disciplined in all areas of your life.

Tip 9: Know When To Rest

If your body is telling you to rest for several days in a row, listen. That is not weakness — that is the signal before burnout.

The trick to sustaining discipline long-term is to set challenges that are difficult but never so extreme that they break you.

Increase the difficulty by **five percent**, not twenty-five. As long as you are doing something to improve, you remain in control. A progressively harder workout. A slightly cleaner diet. A new monthly challenge.

Tip 10: Progressive Overload

When you take a new recruit into the military, they aren't just disciplined on their first day. They get shouted at and accustomed to discipline across many months.

It will take time to build yourself up to a level where you can get to the gym 5 times a week, eat 100% healthily, and to not take days off. The crazy thing is... what you once thought you would hate...

You start to **enjoy**. I enjoy waking up early for a workout, I enjoy avoiding a doughnut to eat a healthy breakfast. Through progressive overload you can get there too.

The Value Of Discipline

“The person who controls their discipline controls their life — their output, their health, their mood, their direction.”

When you build it, you will find that the days that once felt hard become the days you live for.

You will soon begin to see the value in discipline and how it benefits you. Doing hard stuff feels good. Hard times create strong people. You will start to find that the **best** days of your life are not the lazy ones. They are the **disciplined** ones.

I am going to set you some short term goals and exercises to complete to assist you with discipline.

4 Exercises To Build Discipline

Exercise 1: Listen to the audiobook Discipline Equals Freedom.

Something about Jocko Willincks military style upbringing and way of speaking can really help you to feel in the mood to set yourself new discipline challenges.

Exercise 2: Construct Your Own Discipline Challenges

There is a challenge called 75 hard that I use as inspiration for my own discipline challenges.

The 75 hard challenge is 75 days **straight** of:

- Reading 10 pages of a self improvement book every day.
- Two 45 minute workouts everyday (one outdoor and one indoor)
- Following a healthy diet of your choice.
 - Drink a gallon of water a day.

I adopt a simpler and easier approach for myself, because my life is already quite busy.

I already follow my AG4 advanced fitness program, which is a high workrate fitness programme designed for athletes, so even sticking to that requires discipline alone.

I would burn out with the demands of the 75 hard challenge alongside my already extensive fitness programme.

I create **reduced** versions of such challenges if I want to work on my discipline.

30 Days Discipline Challenge

- Workout Daily
- Follow Healthy Diet Of My Choice
- Read 5 Pages Of Self Improvement Book Daily
- Spend 5 Minutes Learning New Skill Daily

My current challenge is:

- Workout Daily Using My AG Workout System
- Follow High Protein Diet With No Chocolate Bars (My Current Weakness)
- Read 5 Pages Of Self Improvement Book Daily (A Reasonable Amount Of Pages)
- 20 Burpees Daily (I Don't Like Burpees, And They Tire Me Out More Than Any Other Exercise, So I Am Improving At Them For The Sake Of Discipline)

Can you see how my challenge isn't ridiculous? It's not 10 ice baths a week, with 100 burpees per day on top of my workout programme and already busy life. It's simply

pushing my discipline to grow instead of shrink, but in a manageable way. I actually find it better not to burn yourself out, and set challenges that will just **slightly** challenge you.

The challenges that grew me the most, weren't specifically the ones where I put myself through the most pain, but were the ones most focused on areas I wanted to improve on in my life.

A challenge to run a marathon with no training and put yourself through extreme hardship is cool, and there's no doubt you learn a lot.

I'm not saying don't push yourself and go on adventures from time to time.

But humble challenges such as reading a self development book for 10 minutes a day for a month straight, or keeping it simple by picking:

- One daily fitness target to do daily
- One nutrition target to stick to daily
 - One book to stick to daily

These challenges are the ones that developed me just as much.

Your discipline challenge to start with could be even more simple.

Habit Tracker 30 Day Challenge:

Follow a habit tracker for 30 days, with the habits of:

- Gratitude Journalling 3 Things Per Day
 - Meditation 1 Minute Per Day
 - Exercise In Any Form Daily
 - Reading 1 Page Per Day

Sticking to these basics alone can improve discipline in amazing ways.

Exercise 3: Journalling Exercise:

Ask yourself:

Who am I?

What have I learned?

What have I created?

What forward progress have I made?

Who have I helped?

What am I doing to improve myself-today?

*To get better, faster, stronger, healthier,
smarter?*

Is this what I want to be? This?

*Is this all I've got-is this everything I can
give?*

Is this going to be my life? Do I accept that?

Ask yourself those hard questions, and then
answer them, truthfully.

Are you spending your days becoming the
person you want to be?

Working on your life's work?

Will you look back on days like this and be
proud at the end of your lifetime? Or are you
wasting them?

Try and set challenges or discipline your life based around becoming the person you want to be.

Not showing off to others, but genuinely focus on the things that will move you forward.

One thing I realized is you don't need ice baths, its alright but really, you should think about the challenges that are actually going to help you follow your dreams.

Does Discipline Have To Be Hard?

People think discipline is hard and they have to hate it. But I want to leave you with a quote.

“Discipline is the enjoyment of life.”

You can build your life so you **enjoy** the discipline. When you really don't want to do something, and it's not ticked off your list, doing it is discipline.

Discipline is your diet too, your sleep, not just your gym, your personal challenges, your reading, how much of a good partner you are, your charity and goodness as a person, everything.

If you asked me to explain discipline it it's most **simple** way. It **is** doing hard things. To an extent. But also doing the things that most benefit you to become who you are meant to be.

It's about doing what's **best** for you to grow.

Before you set a discipline challenge, ask yourself is it just for the sake of it? Will it actually **develop** you in the areas you want?

It isn't pain for pain's sake. Before you set a challenge ask are you doing this for your ego or to look cool? Discipline is sometimes doing the boring easy stuff, that you know will put you in the place you need to be.

It isn't always the **big extreme** challenge everyone sees you doing so you can get attention and feel rewarded.

A challenge has to be aligned to build you up to be the person you actually want to be.

The ideal version of myself doesn't put himself through pain for the sake of it. He

doesn't take ice baths, or overtrain and do
1000 push ups a day.

He does however train **smart**, consistently,
and with his future dream in mind. He
constantly builds towards the right areas.

Those days that you tick off all the goals and
get so much done, are some of the **best** days
of your life. You will look back on these
types of days one day and be proud of them.

Wake up and think of the most **perfect** day
that the best version of yourself would
complete in order to follow their dreams.
And **execute** it repeatedly.

That is discipline done right.

Sleep

Sleep is important for just about everything.
For your gains in the gym, for your mood,
your performance at work.

Without sleep you will actually produce so
many hormones that will delay your
progress in the gym.

Tip 1:

**You Don't Have a Problem Waking Up, You
Have a Problem Going To Bed Early.**

People think waking up is the problem. But
really they have set themselves up for failure
the night before.

They struggle the most with not being able to switch off and pick a sensible bedtime, which in turn throws them off their game the next day.

This then affects their gym performance, their work performance and overall mood **drops** significantly.

The most important part of sleep is what you do to prepare the night **before**.

Once you have made your preparations to sleep, you have to be **strict** with yourself.

Avoid thinking about relationships, your to do list, or work no matter how much you want to.

If you really want to sleep well, then you have to understand that time during the day should be set out for things like processing traumas or difficult life events, making big life moves or plans, but when you are trying to sleep, you have to be **strict** with your own mind.

This is how you stop yourself from getting overstimulated.

Tip 2: Use Positive Night Time Habits That Relax You.

Switch out habits such as **overthinking**, or doing more work, and use habits such as positive visualisations (explained in the overthinking section) gratitude and meditations.

You can use the app Medito to play sleeping music and relaxing meditations. **Wind down** routines are very important.

Tip 3: Lower Your Heart Rate

We want to avoid **overstimulation** before bed. For example, binge watching high action bank robbery dramas on Netflix before we go to bed, or adrenaline pumping horror movies is not the best choice. Reality TV and dramas are too **engaging**, as they are designed to keep us hooked 24/7.

Go for nature shows, travel shows, on a low volume, or shows that we have seen so many times that we **know** the endings. This means our brain is not as interested.

Reading books is proven to be an effective **sleep aid**, and those that read tend to fall asleep easier than those that don't.

It is a good idea to pick a book that is quite boring actually. Find a book that is just interesting enough to where you don't hate it. If it excites you too much, you will **never** get to sleep.

Don't read something with **high emotional content**, or something too mathematical.

Avoid:

- Thrillers
- Horror
- Dark Fantasy

- Anything Complicated

Good Genres:

- Fantasy
- Non Fiction History Books

Tip 4: Switch Off Your Work Brain

To sleep, you need to switch off your “work brain.” Have tomorrow planned out and have all your tasks written out in a journal or on your notes app.

This is so we don’t stay up all night planning what to do the next day. Our mind knows we have it planned and under control.

Writing a to-do list journal for the next day has been shown in studies to be the top journaling technique for sleep.

Make the hard decision to not do any more work. Switch off “work mode.” Be **disciplined** to know you will produce more work tomorrow.

Ask yourself:

“Would I rather do 5 extra hours of work now when I am tired and unproductive, affecting my work day for tomorrow and resulting in more bad work?”

Or is it better to get some sleep and keep the quality of my work high?”

It's usually better to just get the sleep so you can continue to output high quality work in all that you do.

Tip 5: The Sleep Stack

A good sleep stack to boost your sleep is:

L-Theanine
Pistachio Nuts (Contain Melatonin)
Magnesium 400mg
Chamomile Tea

Melatonin 0.5mg (Optional - For The Really Sleepless Nights)

Tip 6: Use Light To Your Advantage

Firstly, when you wake up early, step outside into the sunlight if possible first thing when you wake up. This **signals** to your body that this is the natural time to wake up.

Actually go out into the direct sunlight.

Studies have shown that when taking a scanner that measures the amount of light your exposed to, even on a cloudy day, stepping outside into direct sunlight will give you **100 times** the sunlight rating that you would get staying inside.

When it comes to night time, be mindful of keeping the lights on as they are artificial lights that signal to your body to stay awake.

Blue light is especially a type of light that keeps us awake, and is commonly used by our iPhone screens and TV's.

I switch all my phones to low brightness and “**Night Mode**” which is a special mode that turns the screen orange, using orange light instead of blue light, to help you sleep.

Select red or dim orange style lamps over powerful white lights, or blue lights. If you are reading try to read under a dim lamp, or try to read using the **dark mode** on your kindle.

This dark mode turns the screen black and helps a lot with sleep.

Tip 7: Use A Mouth Tape

If you are a mouth breather at night, unfortunately it is shown that it is not as healthy to breathe through your mouth when you sleep.

Try to breathe through your nose with a short inhale and an extended exhale. To fix mouth breathing you can tape your mouth shut with a “micropore tape” from Amazon.

This is shown to boost your sleep quality by approximately 30%

Tip 8: The Bed Is For 2 Things:

Sleep and Sex.

Essentially, we want the bed to cue us for sleep. If we do too many other things in bed, then our brains don't have an **idea** that it is time to sleep.

Tip 9: Avoid Naps

If you're having trouble sleeping, napping is simply not a good idea, it adversely affects our sleep cycle.

We build up a "sleepiness" chemical called adenosine from the moment we wake up. More adenosine = more sleepy. Napping lowers adenosine levels.

Tip 10: Avoid Caffeine And Alcohol

Reduce your stimulant use: Caffeine and nicotine have a half-life of 5–6 hours.

That means it takes 10–12 hours to clear your system completely. Cut yourself off by noon or early afternoon if you want a good night sleep.

Drinking a lot of water can help improve the elimination of these substances from your body, but not by that much.

Avoid alcohol, it causes nightmares and interrupted sleep.

Conclusion On Sleep

To conclude, sleep is really going to affect your fitness progress as well as your mental health progress, entire books can be written on the reasons why.

Please don't **underestimate** this area of your life and attempt to hit it with the same discipline as your gym and diet programmes. My recommendation is to follow the steps in this chapter, and treat night time as a relaxing time, not a time for overthinking or anything too intense.

Remember that fixing your sleep is going to give a large percentage boost to your productivity and mood, giving you a better chance to succeed in nearly every aspect of your life.

Imposter Syndrome

*Have you ever walked into a room and felt
like you had no right to be there?*

That feeling has a name. **Imposter syndrome.**

The voice that tells you that you are a fraud,
that someone is about to find you out, that
everyone around you is more qualified and
more deserving.

It is one of the most common things I see in
the people I work with. And most of the
people I work with allow it to hold them
back way more than necessary!

Four People Who Almost Let It Stop Them

John

John recently found out he had a child on the way.

He had been waking up everyday with a love for fitness, and even though he was offered a job in his old field of computing that paid more, he wanted to inspire his future child to follow their dreams, so he decided to go with his passion for fitness.

Deep down, John had a drive that would completely out match anyone.

He would do all the reading required of him, he would train from sunrise to sundown, and simply had the type of **personality** and passion to become one of the best trainers in the city.

John applied straight for the **best** gyms in his city. He knew he wanted to train amongst the best.

With a child on the way, he knew that he couldn't be working in a small gym with no **progression** opportunities, he wouldn't be able to make it work for his child on a minimum wage.

John went straight for the **best** gyms. John was simply the kind of person at this stage in his life who would commit to a company for the long term, commit seriously to the development opportunities available, and outwork everyone.

He had only held his fitness training license for 4 months, but had taught boxing training for 5 years.

John knew he had a special gift for connecting and training people, and learned quicker than other people, but as he stepped into the interview room alongside the other applicants, he **doubted** his ability to train as well as those who had been in the business for 10 years.

He stood against these other trainers with a long list of credentials, forgetting that his own unique background could be a breath of fresh air to the company.

The voice started: “you shouldn’t be here. You haven’t earned this yet.”

John trained his clients with upmost passion and in a unique way that would in fact be valuable to a company.

He suddenly got the feeling like he **shouldn't** be in the room, based on his lack of experience alone.

What John could not see was that the company were not looking for the most experienced trainer.

They were looking for someone humble, coachable, and ready to **commit**. John matched that perfectly. He got the job.

The imposter syndrome was present — but he stayed composed, tried anyway, and it changed his life.

Billy

Billy was a talented left handed boxer who had been boxing for only **2 years**. He had won a lot of amateur fights, and made an exceptional transformation.

Billy used to be overweight, and went from fat to a fit boxer.

He had recorded his journey of his weight loss on YouTube.

Billy noticed lots of left handed people were responding to his internet boxing videos of him punching the bag for weight loss. People were impressed with his technique, as well as the videos of his 2 amateur fights.

Billy's audience were asking him to film online courses to help them. They kept asking the same thing: *"where are the tutorials for us? There is nothing out there."*

There aren't many videos on the internet for left handed boxers, and Billy had a lot of information that would be critical to this audience.

Billy didn't see it this way though. His imposter syndrome kicked in and told him that he didn't have the authority to make a course because he wasn't a pro boxer yet.

He sat on it for a month, feeling like as an amateur he didn't have the authority yet to release what he wanted to. Billy decided to battle with these thoughts and released the course anyway.

The course went viral, made him £100,000 in his first 3 months, and he received messages from countless people thanking him greatly for the information.

The truth is through his **transformation**, Billy had learned information that was a **treasure** to his audience. The knowledge he thought was ordinary was **gold** to the people who needed it.

Kelly

Kelly was a finance director who had produced some of the best work of any manager at her bank in the USA.

Kelly was in a job interview for a slightly larger bank. Kelly had a **photographic** memory when it came to numbers, and quite honestly would have been a **better fit** at this bank than any of the other applicants.

As she sat across from applicants who had worked for slightly **larger** firms, in slightly bigger titles, a bead of sweat ran down her forehead. I shouldn't be here.

She was wrong. But imposter syndrome does not deal in facts. It deals in feelings.

Nick

Nick Mira was simply a teenager in his room, first discovering how to **produce** music. He barely knew how to operate a mixing desk or the functions of the music programme he was using when he first started.

What gave him the **confidence** to post music tutorials? He didn't have the attitude that he was "the best" music producer with the most information.

He simply had the attitude that he was sharing what he learned as he went through his journey, and this attitude was beneficial enough for **thousands** of young teenagers across the world.

I saw Nick's transformation in real time, as thousands of teenagers across the world started to follow his label "Internet Money" where he aimed to **show** young people how to make money on the internet through selling music.

Nick overtook the older generation, who knew more about him when it came to mixing desks and composing music in general. How did he do that?

His first beats were not the **best** by any means, but making his tutorials and having the courage to post his journey helped him to make money selling tutorials to others.

It was almost like he was learning the producing software as he went, whilst also showing others and helping them to learn.

Nick got more exposure, moved into villas with other musicians, and placed himself in an environment with other young musicians who believed in his cause.

Nick had a lot of talented guitarists and musicians emailing him for collaborations, also with the dream to make money on the internet.

He had built connections with good musicians, and this allowed Nick to **organize** everything together to create hits for top artists across America.

My point in telling this story is that there were many talented teenagers around that time who had better music hidden away on their computers...

Who simply didn't involve themselves in the process of putting themselves out there, and in return, they never got to sit in the same rooms Nick did.

They never got the same exposure to the industry, and never maintained consistency.

All because they didn't believe they could start something, whereas Nick had a plan, executed through **imperfection**, and eventually built something great.

Why Imposter Syndrome Lies To You

Imposter syndrome **holds you back** by asking questions designed to stop you before you start.

*"What gives me the authority to do fitness
content when I don't look like Arnold
Schwarzenegger?"*

Hint: People buy most and relate most from
everyday transformations and not those on
steroids. You are still valid.

*"What gives me the authority to approach
and talk to this girl or guy I don't know at
the pub?"*

Hint: That girl or guy likes you, and you may
be the perfect partner for them if you just got
out of your head and talked to them.

"What gives me the authority to apply for a job when I don't meet every requirement?"

Hint: Job descriptions are wishlists, not entry barriers. Many employers hire for potential, attitude, and adaptability — not perfect CV matches.

"What gives me the authority to start a business when I've never done it before?"

Hint: Every business owner was inexperienced at some point. The first version of most successful businesses was built by someone figuring it out in real time.

*“What gives me the authority to share advice
when there are people more qualified than
me?”*

Hint: Fresh perspectives often come from those without long term bias. You may see solutions others have stopped noticing.

*"What gives me the authority to share advice
when there are people more qualified than
me?"*

Hint: People don't only learn from the most qualified — they learn from whoever explains things in a way they can actually understand.

“What gives me the authority to try something creative when I’m not “naturally talented”?”

Hint: Most creativity is repetition, not talent. Early attempts are supposed to be average — that’s the entry price of improvement.

"What gives me the authority to start training others when I'm still improving myself?"

Hint: Teaching accelerates learning. You don't need to be finished to be useful — you just need to be a few steps ahead of someone else.

By teaching or learning from mistakes in places that are beyond us, this **accelerates** our learning.

I want you to realise that imposter syndrome doesn't allow us to reach our true potential — it makes us miss out on opportunities to become our best.

Some practical tips to consider:

Tip 1: There Is Someone With Less, Doing More

There are people less talented than you, more stupid than you, who are earning more than you, just because they took action

Whilst you sat there and thought you weren't
good enough.

**Tip 2: You Are Likely Exactly What Someone
Is Looking For**

There are companies that would be blessed
to have you, you are exactly what they are
looking for.

But they will never get the blessing of
working with you if you doubt yourself.

**Tip 3: What Seems Like Common
Knowledge To You Is Gold To Other People**

You are biased because you live the same
life daily.

A boxer uses the same 5 punch combo and thinks it's basic. But really, that is **amazing** to an average person.

A gym instructor does 40 push ups, meanwhile someone who is new to working out is amazed they can even do 1.

A top salesman can persuade someone to buy something within 5 minutes — he uses a script he learned off by heart where he has an answer to everything.

Every objection a customer could have, he finds a way to smoothly get around. To him it's just another day, but to a newcomer to the company, the way he speaks is like **magic**.

We all have skills that we think everyone else has. When really others find these skills magical.

Tip 4: Imposter Syndrome Is A Good Sign

Imposter syndrome is a sign you are doing something right. You are pushing yourself outside of your comfort zone.

It may be hard, it may seem **slightly** above your current level, but it is always worth a try. You don't have to be the best, you just need to start.

When it comes to applying for jobs, employers don't always want the best in terms of **credentials**, but the best fit personality wise.

When it comes to selling products, people do buy from people who are at the top of an industry, as they have credibility.

But in many industries, someone too far above them in terms of credentials alienates the buyer, because the buyer cannot **relate** to them.

People feel too far away from stages that are too advanced for them, and tend to buy mentorship, advice and products from people who are 2 or 3 steps **ahead** of them.

They can relate more to someone close to their level, rather than someone who is 5 steps ahead from them. At that stage the gap in understanding is too great.

In fact you can often get a lot of sales by teaching a concept in a way that is more **simple**, or more **friendly** than someone else.

That's why you don't have to be a professional boxer to teach the sport, you could be an amateur that is simply more friendly and has a more **simplistic** style of explanation. Many people will gravitate to you more than a professional with a more **complicated** teaching style.

The same way in a job, employers may not always go for the most qualified applicant, but who they feel would **fit** most into the team. No one wants to come to work, where we spend 80% of our lives, and have to deal with someone they don't get on well with, even if they have the best credentials.

The feelings of why would anyone listen to me, of not being good enough, of being an imposter — we must **overcome** that. And the sooner the better.

Remember:

"Success often comes less from talent, and more from the willingness to act despite doubt."

3 Exercises To Beat Imposter Syndrome

Here are 3 exercises you can use to challenge imposter syndrome.

Exercise 1: Things I'm Doing That I'm Not Ready For - Journaling Exercise

Complete this sentence 10 times:

"I don't feel ready to ____, but I'm doing it anyway because ____."

Exercise 2 - Collecting Evidence That You Are Who You Say You Are

Write down:

- 5 things you've achieved (big or small)
- 5 skills you've developed
- 3 times you helped someone else improve

Then ask:

“If this was someone else, would I think they're a fraud?”

Most people immediately realise the answer is no.

If the answer is yes, ask yourself:

“Whats the worst that can happen if I try anyway? Will I actually loose anything or just improve massively by throwing myself in the deep end?”

“Will I Improve more by going this route or by staying in the same place, not taking action.”

“Do I accept that if I am scared to put myself out there, or challenge myself with a growth mindset, I will probably not do as well as those with less who do put themselves out there?”

Employers and people in general are more impressed by those that try and have a growth mindset, so remember to never count yourself out!

Exercise 3 - The “They’re Not Special” Lens

This is blunt but effective.

Think of someone doing what you want to do.

Ask yourself:

- Are they actually more capable than me?
- Or did they just start earlier, put themselves out there more, and stay consistent?
- Are they perfect? Do they have bad days? They may have done this longer than me, but does that mean they will burn out before me?
- Do I have more drive than them because of this?
- Do I bring a unique angle?

This removes the illusion that others are uniquely qualified. When you actually think about it, everyone in a room is going to have some weakness.

I know it sounds harsh, but you could even sit and think of other people in your field who are competing against you.

Deep Down, they probably do have undeniable weaknesses, ask yourself if you really Believe they are as perfect as the image of them you have in your head is.

We are all unique and going on our own unique journies, we all have strengths and weaknesses, meaning we are all valuable.

That person with 10 years of experience could be burning out with an attitude that is growing worse and worse every day.

For you not to try would be a crime to yourself and to the people or companies you could help or provide a great service for.

Final Thoughts On Imposter Syndrome

The information provided in this chapter will help you to focus on catching the best

opportunities for yourself rather than
overthinking.

Being a little “out of your depth” in life never
hurt anybody, it’s usually round about
exactly where you want to be to succeed.

Set yourself the goals that are **impossibly
possible**, just beyond possible but still in
reach, and you will achieve them.

You will one day become an authority in
areas you never imagined and incredible
opportunities will reach you, all from **taking
action** and taking the **decision** to believe in
yourself.

Imagine that life where you are **one day**
teaching others what you are unsure of now,
laughing at how far you have come, and
proud of yourself for taking that step.

Let's take the steps together to stamp out imposter syndrome, and achieve what we know we deserve in life.

Anxiety

Two people were victims of a car crash. Jenny was a person who had anxiety. She locked herself indoors.

She listened to advice online such as “take your time,” “heal when you’re ready,” and “be kind to yourself,” so she didn’t push herself to go to the gym even though she knew she probably should.

She thought that she was being kind and patient with herself.

Over time, it wasn't just the gym she was scared to go to. She was scared to leave her house. She had got so used to staying indoors. The voice in her head telling her to stay there all the time won.

Her life became very limited. Jenny was kind to herself and took her time, but misinterpreted being kind to herself as taking no action.

Terry was a person who also had anxiety from the event. Terry knew he didn't want to go out. But his therapist told him he couldn't withdraw.

His therapist told him he had to do the things that scared him in order to get through.

Though this triggered panic attacks, Terry's therapist reassured him that this was normal.

Terry was kind to himself, going to yoga, painting classes, and not living a crazy life, but slowly pushing himself more. He had the occasional night out with alcohol-free drinks, went to the occasional boxing class, and attended support groups.

He found a good balance of pushing his comfort zone and relaxing activities to ensure stress didn't get too high.

He ensured he always pushed himself to do the basics that were going to keep him out of the house and in shape.

Though the panic attacks were bad at first, and he sometimes felt like he was moving

towards them instead of running away,
eventually they became less and less.

Terry regained control of his life, hit records
in his gym sessions, and realised that the
alarms going off in his head were simply
ringing for no reason.

It was simply a life event that had knocked
him, but through being kind to himself,
staying active, and attending support groups,
he realised the world wasn't all so bad.

This chapter is about anxiety and how to
slowly move towards resolving it without
hiding.

Move Towards Anxiety, Instead Of Fighting To Avoid It

The book that helped me to understand “moving towards” anxiety the most was Route 91 by Dr Sheva Gaed. I had some clients that had PTSD and anxiety disorders and this book really helped me to help them through.

Some people give very one dimensional advice when it comes to anxiety. You will often hear:

“Take your medication”

“Stay indoors until you feel ready”

“Go easy on yourself and don’t expose yourself to any triggers.”

I think this advice has some truth to it but is also dangerous.

There's nothing wrong with being kind to yourself, but by playing it safe, staying indoors, and staying put until you feel "ready" with no action on your part, can result in cases where people lose all momentum in their battle against anxiety.

Some people are not active enough in their battle against anxiety, they let their anxiety consume them, and end up never being "ready" to make a change due to constant avoidance of what they actually need to do.

What if we are running away from what we should be moving towards?

Most of the qualified advice given to tackle cases of anxiety explains that, to manage anxiety, instead of running away from it, or trying to fight it, we should learn to accept it and relax into it. We should not practice avoidance of these feelings.

Through leaning into our anxiety, and experiencing it enough times, we often realise that it cannot kill us, and then by that realisation, the anxiety often fixes itself.

It is only through the correct mindset and a willingness to move forward can we do this.

Here's the truth, with anxiety, you do have the choice of never facing up to it, you have the choice of trying to completely avoid any situations that cause you anxiety. This is called "avoidance" by therapists.

But, if you take the choice not to face your fears, you can quickly reach a point where you are so anxious you cannot even leave your house. You tell yourself: “I’ll be ready to conquer this tomorrow.”

And if you have reached this point, staying at home, not going out, telling yourself you will move forwards tomorrow, without a plan of immediate action, you are in the danger zone.

Tomorrow never comes for a lot of people.
Especially when they do not have a solid plan.

When you reach the stage of not leaving your house and avoiding everything, anxiety has completely won. Some people stay waiting to “get ready” to beat anxiety for years.

Not only that, but staying in their house and not leaving means a person gets used to being inside. This may start with just one day inside.

Then two, then, the anxious voice in their head telling them to stay in grows stronger, the habit to stay inside is reinforced. The more days they stay in, the more the habit is built. The anxious voice becomes more real over time, and the longer it is consistently listened to, the harder it becomes to ignore.

The anxiety gets worse due to no social connections, no walks in nature, no exercise, or contact with support groups or friends.

In this situation, anxiety becomes out of control, and before a person knows it, what seemed somewhat conquerable beforehand,

becomes a real disability keeping them indoors. At this stage anxiety is really hard to break free of as you have already set habits that are keeping you at home and isolated.

Staying isolated and hiding from anxiety is the worst thing you could do.

The Concept Of Exposure

What actually helps anxiety is the concept of “exposure.” where you slowly expose yourself to situations that cause you anxiety in order to face your fears.

A book that explains this concept is Route 91, written by Shiva Gaed who was a therapist that helped patients through anxiety and PTSD.

Shiva ended up being a witness to the Las Vegas mass shooting where she witnessed many people who were shot and killed. This was a traumatic event which gave her PTSD alongside many other people.

To prove that her therapy techniques worked, Dr Shiva used her own techniques on herself, alongside a bunch of other survivors from this event, to heal herself of her own anxiety attacks and PTSD.

Shiva successfully created a help group for survivors of the Vegas shooting and helped them get their lives back by involving them with her methods.

Of course after a mass shooting, many patients anxiety levels were extremely high. It was normal for the survivors of this event

to not want to go out of their homes. They would avoid loud places. Everywhere seemed dangerous to them.

But Shiva was an expert on PTSD and anxiety. Shiva said that there needs to be a safe “bare minimum” that is to be committed to to ensure a person with anxiety doesn’t fall completely off track.

No matter how many panic attacks happened, she encouraged her patients to leave their homes. At the very minimum she encouraged them to go to the gym and exercise, to go to the shops, and go to work.

You see, as I said earlier, if a person gets to the point where they avoid all public places, they don’t work out (which is necessary to produce the chemicals to reduce anxiety and

depression) and they avoid all social interaction, they shortly become not only anxious, but depressed too.

Once you build that habit of avoiding life for too long, and feeling scared of the world, it is so hard to break.

I myself have had clients who fell into this rut. They accepted without any give or take that they were scared of the outside world, and took active avoidance of it.

These clients really struggled, for years as a result of this decision. I noticed that pattern very commonly, as did Dr Shiva Ghaed in her book.

The clients who at least tried, who pushed themselves daily, who exposed themselves

gradually each day more than the last to the outside world and to their trigger situations, showed excellent transformations. Many of them were completely fine within a year in most cases.

What Does The Danger Zone Look Like?

You have reached the point where you are codependent on someone else to leave the house. This looks like only leaving or feeling able to go outside when someone else is with you.

You have reached a point where you aren't taking a responsibility to at least exercise, go to work, or leave the house for support groups and sociability.

You totally avoid public places.

If anxiety has got to that point, for you there is only one thing left for you to do. And that is act.

How do we go about doing this?

One step at a time.

The Value Of Facing Our Fears

The most problematic reactions when it comes to anxiety are avoidance behaviors, as they interfere with recovery.

People build avoiding the things they need to do to be happy into their personality and avoiding becomes their default. The first thing Dr Shiva did was reassure her fellow

group members that she was following her own guidance, and shared personal examples of “exposure” activities to help them understand the value of facing their fears.

She let them know to start small but to take action. Maybe they didn’t feel ready to go to the thing that gave them EXTREME anxiety to begin with..

Maybe not a big concert, festival, fair, or amusement park. But she told them to start smaller, with slightly less anxiety provoking activities.

“Start with Walmart, IKEA, or Costco. If that’s too much, start with smaller places where there are other people around since that is often what we avoid.”

The same way you start with lower weights in gym and build up your tolerance, you can do the same with situations that make you anxious. Progressively overload your outings. The more you go out and have safe experiences, the more you will have positive experiences and realise the anxiety is unjust.

Here is an exercise:

Write down a list of all the things you think you may be avoiding right now, and then rank each one on a scale of 1 to 10. The “1” is a relatively low or minimal level of anxiety. (avoidance)

The “10” is the highest level of anxiety you can imagine (maybe panic attack zone), and thus you avoid it the most –

more than most other things.

Once you have established the fear hierarchy, start with the activities listed at about a 3 or 4 and start moving up your fear ladder.

The reason we start with 3 or 4 is that these activities will produce just enough anxiety for you to feel challenged.

If noisy crowds or clubs make you nervous, then you go into lots of crowded places until it doesn't cause you panic and anxiety anymore.

If boxing makes you nervous, you need go to boxing class until it doesn't. You get the idea.

These exposure activities help us to understand the difference between *real* and

perceived threats. It is like when a person gets anxiety about public speaking the first time they do it.

However if they were booked in for 5 speeches a day for 2 months, they would likely reach a stage where public speaking became just another normal day to them.

Everytime you go out there, you realise the world is not out to get you.

Every walk in nature you go on, where some dog walkers smile at you and you realise nothing bad happened. Every time you go to the gym, you realise people are friendly. You start to realise the world is fine. You start to realise you can conquer this.

Conquering Anxiety Can Make You Stronger

Once you work your way up your list of anxieties, you will transform as a person. You may find you not only bounce back from this condition, but bounce beyond.

You may become a stronger person, a more grateful person, a person who feels closer to others and is able to help them through their fears.

A person who is able to find the joy in a small walk, and the feeling of walking freely down the street without fear.

You can actually bounce back beyond who you originally were, and become an all around better person, with the experience of

facing your fears successfully. This can lead to feelings of extreme confidence and really turn you into a new person who would smile back at the you who is facing anxiety now, because you are going to grow into a very strong character.

I am now going to give you 8 further tips to help with conquering anxiety.

8 Tips To Conquer Anxiety

Tip 1: Expose Yourself Daily And Progressively To That Which You Fear

Expose yourself slowly to what you fear as mentioned above. We can slowly take small,

but frequent steps to expose ourselves to that which we most fear, to realise there's nothing to fear. Do the opposite of withdraw. (most people withdraw, that's the worst thing)

Tip 2: Helping Others, And Gratitude

Research shows that healing happens rapidly when you help others and engage in lots of acts of random kindness. Healing cannot occur when the opposite happens (arming up, holing in, avoiding others and practicing a negative mindset).

When we help others heal, we heal.. It helps us challenge habits of negative thinking, (about how horrible, unkind, and unsafe the world is) because: “when we show

compassion and kindness we believe that maybe things are not so bad and others may share these values as well.”

If we act as strong positive people with righteous values, we know there are others out there too. We must release that other people do good every day for every bad person out there there are those doing good.

It’s not that you have to step into bad areas with a gold Rolex on and not keep your wits about you. But you need to acquire a balanced view of the world.

Tip 3 - Get Great Sleep

Poor sleep can impact anxiety by up to 30 - 40% percent. The numbers may be higher

depending on how bad a nights sleep you got.

Sleep is very underestimated, not only for general fitness, but for the large amount of mental health issues it can cause if sleep is poor.

Visit the sleep section in this book for an understanding of how to excel in this area.

Tip 4 - Seek Help - Try EDMR Therapy or CBT

Seeking help is the most important tip. Don't delay it, because untreated anxiety can sometimes not get better without professional intervention.

EDMR therapy is a intense form of therapy that really helps if you have a lot of panic attacks, traumas or anxiety considered on the high end of the scale.

I have spoke to clients that have had great results with this therapy. CBT therapy is also a great option.

With correct medication and therapy selected, anxiety is a highly treatable disorder and your symptoms can become nonexistent.

Tip 5: Avoid Caffeine, Alcohol, And Drugs.

Caffeine is a stimulant, and stimulants naturally spike anxiety and make your heart race faster, not what you want when you are trying to keep your anxiety at bay.

Alcohol simply wrecks your mental health in numerous ways. I always noticed whenever a client of mine had a panic attack, I would ask

them if they drank alcohol that week. The answer would be yes a lot of the time.

Drugs such as cannabis, and hard drugs, are a no go for a person suffering with anxiety.

The paranoia that you feel on these drugs after the initial high, causes your anxiety levels to spike.

Tip 6: Challenge Catastrophic Thoughts And Thoughts That Lead To More Anxiety.

People with anxiety tend to think in catastrophic thoughts. Thoughts like:

“My relationship is going to suffer.”

“I’m going to lose my job.”

“My partner doesn’t love me.”

Once you allow those thoughts to spiral,
panic attacks can start.

CBT is the main tool therapists use to help
challenge these thoughts.

Here is an exercise:

Write down a belief that you have been
telling yourself recently (that continues to
make you anxious).

Ask the questions:

*If my best friend or someone I love came to
me and made this statement, what would I
say to them?*

*Will I feel the same way about this situation
in 10 years?*

*Will this seem as important or urgent in the
future?*

*Would I lack compassion for my child or
spouse as I do for myself?*

*If I had to defend this belief in a courtroom,
would I be able to prove it to a jury? Do I
have ample evidence to support this belief?*

*Do I have any evidence that actually
contradicts my belief?*

Is this belief a fact or based on a feeling?

Does this thought seem extreme or unbalanced in any way? Is there a middle ground?

Is there a way I can look on the positive side of this thought?

After you identify that a thought is unhelpful, look for ways to reframe it as a positive thought.

Look for ways to look on the bright side, and the best possible scenario instead of the worst.

You can work through your traumas and anxiety inducing thoughts with CBT workbooks. You can also work with a CBT

therapist to explain you want to work on these type of thoughts.

Tip 7 - Read Some Books To Help You Take Action

I have compiled a list of well reviewed books that my clients have used to help themselves through this difficult condition:

DARE by Barry McDonagh. This is the main book most of my clients recommend for anxiety. It identifies with the condition and provides practical examples to help.

Hope And Help For Your Nerves by Dr. Claire Weekes (Audiobook) (Teaches you to ride the wave of anxiety.)

The Anxiety and Phobia Workbook by
Bourne (helps with panic attacks. They have
a list of affirmations/sayings that you can
recite when you feel a panic attack coming
on)

***Faith G. Harper's Unfck Your Anxiety and
Coping Skills: Tools & Techniques for Every
Stressful Situation.*** *Any of her Unfck series*
may fit. They are short reads with just
enough science to help with understanding
but mostly full of concrete strategies and tips.

"Overcoming Anxiety, Worry, and Fear" by
Gregory Jantz (Easy to read and is written
by a counselor. Designed to help you isolate
the sources of your anxiety and teach you
techniques to manage/cope with stress.)

Tip 8 - Balance Your Lifestyle

Even though our aim is to push ourselves to leave comfort zones and conquer anxieties, we must balance this out with self care.

Self care isn't staying at home avoiding everything as we talked about, but you can make sure your life isn't a complete roller coaster of adrenaline as well.

If our life is always loud music, clubs, driving fast, pushing your comfort zone 24 / 7, then you can be facing your fears. But it can lead to even more anxiety.

Where we push for change is very important.

Of course, we want to push for change in areas such as leaving the house, social

interaction, going to the gym, surrounding
ourselves with people and feeling safe. Phobias
in these areas really hold us back.

Any unfounded phobia that holds us back
from exercising or functioning as happy
people who look after ourselves in our day to
day life is worth addressing.

It doesn't mean we have to go above and
beyond this, or do crazy things to try and fix
these phobias by leading a **hectic** lifestyle.

Do not neglect the side of your soul that
needs to be at peace. You'll notice a
correlation between how hectic your life is
and how much anxiety you feel. Where you
choose to push for change is important.

Let's say for example you have some social anxiety. If you choose to combat that by going to loud club environments daily, it is **great** that you are trying.

But if your lifestyle then becomes drinking alcohol, always “switched on” and always in a state of adrenaline activities, you can end up sabotaging your progress.

You could just as easily build social interaction in some kind of class, a yoga class or something similar.

When you take steps to zen out your life, you can notice a reduce in anxiety too. The balance is that you need to be working on your anxieties every day, but don't let that consume your whole life!

We **established** that you don't want to stay at home, but we also established you don't want to have a crazy, no sleep, constantly crazy lifestyle either. High stress lifestyles and high stimulating lifestyles can contribute a lot to feelings of anxiety.

To balance this out:

- Get A Massage
- Try Yoga Classes
- Meditate And Tell Yourself Positive Things
- Light Swimming (Proven To Be One Of The Leading Exercises For Anxiety Reduction)
- Life Journalling With Peaceful Music Playing
- Read A Self Improvement Book

Dealing With Panic Attacks

Manage panic attacks by accepting them and getting stronger at realising they are just adrenaline. Every panic attack you conquer is your body getting used to them and realising they cannot kill you.

Sometimes, when a person's anxiety builds to a certain point, a panic attack happens.

This can be confusing to both the person and the people around them, especially on the first time it happens.

If you are the person having the panic attack, it can feel like you are going to have a heart attack.

Here are some common myths about panic.

“I’m going crazy.”

Unlikely. Panic can feel intense, but it’s not psychosis. It doesn’t involve delusions or hallucinations—just your body’s alarm system activating.

“I’m losing control.”

No. It may feel that way, but your fight-flight-freeze response is designed to protect you. In reality, your body becomes quicker, stronger, and more alert.

“My body is going to shut down.”

Not happening. Your nervous system is built

to activate *and* calm down. Panic won't wear out your body—it's temporary.

“I'm having a heart attack.”

Very unlikely. Panic attacks and heart attacks feel different. Your heart rate during panic is usually lower than during intense exercise or a real cardiac event.

“I'm going to faint.”

Unlikely. Fainting comes from *low* blood pressure, while panic raises it. You might feel dizzy, but that's not the same as passing out.

Panic attacks are scary, but they aren't dangerous. Now I am going to explain how to deal with a panic attack.

What to Do When Panic Hits

You can have two different types of panic attack. A panic attack that builds slowly with thoughts of unsettlement, racing what if thoughts, and generally worrying about danger or embarrassment. Or sometimes you can have sudden panic attacks out of nowhere where your heart starts to race.

Step 1: Stay Safe

- Sit or lie down safely
- Remind yourself: **“This is a panic attack. It is scary, but not dangerous.”**

What to do:

1. **Label the thoughts:** “I’m having catastrophic thoughts. These are not

real danger.” Name sensations and emotions: “Heart racing. Fear rising. I can feel this and still be safe.”

2. **Use grounding:** Counting down 5-4-3-2-1 helps bring you back into the present. You can also touch an object to make you realise you are still here and can feel your body in the moment. Look around and name 5 things you see, 4 things you touch, 3 things you hear (grounding)
3. **Use box breathing:** 4seconds inhale, 4 seconds hold and 4 seconds exhale
4. **Reframe it:** “This is scary, but my body is safe.” “It is just adrenaline.”
5. **Redirect attention:** Gentle activity if possible (walk, fold laundry, draw, light TV) or stay still.

6. **Ride it out:** Panic peaks ~10 minutes, then naturally decreases, sometimes you can get repeated attacks and feel hungover for the rest of the day, but tell yourself: “this is temporary, it is going to pass soon.
7. **Optional journaling:** After panic passes, jot down what happened — helps with exposure learning.

How To Respond During a Flashback

Sometimes you will get intense flashbacks if your anxiety is triggered by a serious event. This is when your anxiety matches the description of PTSD.

Grounding Is Key

A. Remind the brain you're in the present:

- Name the room, objects, sounds, temperature
- “I am here. I am safe. This is a memory, not happening now.”

B. Mindful awareness

- Name sensations without judgment:
“My heart is racing. My hands are shaking. This is a flashback.”
- Accept the feeling instead of fighting it
— trying to suppress can **intensify it**

C. Body orientation

- Place feet on the floor, sit upright
- Slowly move hands or touch a nearby object
- Anchors you in the **here and now**

D. Breathing

- Box breathing (4seconds inhale, 4 seconds hold, 4 seconds exhale) to calm nervous system
- Focus on slow exhale → signals safety to body

This is an effective way to navigate a panic attack.

On the other side of this, if you are the person trying to reassure someone through a panic attack:

Firstly, They aren't going to die, they are safe.

Never tell the person to “just stop thinking about it” or try to “snap them out” of it.

The truth is... the attack is going to run for a minimum of 10 minutes, and can last up to an hour if there are repeated attacks. It's going to be difficult and uncomfortable at times, and there's no rushing a person through a panic attack.

The adrenaline won't simply stop flowing through there body because you said so. You have to face the fact a panic attack will take time to run it's course and accept that.

My best advice would be to display no panic in your own actions. If you yourself panic when someone else is going through a panic attack, and show it on your face, it will make the person panic more.

You have to strike a balance between caring for them, asking if they are ok, but also showing that there is nothing scary going on in the room, and that life is continuing as normal.

Don't start jumping around, hyperventilating and mirroring their anxiety. You are this persons rock, showing them calmly that everything is ok.

I understand it can be awkward when a person is not responding to you for half an hour straight, you feel like you are checking up on them and saying the same things for an hour and nothing is working. But there is no rushing a panic attack.

You have to understand that it takes time for them to return a relaxed state of mind. For you, it may feel like an hour out of your time, where you are going around in circles repeating to the person that it is going to be ok, but for the person having the panic attack it's even worse!

Time goes extremely slow for them. It can feel like an eternity, a 20 minute panic attack can feel like 4 hours for them.

My **best** advice is to make the situation as chilled as you possibly can.

Don't turn off all the lights and all the TV and hide them under the covers unless they specifically want that. That can sometimes signal that "it's panic attack time" and something is wrong.

Almost like you are taking cover and protecting yourselves. Don't signal that anything is wrong.

Go about your moment with this person, without panicking yourself. If they want the TV on you can watch TV, if they want it off that's ok too.

Try to show this person that you are sharing a normal, safe environment and there is nothing in the atmosphere to suggest otherwise.

Also understand the person may need a mixture of comfort and space going through this moment. There is a balance to be found.

You will be able to tell that sometimes the person going through the attack needs space.

I'm not saying to ignore the person or leave the room, but go about your business showing them that you're still in the room present with them and near them, and that the day is going on, with no danger around.

Don't sit there tense or awkwardly. Answer some emails on your phone, be nearby for them. You don't want to smother them when you can tell they don't want that.

You don't want to be asking the same question "are you ok?" every 10 seconds and clinging onto them when they are agitated.

In these moments you can simply just watch the TV or sit on your phone, stay near them, and be still. Not panicking, not smothering, simply there.

Of course you don't want to take this too far,
and ignore them completely.

Every once in a while, you want to hug them
if possible and repeat the following
statements:

"I'm here for you."

"It's going to be Ok."

*"Breathe with me: In 4 seconds. Hold 4
seconds. Out 4 seconds."*

"You are safe"

"Do you know where you are"

"Do you need anything"

"Nothing here can hurt you"

"Take your time, I'm here."

Use their reaction to see if they want you
directly next to them, or simply around. If
you need to leave the room to get something,

let them know so they know you are coming
back.

Your job isn't really to snap of them out of
this, because panic attacks simply need to
run their course.

Your job is to simply be there. Don't think
you are doing something wrong if you can't
"snap them out of it" because the person will
be thankful when you are simply there for
them.

Show them that you are present, that
nothing bad is in the room, and you are
getting on with your day as if there is no
danger.

Once they see there is no danger, they start to relax too, but they still need time to come out of the attack.

Final Thoughts - Anxiety & Panic

To conclude, you can tackle your anxiety through a few routes:

- Psychotherapy (counselling)
- EDMR Therapy (seen to be very effective)
- Medication
- Good Sleep
- No Alcohol
- No Drugs
- No Caffeine after midday (12pm) or at all.
- Gradual Exposure To Events That Cause Anxiety
- Social Interaction

- Frequent Exercise
- Tackling Thoughts That Lead To Anxiety

If you feel the symptom of anxiety, I want to tell you it's better to get help rather than try to deal with it all on your own.

Take action sooner rather than later, so you can be the person you want to be! This book can give you some good pointers, but it is important most of all to seek a professional therapist and medical help too if this is a real issue for you.

Take the step you know you need to take.
Life will reward you.

Regardless of how long you have been dealing with

anxiety, or when or where or who it came from, it can be changed. I will leave you with a quote.

“We have the power to change our belief systems at any point in our lives. We have the power to change our story.”

When it comes to anxiety, action is not always easy. You aren't always going to feel like it.

But if you can just commit to leaving feelings out of it, and go to the gym anyway, or go out anyway, then we have a chance at beating the condition that destroys our chances to experience positive emotions.

Let's just commit to go do the thing that we know will lead us towards our desired

outcome of being healthier, happier, more peaceful people.

This rule has been the single most helpful, life- changing rule for most of the clients who have been able to accept it and start changing behavior.

Especially if you have difficulty with the basics. If you have difficulty in social interactions, driving, shopping, and other essential activities of daily living, then mastering this rule may just change your life..

sometimes things feel worse before they get comfortable. Stay in this battle because it will pay off!

I hope this section helps you in your journey against anxiety. You have a greater potential to face this fear more than you know.

“Feel the fear and do it anyway.”

Processing Traumas

Sarah sits on a park bench every Sunday morning with her journal. She's been doing this for three months now. Her friends think she's "working on herself." Her therapist calls it "processing time."

She writes about the same betrayal every week. She cries. Then Monday comes, and by Wednesday, she's overthinking again.

She wonders: is this what healing looks like, or am I just making myself worse?

She wonders a lot of things:

- When she should complain, when she should move on.
- What kind of things to “let go” of in favor of positivity, and what kind of things she should journal to avoid bottling up.
- She wonders the right way to write about things in her journal to actually allow her to “let go” of such issues, so they don’t return to haunt her.

Many people like Sarah, need extra direction in processing their traumas.

Unprocessed traumas can link to a wide range of other issues such as anxiety and overthinking.. I am going to take you through some ways to process traumas in a healthy way.

A balance point is possible to find. One of the main things I see is people who are confused about what they should process and what they shouldn't.

They don't know if they should be the type of person who is "positive all the time?" and bottle everything up. Or the person who "lets everything out" at all times and risks building constant complaining and overthinking into their character?

The truth is you can find a healthy balance. It is important for your future. I have helped many people to find this balance.

You see, I find that some people want to be positive all the time, they are scared if they

focus too much on negativity or life issues
that they will become negative.

Especially in self help books like this, people
do get encouraged to think positively, but
when does it all become toxic?

When do we actually “let go” of our pains
and choose positive thinking, and when do
we actually process things?

Here is the basic rule.

If a thought that keeps surfacing is a genuine
trauma or a serious life event with real
weight — do not bury it. You cannot simply
"be positive" your way through something
that genuinely needs processing.

Set aside dedicated time, use **CBT techniques**, and work through this properly.
You need to process.

If it is a daily stress — an argument, a worry, something that will not matter in six months or a weeks time — the general rule is to let it go.

Use **mindfulness** to feel the thought, “let go” of the thought, remain living in the moment, and redirect yourself towards positivity.

Use CBT when:

- A thought feels **very real**
- You’re avoiding stuff because of it
- You’ve never really questioned it before

CBT helps you **break the illusion**.

Use mindfulness when:

- You're stuck in loops
- You've already analyzed it 100 times
- Your brain won't shut up

Mindfulness helps you **stop feeding the loop.**

Rehearse stress every night and you become a stressed person. Rehearse ease and you become easy-going.

Allowing negative thoughts that won't matter in a week to repeatedly anger you is a one-way ticket to becoming an angry personality with chronic complaining built into your character.

You are training yourself every single day. The question is: what are you training yourself to become?

There are two modes of mental work

1. Deep processing (CBT-style behavioral exposure or reflection)

- Sitting down, facing feelings/thoughts fully
- Working through blame, guilt, fear
- Reframing thoughts until they stop coming back
- This is powerful, but **time and energy intensive**

2. Mindfulness / gratitude / daily life focus

- Not analyzing or processing every thought
- Letting thoughts exist without spiraling

- Choosing where to place attention
- Filling your day with positivity and engagement
- This is lighter, sustainable, prevents overthinking
- Directing your thoughts to positive outcomes and choosing to let go

You can't live in a CBT mode all day every day without it becoming unhealthy. Even CBT acknowledges this — exposure and processing are **tools**, not life-long states.

How to know which mode to use

A simple way to think about it:

Signal	Use CBT-style deep processing	Use mindfulness / gratitude
Thought is stuck and unresolved over a long term period	✓	✗
Thought is looping and unhelpful	✗	✓
You feel stuck , unable to function	✓	✗
You feel drained by overthinking	✗	✓
There is a deadline , family , work	✗	✓

- CBT-style is for **rare, intense unresolved issues**
- Mindfulness / Gratitude = for **daily maintenance, preventing overthinkings that don't serve us**

Why both are necessary

- **Deep processing** helps you permanently resolve things that actually matter
- **Mindfulness / gratitude** prevents “mental clutter” from taking over your life

Too much of either can be harmful:

- Excessive processing → chronic rumination, anxiety

- Pure mindfulness / avoidance → unprocessed trauma or unresolved issues

Mindfulness is better for **day-to-day mental hygiene**. Deep reflection is for when the brain literally **cannot relax** until it processes something important.

Daily/ordinary negative thoughts

Examples:

- Someone annoyed you at work
- Minor arguments or misunderstandings
- Small regrets or mistakes
- “I’m frustrated with my partner/friend/family”
- Minor relationship issues

What to do:

- Practice **mindfulness**: notice the thought, don't argue with it
- Practice **gratitude**: shift attention to what went well, the thought will likely pass within the next day.
- Let it **pass naturally**

2. Rare, intense, unresolved thoughts

Examples:

- Death of a loved one
- Major trauma or accident
- Serious betrayal or relationship rupture
- Life-changing regret or failure that keeps replaying

What to do:

- Give yourself **intentional processing time** (set yourself a quiet place, 2 hours of your time on a Sunday and work through it)
- **Set a time limit** you think is reasonable (1–2 hours)
- Process: acknowledge, reflect, reframe, accept
- When time's up → **move on to normal life**

The Goal is to resolve the thought so it doesn't keep returning, processing it fully until your brain can let it go.

Finding The Balance

The question I get asked most in this area is:

"Do I just have to be positive all the time?"

No. Know when to process and when to let
go.

The trick is to know when to be easy going
and when you have an actual trauma or
deeper life event to work through. If the
latter is the case, that is when you block
aside a day, and dedicate it to the issue.

Even then, rest assured you wont be
“complaining” or overthinking the issue, but
actively trying to use CBT techniques on
yourself to find a solution as well as process
how you are going to cope with this issue.

CBT techniques to process an issue are as follows:

Step 1: Go To a Quiet Place Where You Can Concentrate

Work through your issue in a quiet place.

Step 2: Identify The Thought Clearly

Write it down in one sentence. Make it specific.

Example:

- “I feel guilty for yelling at my friend yesterday.”
- “I keep thinking I failed my project and I’m not good enough.”

Tip: The clearer the thought, the easier it is to process.

Step 3: Examine The Thought Like a Detective

Ask yourself **CBT-style questions**:

1. **Evidence for it:** What's the proof this is true?
2. **Evidence against it:** What's the proof it's not fully true?
3. **Am I thinking in extremes or all-or-nothing terms?**
4. **Am I blaming myself unfairly?**

Write your answers honestly — no sugarcoating.

Step 4: Explore The Feelings

- Identify the emotions attached (anger, sadness, guilt, fear).
- Rate intensity 1–10.
- Ask yourself: **“What is this emotion trying to tell me?”**

Example: guilt → “I care about my friend and I want to repair the relationship.”

Step 5: Reframe Or Challenge The Thought

After examining the evidence and feelings, write a **balanced, realistic version** of the thought.

Example:

- Original: “I’m a terrible friend for yelling.”

- Reframe: “I lost my temper, but I usually treat my friends well. I can apologize and repair this.”

Step 6: Acceptance And Closure

Ask yourself journal prompts like:

- “Have I seen all sides of this situation?”
- “Can I accept that I did my best given the circumstances?”
- “Is there anything else I need to do to make this right?”
- Is there a way I can move forwards from this without feeling negative? What way is that?
- “Can I let this go now and move on?”

Step 7: Optional Next Steps (If Needed)

If an action is needed (apology, task, learning lesson) → plan **it exactly**.

If nothing is actionable → practice **letting go**.

After closing the journal → switch attention to something **neutral or positive** (walk, tea, music, gratitude list).

Seek Self Forgiveness and Positive Solutions

Always think of ways to forgive yourself and ways you can move on from a trauma.

If you didn't do your best in one situation, ask yourself: does that mean you're not still a top achiever overall? You're still on the road to greatness.

Maybe the situation wasn't important to you, or maybe you got distracted by something you shouldn't have.

Everyone gets distracted from time to time—but does that really mean you're an unfocused person, when 9 times out of 10 you're on the ball?

Simply aim to do better next time.

Worksheets that aid this process are often called ABC worksheets or challenging thoughts worksheets. They look like this:

ABC Worksheet

A: Activating Event	B: Beliefs/Thoughts	C: Consequences
What situation happened that triggered thoughts and feelings that made me unhappy or led me to behave in a certain way?	What are my beliefs about the situation? What are the thoughts in my head?	How do I feel right now? How do I want to act or behave?

1. Are my thoughts in column B realistic or helpful?

2. What is the healthier thought I can tell myself on such occasions in the future?

First We Ask:

What situation happened that triggered thoughts and feelings that made me unhappy or led me to behave in a certain way?

What are my beliefs about the situation?
What are my *automatic* or *habitual* thoughts that keeping going through my head?

What do I tend to think in situations like this? How do I feel right now? (Recall the primary *biologically-driven* emotions of happiness, sadness, anger, anxiety or fear, and disgust, as well as more *socially-driven* emotions like shame and guilt).

How did I (or do I want to) act or behave?

Then We Ask:

Are my thoughts in column B realistic or helpful?

Would they hold up in a court of law? If my best friend made this comment, would I agree?

And Finally:

What would be a healthier, more logical/rational, or more helpful thought or belief I tell myself in situations like this in the future?

If you have unresolved traumas, working through them like this with a therapist and in your own time can really help you.

Finally, to resolve traumas you can explore EDMR therapy. It is a newer form of therapy. It is intense, but it is proven to be very effective for working through traumas.

I have received very good reviews on it from some of the people I have worked with who have been through this therapy. If it is available in your country, I suggest you check it out.

Grief And Loss

No matter how strong you are, no matter how disciplined, no matter how much you have built — loss finds you. It finds everyone at least once in their life.

But there is a way to carry grief that does not break you.

I have extensive experience with this and I want to help you explore the possibility that you are going to come out of grief, grow as a person, and live a very positive life.

This really matters, losing someone can really make or break who you become as a person, we want our lives to take a positive direction over a negative direction in all circumstances. I am going to get into 5 tips to manage grief to help you.

Tip 1: Be Compassionate With Yourself And Others.

Try not to place a timeline or a set of expectations on yourself or others. Grief

takes time and everyone grieves differently.
Be patient and kind. Remember your
“compassion statement.”

*I am having a hard moment... hard moments
are a part of life. May I be kind to myself.*

Tip 2: Ride The Initial Few Months Without Doing Anything Stupid

Try not to make irreversible, impulsive, life-
altering decisions when you are in crisis.

Wait until things calm down before you
decide to quit your job,
get married, get divorced, drink heavily,
shave off your hair, move out of the
country, or anything crazy.

Just wait.

Now — in the early days, the only objective is to get through the initial shock. The first weeks are raw.

Everyone reacts differently. Some people drive around at night recklessly feeling like the wheels might as well leave the road. Others go quiet and stay inside.

Whatever your version looks like, know that it is normal. The best thing you can do in that immediate period is avoid alcohol, keep up with your friends, and keep moving. Make the healthy choices.

Tip 3: Honor The Person

“You are suffering a loss; if you have lost a loved one, then know that you do not honor them by also forfeiting your life (physically or mentally). You honor them by living, by thriving, and you know in your heart that is exactly what they would want for you.”

Tip 4: Don't Try To Do It Alone

We do not succeed alone. We need people, and we heal and process best in the context of our close relationships with other people.

Social support is the key to healing

and recovery, so if you have limited social support, then find a group, or seek professional help.

When our minds are closed, we see no help available even though it may be right in front of us. But, when our minds are open, there are infinite possibilities and plenty of support.

Tip 5: Don't Feel Guilty About Recovering Fast

The first thing I want to say is this: never feel guilty about recovering. That guilt — the feeling that laughing again means you have forgotten, that building something good somehow dishonours the person you lost — is one of the heaviest things a person can carry.

And when you examine it honestly, it is the opposite of what they would want for you.

Tip 6: Make A Promise

The most powerful thing I have ever suggested to someone carrying grief is to make a promise. Not a vague intention. A real, spoken, committed promise — to the person you lost — that you are going to live the best possible life in their name.

That you are going to take the love you have for them and pour it into everything you build.

The reason this works is simple. Once that promise is out there, you cannot take it back.

The loss does not disappear — but it

transforms. It stops being only a weight and starts becoming a fuel.

Every time you want to quit, every time you feel like giving up on yourself, you remember the promise. You come back to it. And you keep going.

There is no rush, but there will come a day — you will know roughly when — where you feel ready to make that promise.

**Tip 7: Understand This Makes You Stronger,
Not Weaker**

People who have loved and lost deeply often become the most purposeful people in a room. They understand, in a way others do not yet, how finite all of this is. How much every single day counts. That understanding

is painful to earn. But it is one of the most powerful forces a person can possess.

You are only weaker, or broken, or mentally shaken, if you allow the situation to make you feel that way.

Imagine waking up one day — not so far from now — and the image of the person you lost is still there, but the grief no longer runs you. You think of them and smile before you cry. The life you are building has become, in itself, a monument to who they were. And when someone asks what drives you, their name is part of the answer.

That is not a fantasy. That is achievable. One day you will sit there, able to celebrate their life, and feel — for the first time in a long

time — genuinely proud of the person you
are becoming.

Make sure to make them proud.

I remember my own story, my mother
passed away in the hospital in my early
twenties. I made a last promise to her that I
would start my charity to help people, that I
would be the best man I could be and that I
would look after my family for her.

Maybe I had a lot to be guilty about. I was
rarely around in her last months. I was off
studying caring more about business.

I was a troublesome teenager who gave her
too much trouble. My family had to move
house because I got into so much trouble in
my old area!

It's a deep thing to admit, but I missed the final moments of my mother's life, due to caring for another family member that was overdosing.

In someone else's mind, that might be a lot of reasons to feel guilty.

Nowadays I can go to the church and light a candle for my mother, feeling mentally healthy about it. In fact I am usually in quite a good mood actually.

I used to avoid thinking about the anniversary of her passing, and I would avoid looking at pictures. But joy is now restored to my life.

All that stuff is normal to me and there are no issues. Time really fixes everything, and

you will be able to live a normal and happy life again too. Follow the principles above and keep your head up!

Heartbreak

Heartbreak, surprisingly, can be very similar to grief and loss in terms of the advice I give to my clients. You are losing someone close to you. A lot of the same advice applies. Here are 7 tips to help you conquer this life situation and what to do to come out on the other side smiling.

Tip 1: Get Through The Initial Crisis Safely

Firstly, the first week or month is going to be hard. It can be tempting to go out drinking, to speed your car around angrily at night

with the intention to hit something or run yourself off the road.

It is a temporary feeling, don't make any mistakes in this first week or two. Spend time with good friends, have a talk, focus on work, remain peaceful with your lifestyle and spend some time reflecting.

Tip 2: There Is Always Something Better Coming

You know the phrase, there is always something better coming? That if you loose somebody, life is preparing you for someone better? 9 times out of 10, that is true.

Because nearly 95% of the time, if your connection with the partner you just split up with was truly meant to be, it would have

worked and you wouldn't have broken up.
Think about your past.

Anytime I have ever broken up with someone, the next relationship was always better without fail. You know more about what you are looking for, and tend to attract it, spending less time messing around.

You also take the mistakes and all that you learned in your previous relationship and use it as a learning experience to make the next one better.

We become more experienced as we go through life and are able to have better relationships if we have a good mindset towards learning and growing.

Tip 3: Accept That Non Compatibility Isn't Failure

This is only a big deal because we make it. But really it's a natural part of life. There are many good people out there.

Some people move far away from each other. Some people have a great relationship and get on great with each other but it isn't the right time.

Sometimes one person wants kids and another doesn't and that's a dealbreaker.

There are so many little personality differences that are unworkable between two otherwise greatly respectful people.

Sometimes you just intuitively know that you had the a great time and a lot of love with someone, and there's nothing

particularly wrong with them, but they aren't
the "one" for you.

Maybe it's just something about their
personality that you know will never change
and they aren't a bad person for it but you
know it won't work for you!

Humans are very preoccupied with finding
"the one." More so than you would think.

I have seen pretty handsome and rich clients
that get broken up with and left for people
who are not doing so well and not as
conventionally attractive. Even people with
great personalities and nothing really wrong
with them.

Even great relationships with barely any issues can sometimes break up. There is no rhyme or reason behind it.

Sometimes people just see a person that blows them away and find their “one” and it doesn’t really mean that you are incapable or that you aren’t a high quality person.

Especially when you are the one that has been broken up with, you start to feel as though it was you, you start to feel like you lack something.

That maybe the person your partner chooses to move on with is “better” than you.

But don’t hold yourself back and think like that. The same will happen to you one day, you will just “hit” for someone and they will see you as their “one.”

When you are single again, see it as an opportunity of abundance, to search for and discover that personality type that you really want.

You have probably neglected your friends, and haven't dated certain types of people or from certain cultures before, so use it as an opportunity to explore and find yourself.

Tip 4: Be The Type Of Person That Moves On

I commonly see two types of people when it comes to heartbreaks. The “move - on” ers and the ones that stay stuck in limbo for years and years of their life.

It is one of the hardest things you have to do when you decide someone is not a match for you, or if they decide it. The more you go

through this and make the right choices for
yourself the easier it gets.

I looked at the difference between the people
who get stuck in limbo, and the people who
move on.

One difference I find in the people who move
on is that they have more life experience
when it comes to heartbreak.

They have been through it a few times, to the
point where they are able to see it in an adult
way—as part of life, not something
devastating or personal.

They've usually had a couple of breakups,
maybe even positive relationships that
ended on good terms due to minor
incompatibilities. Because of this, they see
the world in abundance.

There are plenty of great people out there,
and every relationship becomes an
opportunity to find a better fit, to learn what
they actually want, and to understand
different personality types.

They get back out there fairly quickly, and
over time they get positive reinforcement
from real experiences—realising that
connection is always possible again when
they meet someone new.

After two or three cycles of this, they start to
fully internalise that this is just a normal
part of life.

We go through life, we give our best to
people, and sometimes for whatever reason,
it just isn't a fit—and the right thing to do is
let it go.

It's okay. Life works this way. We travel through life trying to find our match, sharing love and experiences with different people along the way.

It doesn't take away from what you had. You can still look back and appreciate it for what it was—a real connection, a real experience, a real chapter of your life.

But not everyone is meant to be permanent in your life, and that's okay. You can love someone, appreciate them, and be grateful for what you shared, while also recognizing that your path is meant to continue elsewhere.

Keep on continuing to work on your greatest gifts, and your path will lead to greater things.

Tip 5 - Don't Be The Type Of Person Who Doesn't Move On

So what about the people who don't move on?

These type of people usually have a “the one that got away attitude.” A “what if” attitude. You don't want to be the “one that got away” type person.

These people don't pull there boots up by the breaches, and adopt a mature stance.

Usually it's their first love. They don't move on for years so they don't have that positive feedback loop of successfully getting into new relationships and seeing that it's ok. Once you actually do it and see it's ok, the whole process becomes easier.

I always hear the same things with these people. “I’m just not ready yet.” “I don’t want to use these dating apps.”

If you are in this situation. You have to take charge of your own destiny. You have to take action and get that first win of moving on. Because after that it becomes a lot easier.

If you don’t push yourself to get that win soon, you can really stay in this hole for a long time. I’ve seen it happen to people for years, and the longer it goes on, the more stuck in their ways they seem to get.

I appreciate your point of view if you are one of these people, because I know it is hard to move on, and I have been there too. But even if you don’t want to, you have to take that step.

Give someone else a chance, even if you have to give yourself a little push at first, even if you are feeling resistance from your mind, you need to give yourself that “push” to move on. That push is going to get you back to where you need to be.

Tip 6: Be Honest About “Staying in Touch”

I think the hardest part for people to accept is this. We always break up with people and say: “oh we will stay in touch.” “We will always care”

People don’t want to loose the connection sometimes if the relationship was good.

But usually, realistically, you end up barely speaking to that person again. The reason being is when you move on and when they

move on, it rarely becomes appropriate to do
so.

Even if you care. Even if you have no issue
with them whatsoever. Your new partner
likely wants your undivided attention and it
can cause problems if you are constantly
talking with the old. Adults understand this.

It's for this reason that you have to be real
with yourself, you share these amazing and
great moments with someone, and that will
always be there.

That person will always be there with you
and the lessons you learned should make
you smile. It's not that you're "letting go" of
them as the memories remain, the respect
remains, but it is appropriate to let go of the
same contact you had with them once you
move on.

And I think this is ok once you do it a few times. You don't hate the person, you actually think highly of them. You aren't ignoring them, or being horrible, it's just the way of this life. And adults understand.

Tip 7: Take Action and Move Forward

At the end of the day, this is the world we live in in 2026. We live in a world where you can access a large collection of single women or men by downloading an app.

The people that do well simply download as many apps as they can, make the effort, message and talk to as many people in life as they can, and they move on.

Sometimes you don't want to in the moment, but it's the right thing for you. You don't have to be the most social person in the pub

anymore, constantly going out drinking to
meet someone.

There are routes for everyone now to get out
there and date and socialise in many
different avenues, online and offline.

Throughout this book we always prioritise
taking action, and in break ups you have to
as well. This is a part of life, and it is ok.

You may not see it now, but this is just
another sign from the universe that your
great and loving connection with this person
is now complete, and it's time for life to
teach you something more about love with
someone else.

You are going to be ok, life is showing you
that your path is with someone else,
depending on how you view it, it's not a

negative, it is simply life showing you the way.

Final Thoughts On Heartbreak

This is such a common issue but it hurts a lot and happens to the best of us. Remember 3 things:

- 1.You have to let someone go to invite better into your life.
- 2.There will always be one better.
- 3.Life will still be great and improve with time.

Disadvantaged Youths With Life Issues

I remember sitting there trying to coach a youth who was shouting that no one understood him.

He felt as though his entire situation was unique and he was so angry at his position in life. He said: *"No one knows how it feels — if you grew up in the same environment as me, you would be just like me."*

He didn't think anyone had been through what he had been through. It wasn't until a colleague of mine challenged him and said:

"Listen, you're not the only one who's been through that. Me and my mates went

*through the exact same thing, and we aren't
here making excuses. We still made
something of ourselves — look, here's the
proof."*

The youth questioned it at first. But once he genuinely saw direct examples of people who had been through similar — or even worse — circumstances, and had responded with a positive attitude, something shifted. He became inspired and took the step to make a change.

There are limits to what someone can do who has no connection to that world. A rich banker from a wealthy area would struggle to reach a group of kids being thrown out of school with very little going for them.

But if that same banker had come from a similar background to the kids, demonstrated how they went through comparable circumstances and came out the other side — those young people would have a far greater chance of actually listening.

Youths from this background are essentially asking themselves four things:

1. Who is this person?
2. Can I truly relate their circumstances to mine?
3. What are they like as a result — could I be like that?
4. What's in it for me if I do change?

This is why **vulnerability** can really help you. To reach these young people, you have to tell them about a time you were in their position.

What you tried to do to fix it, how you felt emotionally.

Paint the story of you trying and failing, what worked and what didn't, until you finally came out on top.

If you can show them that you have been in a truly **similar** position — and they **believe** you — and then show them that you became a positive person and didn't let anything hold you back, it gives them permission to do the same.

If they have been through something you haven't personally experienced, it is not a lost cause. Find them a clear example of someone who was in a similar position.

Ideally someone whose circumstances are close to theirs — the closer the match, the

more it will land. Show them that example, and show them what that person became.

You can show them **examples** of someone who had it slightly worse than them, but I have found sometimes it's best to find a close match to their current situation so they relate more.

These youths are sometimes looking for an easy way out. Maybe their parents stopped caring.

They are looking to say "*I am this way because of my circumstances*" — and they aren't expecting anyone to challenge them on it.

They may have genuinely never realised there are those who have achieved greatness

under the exact same circumstances. Getting them to realise this can instantly **shift** their attitude.

The case studies you present to disadvantaged youths may look slightly different to those you'd use with young people from more affluent areas — but the principle remains the same.

Show them they are not alone in what they are going through, show them examples of others have conquered their situation, and hold them accountable to doing better.

I coached a lot of young people from South London who would say things like "*What would you know about it?*"

They were convinced their area was different and worse — even when I told them I had grown up in South London myself.

They would say "*the crime is different now, it's not the same*" — even though the city was statistically far safer than when I was growing up.

It was as if they needed their situation to be the worst possible version of reality.

The truth is they weren't the **only** kids growing up rough, there were thousands of areas just like South London.

There are lots of youths who grow up around violence or drugs within their family.

The way you address this is important. They are under the impression that their situation isn't normal. They compare themselves to friends from more comfortable backgrounds and feel like they've been dealt a completely different hand. They don't feel "normal."

But once you help them understand that you have helped many people just like them — that this is actually a **common** challenge you have seen again and again — and that nine out of ten people who face it and don't use it as an excuse end up bettering themselves, they start to feel less abnormal.

They start to question themselves.

Could it be that their issue is in fact commonly worked through in a positive manner? Tell them this, tell them the issue is

common all across the world. Tell them that 9 out of 10 people who go through this issue end up bettering themselves if they are not using it as an excuse, and the 1 out of 10 who continue to have a victim mindset don't make it.

Ask them which one do they want to be?

Their situation may not feel normal within the bubble of their school or their street.
They may feel completely alone in it.

But in the grand scheme of the world, what they are going through is happening **every single day** — and positive futures are being built from those exact same starting points, every single day.

Make that known. And guide them, step by step, toward the most confident version of themselves.

One last thing to note when it comes to a youth with a difficult background. You may be the first person in their life who has genuinely **believed** in them. Don't underestimate what that means.

Sometimes that one person is all it takes. Sometimes it is that one kind thing you say that can change the trajectory of someone's entire future.

With a disadvantaged youth, show them it is **possible** to change and that you expect it from them. Despite their circumstances, make them understand you have commonly seen those with their exact circumstances

hold their heads up high and succeed. And
you believe they can do it too.

Don't be soft on them, don't treat them as
special, and don't treat them as different,
just let them know it's possible for them to
succeed and it's in their best interest to do so.

After that, all that's left to do is show up for
them **consistently** and apply the same
principles of good coaching that you would
with any other group as mentioned in this
book.

As a final note — one that I find genuinely
exciting — those who have been through real
life issues often make incredible athletes
when they apply themselves.

They often go on to be driven in the world of sports or become very charismatic and inspirational figures if they apply themselves correctly.

People from difficult experiences are able to use the pain they went through as fuel, a kind of drive that is rarely seen.

They can withstand discomfort, take defeats on the chin, and they have no illusions about life being perfect or easy.

That resilience, channeled in the right direction, is one of the most **powerful** things you will ever witness as a coach.

Get them to unlock it.

Drugs / Alcohol

"Your life does not get better by chance; it gets better by change." – Jim Rohn

In this section, we'll dive deeper into one of the most important aspects of improving your mindset and mental health: eliminating drug use.

While we've already touched on the impact of what we consume on our well-being, it's crucial to understand how drugs—no matter how casual or recreational—can hold you back from becoming the person you truly want to be.

The Right Time to Celebrate— Responsibly

"Success is to wake up each morning and consciously decide that today will be the best day of your life." – Ken Poirot

Once you've reached a point where your life is stable, where you're happy, healthy, and thriving, you may wonder if it's okay to celebrate with a drink or a rare party.

The truth is, once you've mastered your life—once you've built a solid foundation of happiness and success—you can make that decision for yourself.

But even then, it's crucial to be aware of the dangers and the slippery slope that substances can lead to.

Tackle Drugs Sooner Rather Than Later!

Drugs are one of the first things I try and tackle when it comes to a person's self improvement journey.

The reason being is because drugs dim the mind to the point where a person will struggle to get anywhere without first quitting the drugs. You need the clarity that quitting drugs and alcohol brings.

People on drugs simply don't remember the lessons learned, they don't have the concentration level, and they don't have the drive or motivation to really tackle the deeper levels of my systems.

Our brains ability to concentrate is so deeply affected by drugs, to the point where I have rarely seen a person on drugs be able to concentrate enough to fix any of the other issues on our list with any kind of lasting effort.

Drugs and alcohol steal your motivation, and they steal your dreams.

Once drugs are cleared from the system, it is like a whole new world opens up where people are able to soak in lessons and make progress. Before that, it is like a barrier is in

place in those life that will never be lifted until they quit.

There is one certain fact I have seen time and time again, until you quit drug and heavy alcohol use, you will always hit a brick wall when it comes to your fitness, mental health, and self improvement. Your brain will simply be too depressed to grasp the concepts of self improvement.

Some people will argue and say you can still make progress whilst on drugs and alcohol, and I'm not saying you can't make slight progress in your life, but it will be next to no progress and there will be a barrier that stops you from progressing.

That barrier will prevent you from elevating past a certain point, and that point is very

low in terms of the overall progress you can make. You will be stuck on a very low vibrational energy, and you will be limited to a low level of living.

I am going to give you 6 tips for quitting drugs.

Tip 1 - Get Rid Of The Idea That You Have Caused Irreversible Damage

I had a client called Jason who had done drugs for many many years. He had done drugs to the point where, he had sometimes done 10 times the recommended recreational dose of multiple hard drugs, it was actually a miracle he was still alive in his own words.

Jason told me he was scared when he went to the doctor, and said: “Doc, i think I have messed myself up for life.”

What the doctor said to him brought him to tears. He felt instant peace and release. The doctor told him kindly not to give up.

“As humans, we do not give ourselves enough credit for how good we are at repairing and healing the damage done to ourselves. We are one of the most amazing species in the world for repairing damage.

“Our bodies are amazing, when we get a cut, we bleed but then our skin scabs over and heals. However, your brain is the most exceptional muscle in the human body at healing itself.”

How is the brain designed? Well I will tell you, it is designed to repair itself and reach a balanced and natural state, just like our bodies. Our bodies are expertly designed to repair.

There is little damage you can do to a human brain that in most situations cannot be reversed over time, with correct self care.

Jason was still nervous... “What if I have fried all the cells in my brain?” “What if this is irreversible?” Jason had taken 12 ecstasy pills at a party 5 months ago. The recommended dose is 1 pill.

Ecstasy can cause our brain to release all of its happy chemical, and can be toxic in large amounts such as the amount Jason took. After releasing all of our happy chemical, we

can get depressed as it takes a while to produce it back.

Jason had taken a HUGE amount. For months Jason was unable to feel happy. He was very depressed and scared. “Doctor are you sure I haven’t messed myself up for good?”

“Look, actually, the brain simply doesn’t work that way. It’s impossible to mess yourself up for good.”

He then told Jason this:

“When you look at a smoker's lungs, it is very hard for them to get their original lungs back.”

“If a smoker smokes for a few years, when we look at their lungs, they may have already lost around 70% of their lung capacity.

When a smoker quits, they can work back to get to around 50% of their lung capacity. However, they will never reach the full 100% that they had EVER again.”

“However...” he told me. “The brain on the other hand... is very good at balancing things out for itself.

Whatever drug you take, whatever abuse you faced, we can give the brain a scan now, it may show some signs of trouble.

But in 2 years of good healthy living, the brain will readjust to its natural state, we will scan it and it will be all clear. The brain

is a supercomputer and remarkable at what it does.”

This gave Jason a lot of confidence. No matter what drug he had taken, or what event had happened in his life, he realised time is the best healer. After this moment as a young man Jason realised all hope was not lost, and he started on his self improvement journey to improve his life.

Tip 2: Cut Down Slowly If Cold Turkey Doesn't Work

When coaching people I have always found value in cutting them off slowly.

Cold turkey can work for some people, and do it if you think you can handle it, but if the cold turkey isn't working, work to reduce the

frequency and amount per day. And even the dosage size.

Try and reduce those numbers until it barely makes a difference if you do the drug or drink the alcohol or not, because you are barely having any.

Challenge: Use a little less drink or drugs, every day. Even if it is just reducing your intake by 0.1%, going from 2 joints to 1 and a half.

Going from 3 large rollup cigarettes to 2 big ones and 1 small one. Progressively reduce your intake and see the positivity come out in your life.

If you drink daily, select 3 nights to have your glass of wine. Slowly reduce the

amount of nights every month. Then reduce the size of the glasses.

Tip 3: Relapsing: A Winning Mindset

One mindset tip I can give to you is in terms of relapsing. This is useful if you yourself have relapsed, or useful to tell someone who has relapsed.

Don't worry. Relapse is a normal part of the process of making a good change. A relapse is really just an opportunity to learn from your mistake.

It is better to relapse one or two times, than to still be taking drugs. You are still making more progress through relapsing than if you didn't try.

It's better to be in the arena fighting than in the crowd watching. One path pushes you toward your best self, the other keeps you on the sidelines as your life stays unchanged.

The mindset to have is: just because you went back to drugs one time and had a moment of weakness, doesn't mean it's the end of the world and you have to take more!

It may hurt slightly, but its time to get back on track. A self victimizing and feeling sorry for yourself mindset is the worst mindset to have in this situation.

As long as you're progressively using less this week than you were the week before and you stick to reducing dosage and frequency, you'll eventually be OK.

Try to adopt a never miss twice mentality. You missed once, but today it is another chance to do our best. Remember you are a champion for trying, let's get back on track.

Tip 4: Read These 2 Books

The Easy Way To Stop Alcohol & The Easy Way To Quit Smoking by Alan Carr are excellent books. Alcohol will steal your motivation. Steal your dreams. Steal your physique.

The danger of smoking is that it is super counterproductive to your fitness, and can cause poor self esteem, you are not respecting what you put into your body, and as long as you continue to destroy your body,

you will find it hard to reach the top levels of a positive mindset. Read these great books for tips on how to navigate the process of quitting these vices.

Tip 5: Journalling Exercise

First write down your vices. (Your addictions)

Write down what this vice gives you. (Such as: Cures boredom. Social Confidence. Pleasure. Note that you are usually using a vice to medicate and run from an issue that you should be solving, try to identify these in this section)

Write down everything this vice is stealing from you. (Every way it is negatively impacting your life.)

Write down in detail what your life will be like in 10 years time if you continue this vice.

Write down where you could be in 10 years if you quit, stayed disciplined, and worked on other more productive areas.

This exercise is going to help you to see the advantages of changing versus the disadvantages of staying the same.

Tip 6: You Are Capable of Greatness

*"Strength does not come from physical capacity. It comes from an indomitable will."
– Mahatma Gandhi*

Remember, you're on a journey to become the best version of yourself, and part of that

journey is cutting out the things that no longer serve you.

Drugs might have been a crutch in the past, but you don't need them anymore.

You're stronger than you know, and with each day that you stay committed to your goals and your growth, you're proving to yourself just how capable you are.

By eliminating drugs from your life, you're clearing the path to achieving your dreams.

You're giving yourself the mental clarity, emotional stability, and physical energy needed to reach new heights.

You are capable of greatness, and every step you take toward a healthier, drug-free life

brings you closer to the person you were always meant to be.

ADHD / Focus

I was diagnosed with ADHD in school.

Teachers always noticed I couldn't sit still.

I used it as an **excuse** and a disability for most of my life.

Until I entered the real world, where I realized I wanted to be successful.

I realised that in most high paying jobs, concentration simply had to be maintained. I

would need to learn how to focus in order to be successful. But it was hard.

I didn't know where to begin.

- I knew I wouldn't get promotions in my current state.
- I knew I wasn't finishing everything I started.
- Things seemed to take so long to build, due to distractions.
- My confidence in being a high achiever felt limited, I felt forgetful, and unfocused, not like the switched-on, organized businessman I felt I needed to be to build my Achieve Greatness business idea.

I tried things like coffee for my concentration, which didn't really work.

Supplements were a little bit better, not the ones that are marketed to make money and designed specifically for ADHD, but taking creatine, cod liver oil, vitamin d3 and some magnesium made me feel more focused.

Combining this with a solid **fitness programme** and a healthy diet made me feel even sharper.

But, things still were not perfect, as these were only small changes. Fortunately, I discovered what worked.

One thing I have always felt about ADHD, is that it can worsen or improve based on how you **exercise** your brain.

I wasn't exercising my brain like I was my muscles. Since helping myself and other

people through ADHD, I have never seen ADHD as something someone is just “born with” that cannot be fixed.

Our brains and attention span is like our muscles, if we use it, it gets stronger.

We live in a world where we scroll on social media, play a bunch of flashing video games and watch TV shows designed to catch our attention.

We don’t really comprehend it but we don’t use our attention spans much anymore.

Everything in this world is designed to grab our **attention**. Movies cut scenes every 5 seconds with a new explosion.

Social media videos have developed a preference for quick in your face visuals that change all the time.

This isn't in our heads, the average human could concentrate on a basic task for 150 seconds back in 2003. Now that number is 43 seconds. Our lifestyles are full of completing tasks that don't help our focus at all.

If you took one child who read a lot of books, and compared his attention span to a child that played video games, you would see two distinct strengths and weaknesses.

The child that played video games, wouldn't be likely to have a good concentration span, but would have a good reaction time. This is

due to them reacting quickly to the images they see on the screen.

The child that reads would actually have a **better** attention span.

Reading books strengthens sustained, focused attention. Video games simply improve rapid short term attention to immediate surroundings, but again, it is the focused **long term** attention we need to actually concentrate in everyday life.

This is why I believe ADHD can be completely cured or at the very least minimized and directed towards productive things with the right lifestyle.

I don't see it as a disability, and it can even be a superpower if used in the right way...

If you point me to a person who played video games their whole life, smokes weed, uses their phone a lot, doesn't **read** or **meditate**, and told me they had been diagnosed with ADHD, I would not be surprised in the slightest.

ADHD is a spectrum, and they have likely placed themselves on a higher end of it by their lifestyle.

But no matter where someone lands on this spectrum, there are always improvements we can make to improve their quality of life and focus.

Here are 5 tips to work towards self improvement in the area of ADHD:

5 Tips To Improve ADHD

Tip 1: Avoid Drugs

Firstly avoid weed and alcohol, this completely destroys what little attention span we have.

Tip 2: Follow Your Purpose.

Those with ADHD are actually able to hyperfocus and concentrate MORE, as long as they truly enjoy the task they are doing.

This means a person with ADHD will sit there shaking there leg, waiting to escape from a conversation they don't find interesting, but when they find it interesting or think it can benefit them in some way, they can remain focused for hours.

It's why you could take a child with ADHD, who cannot sit and listen to their geography lesson in school, but can sit and play the piano for 8 hours.

They can become really great at piano, but due to the ADHD would still have issues because, they would likely play their favorite songs for hours and not focus on the songs they didn't like.

What I am saying is the ability to **hyperfocus** is a blessing, but we have to find the tasks that unlock it. Those tasks are usually our deeper life purpose.

Then we have to work on staying focused for tasks we don't really like as much to balance things out. I will explain more how to do that in the next tip.

The two examples I have given you so far will help you, but they aren't fixes.

What actually fixed it for me this...

Tip 3: Meditation

This single handedly, helped me the most with ADHD. It improves my concentration and control of my thoughts by actually training my brain to focus.

We cannot improve from ADHD medicines alone, but by actually training the brain and putting in the repetitions to make our focus better.

Meditation allows us to work our attention span like a muscle. To put it simply, a simple

meditation flow is this: you breathe in for 7 seconds and you breathe out for 4 seconds. Picture only your breath, you are breathing in positivity and breathing out negativity.

Whenever you get distracted (which you will) and you realise you lost focus, don't feel bad, simply identify that you got distracted and bring your attention back to your breath.

The act of getting distracted, **realizing** you got distracted, and then bringing yourself back into focus again is like 1 repetition of a weight in the gym.

The more **repetitions** you do of meditation, the stronger your focus and attention span will get. Apply it to your everyday life.

I know some of you may doubt this, but I can assure you, you reach a level of attention span that improves your life in every way.

I ended up being able to **identify** when I was getting distracted in classes, or when I was **sinking** into negative thought processes or getting angry, and I was able to bring myself straight back into positive alignment.

Don't doubt the power of this skill!

Tip 4: Reading

Reading improves deep concentration. The exact type of concentration you need to beat ADHD.

Tip 5: Reduce Screen Time

If we just sit and binge watch TV, things will never change.

Those with ADHD need peaceful environments. Go to the library to get work done, turn off your phone notifications.

On your phone, when you want to get work done, keep it in the bag. There is a setting on your phone that will show you how much **screen time** you use per day.

On iPhones it literally displays it on your front screen so you always see it once you turn the setting on. Turn this setting on.

When I first used it, I was thinking it would say 30 minutes for my own screen time.

The result shocked me... There were some days it said 5 hours.

This is a really big addiction for many people.

To level up your concentration, actually do periods of deep work, in quiet places and leave your phone out of it. Get that screen time down.

A study took two groups of people, both groups were placed in a room and told to complete some work for an hour.

One group of people had access to their mobile phones, and were able to read messages from friends.

The others smoked weed but were not allowed their phones.

The group that smoked weed literally performed significantly better and got more work done than those that were allowed the phones.

Practice periods of undisturbed work.

Final Thoughts On ADHD

Even if you have been told your whole life you have some kind of “disability,” you should know that you have **unlimited** positive potential.

Many of the most **successful** people carry traits of ADHD and it is not any kind of

death sentence on your ability to concentrate for the rest of your life.

Through applying different techniques and committing to the lifestyle changes discussed in this chapter, you may in some cases be able to focus **more** than others.

Especially when it comes to things you really care about and following your dreams. And through training your brain through meditation and removing distractions, you can learn how to stay present during tasks you don't enjoy as much too.

There is great value in following the above steps. You can access more creative power, becoming a person with the ability to finish things, as well as the person who has the ability to focus on demand.

That ability is reachable through practice
and commitment.

Imagine who you could **become** if you
trained your focus every single **day** for the
next year.

Every time you choose to sit down and
concentrate, you're getting stronger.

I wouldn't let a diagnosis hold you back...

ADHD becomes a superpower when that
person finds their purpose and combines it
with trained attention.

You already likely have the rare ability to
hyperfocus to some degree when you really
enjoy something. In some cases for up to 8
hours or more.

An ADHD person who consistently practises meditation and deep work over time develops an attention span that surpasses the average person on tasks they don't enjoy. Not just catches up. Surpasses. Because they have been forced to train that muscle harder than most people ever bother to.

And they still have the hyperfocus ability sitting there for when it matters most.

So what you are actually working with is this. A brain that with the right training can outlast the average person on the boring stuff, and then absolutely demolish them on the things it loves.

That is not a bad hand to be dealt. That is actually an incredible one once you understand how to play it.

The goal is not to suffer through a life you hate. The goal is to train the mind, find your purpose, and stack both advantages at once.

When you do that, very few people can compete with you.

Life is about playing to your strengths.

In this distracted world, those who are willing to make the minor improvements that others won't, are the ones that end up the most productive.

Use these techniques to separate yourself from the distracted majority, and build your focus.

There's something really powerful about taking something a person has been told is a weakness their whole life — been pulled out of class for, been made to feel broken over, maybe even been medicated for — and showing them that with the right approach it was actually an advantage the whole time.

That reframe is genuinely life changing for the right person reading it. Your brain is a weapon, not a problem.

How to Find The Balance When Helping People

This section is for those who feel they have been burned before by giving too much of themselves and want to learn how to help sustainably.

One thing I wanted to go over is how to help you find that balance between helping someone and knowing when to stop and live your own life too.

Finding this balance is important: you don't want to set yourself on fire to keep others warm. How do I approach this?

Firstly, you need to know as a coach that you
can't help everyone.

Even if you are the best coach in the world,
there are some people in life who are just too
stubborn to change, even the best coaches
come across this.

There is no “perfect thing” to say to this type
of person, because they are too stubborn and
haven't made the choice themselves to
change.

If you hear no “change talk” whatsoever, and
that person simply doesn't care to be helped
or coached, it's sometimes best to detach
from them.

If they question why their life is not
improving, you just tell them “well its

because you didn't take this step that is necessary" and keep contact to a minimum until you hear the actual change talk coming.

Other times you may be helping people with really hard lives. OR really negative people going through serious bouts of depression.

Perhaps a family member is going through a trauma or drug or alcohol related issue. They show signs of wanting to change when you ask them if they truly are happy with the position they are in, you can hear the
"change talk."

This is usually some form of: "I want to change, BUT..."

With these people, the technique I told you in a previous chapter where you hone in on

their “change talk” and not on their sustain talk is super important.

Not just for their mental benefit, but for yours too. You need to find the balance between having hours of negative conversations where someone vents with you, and positive productive conversations.

This is so you yourself don't **burn out** helping someone. You see some people are just in a very negative place and you yourself may not wish to spend hours in a negative place with someone.

You want to help them.

Yes you are doing them a service to listen to them, and if they are telling you things, it is a good sign because they put their trust in you.

They see you as somewhat of a leader in
their life.

But how you respond and react to them and
guide them through there issues will dictate
whether they simply trust you enough to
vent, or whether they trust you enough to
actually help them through, seeing you as a
true leader.

How do we respond to actually become a
leader, to guard our own hearts, and to
direct this person towards results?

Given the chance, many people will sit and
drone on to you for hours about their
negative thought patterns and their deepest
insecurities. Again, this can be a good thing
because these people have sometimes never
had someone listen to them in their lives.

People need to vent, and maybe they never had someone who would give them the time to listen. There's likely something about you that they trust, but in this case, given the chance they will probably talk for long time.

You are of course helping them by listening, the problem is they are using you as an emotional pillow.

This can help someone, but it has limits in terms of productivity. There's **listening** and then there's **guiding**, forming solutions and directing them in a way where they trust you know where you are going.

We want to guide without sounding judgy,
preaching hard, or steering the conversation
in a direction that is just too negative.

This takes a lot of finesse.

For example, let's say you have a younger
sister who says she wants to change. She is
showing change talk.

She has great opportunities in a big city, and
many chances at a good degree paid for by
the government. She is into modelling but
feels ugly sometimes.

The opportunities are there. But she parties
and has a lot of limiting beliefs about her
looks.

You might feel so angry! You won two modelling competitions when you were younger! You have what it takes to go all the way! You live in one of the biggest cities in the world.

Even if you know their limiting beliefs are total nonsense, to them its real. You getting angry and telling them “you shouldn’t feel this way.” “You have so much opportunity why don’t you see it?” doesn’t help.

Trying to convince someone not to feel the negative way that they feel can come across as preaching, you can say a few kind words about how you feel it may not be true, but if you show visible frustration that person will withdraw as they will feel they made you disappointed and get defensive.

I've found you lose energy yourself this way
as well, because you feel like the angry
preacher, that is going around repeating
yourself.

The flow of the conversation simply never
goes good when you get angry, or focus too
much on the negative sustain talk. I've fallen
into that trap so many times.

I have found that
15–45 minutes of focused listening is usually
sustainable for helping someone through an
issue.

Longer is fine *occasionally*, but not as a
regular pattern.

There also needs to be a give and take. If
they just vent and you absorb, it becomes

one sided. A person needs to meet you half way.

You decide whether you are the kind of person who they vent to for hours, or if you are the type of person who is listening to them under the condition that they allow you to coach and reach a solution as well as vent.

You don't have to explicitly say this to a person, but it is more from how you direct the conversation.

I myself draw the line if someone would want to vent to me for hours, but not be willing to at least hear my input and advice on how to form a solution. This balance really feels fair and works well for me.

I am going to give you some practical ways to steer the conversation towards a healthy exchange.

Focus On The Change Talk, Not The Sustain

Choosing to tell a person to focus on the change talk, saying: “it’s really cool that you wish to change in this way, and I think you should focus on that!” always directs the conversation back towards positivity and respect.

As a coaching figure in their life and not necessarily a professional therapist, it can sometimes be a better use of your time and effort to redirect towards the positive.

This technique actually helps with your own mental health too and allows you to find a balance point.

You yourself will get tired of going around in circles with someone, feeling like a “nagging” figure in their life, getting frustrated focusing on negative issues when someone simply “just doesn’t get it.”

You also don’t want to be sitting there for hours simply discussing negatives with no solutions. Let a person vent but don’t challenge what you don’t like about their response. It always leads to defensiveness if you challenge too much. Instead focus on what you do like, and lead them in that direction.

You will find that this opens up more positive conversations.

Frustration Is Rarely The Answer

Getting frustrated at a persons lack of progress rarely fixes things.

Don't get frustrated as the person goes around in circles even if you want to. Let's take two replies to a person who is displaying limiting beliefs.

“I want to make a positive change to my fitness and life, I have been doing some home workouts.

Honestly I don't like going to the gym because I feel like people will look at me and I feel like they will judge me and I have that

face that scares people away. I don't feel safe leaving the house because I have anxiety.

I feel ugly. So I just stay at home.”

This is quite a deep issue with a lot to unpack. Some people will tell you things like this and then also tell you multiple other issues and feelings stacked on top of it. Don't let it knock you. Let's look at the example of Reply 1 below, which is the example of a bad reply.

Reply 1:

What do you mean you don't like going to the gym and you don't like leaving the house! You live in the safest area possible! How can

you say you're not motivated to leave your
house!

You have all the money that others don't
have and a good life! If only you could see
your position!

And what do you mean you don't want to
leave the house because you feel like you
have a face that people find ugly! You
literally look like a model! You need to get a
grip, don't think that way!"

And now an example of a better reply:

Reply 2:

Listen, some of what you just said, I can talk
all day about why they are not true, or why

they don't serve you, but let's not take hours trying to convince you not to think a certain way.

Instead, let's focus on the solution of you wanting to change, and let's implement some new stuff to help you get there, and I will support you. You will be great at the gym, and I think it's a great idea.

Those are two totally different conversations. The second one is more often than not what works.

You could then get that person to commit to first going to the gym at least once per week, or ask if they would be open to talk to you or someone without judgement so you could help them see the reality of their limiting belief of being ugly.

In conclusion, it is very valuable to learn a healthy balance if you are the type of person who likes to help others. This can allow you to feel like you are fulfilling that feeling of helping without ever feeling guilty or like you are losing your quality of life.

You get the feeling of fulfillment without any guilt, and have clear rules about where you stand and your limits. This is a great achievement for your mental health.

To find the balance of helping people in need, I try to focus on quick, actionable advice where I focus on the positives of what people

want to do and not the negative talk they are telling me.

I give people time but try to do it in short productive sessions. I help people that are close to me, who trust me and are showing change talk, and if I have the time.

I wouldn't let someone vent for hours on a regular basis, and try not to get angry at them for the circles they go around in and the promises they don't keep. As soon as you feel anger, it's a sign that you are over reaching.

It's usually a sign that you've focused too much on the negative of the situation and allowed it to drag you down.

Perhaps you've gone on for too long trying to persuade someone on the small things, the negativities, the doubts, the worries, the pain, and that has dragged your emotional state down, instead of worrying about the productive solutions and the great changes they could make.

As soon as you feel the emotions of anger and stress, it's a sign to spend some time on yourself.

In my first book I set some non negotiables. If you are consistently not taking 10 minutes out of your day to write a gratitude journal, go to the gym, meditate, read a book, and stick to your diet, then it is a sign to take more time for yourself.

You should be ticking off your bucket list targets, financially doing ok for yourself, living a life you consider good, then you can designate more time for others!

Build in a way that sustains you, not depletes you!

End Of Coaching Book - Final Thoughts

I hope this book allows you to be confident in guiding others and allows you to unlock the champion within someone.

I hope you can be a more confident and inspiring person to your family, friends,

elderly family members and to young people around you.

People really look up to motivational coaches and those that are able to motivate others in everyday life.

You will start to live a very interesting life of helping people, and your life will tend to be surrounded with people who look up to you.

It is a rewarding life to live.

You can do it! As long as you practice what you preach, people will eventually listen. So keep working on yourself too.

The only thing that is left to do is to keep learning. Learn how to improve all elements of your life so you can pass the information onto others and take joy in helping them.

Your life will attract positive circumstances
and many people will be drawn to you.

Watch other motivational people and
teachers, take from them the techniques that
you like, and follow the next section of this
book for a recommended reading list of how
to improve all areas of your life further.

Build your knowledge and pass it on! Always
be improving and striving for greatness!

I hope the information in this book has
helped you to inspire someone, and made
you feel more like a leader.

If you feel like you need further help with
your fitness programming, your nutrition, or
you are in need of further life coaching,
please reach out to me on instagram at
@achievegreatnesstraining with any
questions.

Based on my availability I offer slots to work one to one with people around the world to help them achieve their best.

I am once again proud of you for making it this far and taking the decision to read this series of books. I wrote these books to inspire all people around the world to achieve greatness in sports and in their dreams.

I always say these books will appeal to a certain type of person, you are special for reading this and have something deeper inside of you for finishing this book series to the end.

When you think about the value you have created for yourself, you have invested in a book series that teaches you concepts 99% of people will never know.

With a mastery of fitness, nutrition, and inspiring others, as well as some reading lists, routines and non negotiable habits, rules and values to live your life by, you are all set.

I want to stress the importance of making your fitness an adventure that you enjoy, make sure to keep a variety of workouts, follow your dreams, discover your purpose and always try to achieve the best you can.

You can get in shape, look after yourself, and inspire others, from any humble beginning. I have given you the tools to do so.

There are few things better than a life of great emotional and physical health, and a positive mentality, waking up in the morning with a drive to achieve your wildest dreams.

I want you to imagine your life heading in this direction and the joy you will feel daily as you live life at a higher level.

Full of belief, equipped with the tools from this series, you are ready to achieve greatness in all of its forms.

Thanks for being with me over the course of these books, I am always here to help you. I am proud that you read all of what I taught you. Go out and achieve your everything.

- Coach Tommy

Chapter 5: Aligning Yourself To A Higher Level

Recommended Reading

I want you to go out and start reading self improvement books. Each one will improve your mindset in order to Achieve Greatness.

The journey of learning never stops. Please do not skip this section, and read everyday.

People have a negative mindset about these books, saying that “they never work.”

But self help books are far from a waste of time. You can learn so much and become a very well rounded person when you read this style of book.

The books below helped me to better advise myself and others on topics such as relationships, finances, health and mental issues, & public speaking.

They helped me to ace job interviews, and to make more money, and to help countless others to improve their lives.

To become the most complete person we can be, it is great to have knowledge on more than just fitness & nutrition.

Living a complete life requires a balance of knowledge in all areas. You want to be happy, successful and confident in many of the below areas of your life to have the best life possible.

You can learn a lot from these books such as:

- Knowing how to apply mental health techniques to your life written by qualified therapists
- Techniques to save money by financial advisors.
- Techniques to start your own business and make extra money.
- Techniques to have healthy relationships by qualified experts and marriage counsellors.
- Techniques to improve your public speaking by those who have done it thousands of times before.
- Techniques to excel at job interviews, sales, and leadership

I myself don't consider myself beyond such information and I urge you not to consider yourself beyond it either!

I notice a lot the people who consider themselves "beyond" this type of book seem to be negative people on average who stay in the same place in life.

I want you to keep an open mind and keep improving daily in many areas of your life.

I have compiled the below books to help you to improve your life further.

Finance and Business -

Mastering Yourself - Corey Wayne (Finding your Purpose and Career)

The Intelligent Investor - Benjamin Graham
(Making Money)
Random Walk Down Wall Street - Burton G.
Malkiel (Saving Money)
Millionaire Fast Lane - MJ DeMarco
Rich Dad Poor Dad - Robert Kiyosaki
The Total Money Makeover - Dave Ramsey
4 Hour Work Week - Tim Ferriss
The Laws of Success - Napoleon Hill
What you do is who you are - Ben Horowitz
(Building a business)
Win Bigly - Scott Adams (Persuading People)
Simple Path To Wealth - J.L Collins
Richest Man In Babylon - George Clayson
Set For Life - Scott Trench
Personal Finance for Dummies
DotComSecrets - Russel Brunson
Expert Secrets - Russel Brunson
The E-Myth Revisited - Michael E Gerber
Influence - Robert Cialdini

How to Get Rich - Felix Dennis

\$100m Offers - Alex Hormuz

Principles - Ray Dalio

The Psychology of Money - Morgan House

Money Master The Game - Tony Robbins

Mindset -

How To Win Friends and Influence People -
Dale Carnegie

Awaken The Giant Within - Tony Robbins

Discipline Equals Freedom - Jocko Willink
(Improve your discipline)

Way Of The Superior Man - David Deida

The War of Art - Steven Pressfield

Thinking Fast and Slow - Daniel Kahneman

Psycho-Cybernetics - Maxwell Maltz

(Visualisation & Self Image)

The Slight Edge - Jeff Olson

Can't Hurt Me - David Goggins
Never Finished - David Goggins
Mans Search For Meaning - Viktor Frankl
Laws of Human Nature - Robert Greene
Meditations - Marcus Aurelius
How To Think Like a Roman Emperor -
Donald Robertson
Hard Times Create Strong Men - Stefan
Aarnio
The Way Of Men - Jack Donovan
The Four Agreements - Don Miguel (Positive
Mindset, Self Forgiveness, Living Free From
Painful Thoughts)

Health -

The Molecule of More - Daniel Z Lieberman
Atomic Habits - James Clear
Why We Sleep - Matthew Walker
Emotional Intelligence - Daniel Goleman

Deep Work - Cal Newport
Think Again - Adam Grant
Easy Way To Control Alcohol - Alan Carr
The Worlds Fittest Book - Ross Edgily
Become A Supple Leopard - Kelly Start
Encyclopaedia of Modern Bodybuilding -
Arnold Schwarzenegger

Relationships -

How to make marriage work - John Gottman
Attached - Amir Levine

Sales -

How I Raised Myself From Failure To
Success In Selling - Frank Bettger
Influence The Art Of Persuasion - Robert
Caldini
The Way Of The Wolf - Jordan Belfort

Public Speaking -

Talk Like Ted - Carmine Gallo (Giving Good Presentations & Body Language For Public Speaking)

Depression -

The Subtle Art Of Not Giving A F* - Mark Manson

Anxiety-

Dare: The New Way to End Anxiety and Stop Panic Attacks - Barry McDonough

PTSD -

Route 91: Healing from Mass Violence and
Trauma by Dr. Shiva Ghaed

Achieve Greatness Mindset

1. Working Out Regularly
2. Accepts Negative Emotions but always
from an angle of “This Is What I’m Going To
Do About It”
3. Always Chasing Happiness

4.Be Unbreakably Positive

5.Does Not Subscribe To The Viewpoint That Life Isn't Fair

6.Will Rise To A Challenge And Take On Anyone

7.Not Displaying Vengefulness

8.Thick Skin - Not Letting Anything Annoy You Even The Most Annoying Things

9.Never Displaying Fear or Nervousness - Fake It Until You Make It

10. Not Staying In Jobs You Hate - Study Something You Want That Will Make You A Lot Of Money

11. Going For What You Want Even If It Doesn't Work Out

12. Never Timid, Never Shy. Good Loud Clear Communication Voice

13. Happy, Upbeat, Excited About Life and Dreams

14. Excited About Job and Wants To Be The Best

15. Sets Boundaries

16. Helps Others

17. Takes Complaints As Feedback

18. Stays Away From Drugs

19. Gets Home And Talks About The Good In
The Day Not The Bad

20. Puts in 200% to all areas of life



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